THURSDAY
October 29, 2026

DELHI
CITY EDITION
22 Pages ₹ 12.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 16 • No. 256
Regd. DL(ND)-11/6110/2006-07-08
RNI No. UPENG/2012/49940

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna



IN BRIEF



Jamia protest: two members of NSUI detained

NEW DELHI
Delhi Police on Wednesday detained two members of the National Students' Union of India (NSUI), the students' wing of the Congress, from outside the Jamia Millia Islamia campus amid an ongoing protest. » Page 2

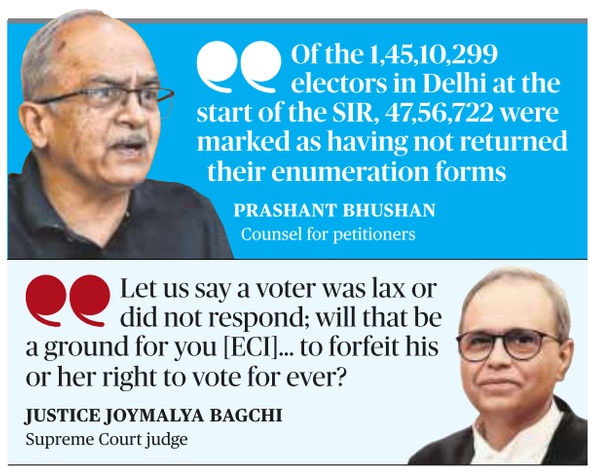
Mann, all Punjab MLAs get invite to visit Pakistan

CHANDIGARH
Days after Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann wished to attend an international Punjabi conference in Lahore, Pakistan Punjab Minister Ramesh Singh Arora has extended an invite to Mr. Mann and all Punjab MLAs to visit Pakistan. » Page 4

SC asks if poll panel has powers to punish voters

ECI in 'error' to force pre-existing voters whose names were deleted from rolls to apply as new electors, says SC; it asks how electors can be denied vote because they were lax or inert during SIR

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI



> Of the 1,45,10,299 electors in Delhi at the start of the SIR, 47,56,722 were marked as having not returned their enumeration forms
>
> **PRASHANT BHUSHAN**
> Counsel for petitioners

> Let us say a voter was lax or did not respond; will that be a ground for you [ECI]... to forfeit his or her right to vote for ever?
>
> **JUSTICE JOYMALYA BAGCHI**
> Supreme Court judge

The Supreme Court on Wednesday questioned the authority of Election Commission of India (ECI) to deprive citizens forever of their right to vote simply because they were lax in returning enumeration forms during the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, which has disenfranchised nearly 13 crore voters across the country.

"Let us say a voter was lax, inert, or did not respond, will that be a ground for you, the Election Commission of India, to forfeit his or her right to vote for ever? We will answer that," Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, addressed the poll body. The court said the ECI was in "error" to force pre-existing voters, whose names were deleted from the electoral roll, to apply as new voters under Form 6 of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

Senior advocate Dama Seshadri Naidu, for the ECI, said the court's Bihar SIR judgment on May 27 had mentioned that the poll body had "residuary powers".

Justice Bagchi clarified that the Bihar judgment was not a "binding precedent" and asked why the ECI had not then used these residuary powers to reach out to voters who had not responded to enumeration forms.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12
SIR: SERIOUS QUESTIONS
» PAGE 8

64.5 lakh electors 'missing' in Karnataka's rolls

Around 64.5 lakh electors are potentially missing from the final electoral rolls of Karnataka released after the special intensive revision on Tuesday, as per calculations based on Elector-to-Population ratio of 66.11, released by the office of the Chief Electoral Officer. » PAGE 9

Five killed in heavy rain as Cyclone Arnab crosses A.P.

Nellore Sravani
VIJAYAWADA



A tree uprooted under the influence of Cyclone Arnab lies on top of a car in Visakhapatnam, A.P., on Wednesday. K. R. DEEPAK

Five people were killed in rain-related incidents as Cyclone Arnab battered north Andhra Pradesh with extremely heavy rain and winds gusting up to 150 km per hour as it made landfall on Wednesday morning, uprooting more than 1,000 trees and affecting crops across 80,500 hectares, official reports said.

More than 42 weather stations across the northern districts of Visakhapatnam, Vizianagaram, and Anakapalli recorded over 200 mm of rainfall in a 24-hour period ending on Wednesday morning. Garividi of Vizianagaram district recorded the highest of 260 mm.

Another 271 stations across the State reported at least 100 mm during the period.

The landfall process of the 'very severe cyclonic storm' continued till 8 a.m., after which the system weakened into a 'severe cyclonic storm'.

Neighbouring Odisha, where the cyclonic system is expected to bring heavy rainfall until Thursday morning, said it is prepared to deal with any eventuality. Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi said 17 districts of Odisha had been affected by heavy rainfall triggered by Cyclone Arnab.

In its national bulletin issued at 8.30 p.m., the India Meteorological Department said the severe cyclonic storm had weakened into a cyclonic storm. It is likely to become a deep depression by midnight and move north-northwestwards in the next 24 hours before gradually weakening, it said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12
EDITORIAL
» PAGE 8
CENTRAL AID SOUGHT
» PAGE 6

SFI alleges reservation shortfall in JNU PhD seats

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Students' Federation of India (SFI) on Wednesday alleged that Jawaharlal Nehru University's (JNU) PhD Admission Prospectus 2026-27 falls short of the prescribed reservation quotas for Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST) and Persons with Benchmark Disabilities (PwBD), and sought rectification.

JNUSU vice-president Gopika Babu said of the total 711 PhD seats, 38 were reserved for ST candidates against the required 53, while 103 were earmarked for SC candidates against 107. For PwBD candidates, only 17 seats were advertised against the required 36. "These figures point to serious deficiencies in the university's implementation of reservation norms," she said.

According to the SFI, the National Commission for Scheduled Castes issued JNU a notice on October 8 over the SFI's complaint, and gave it seven days to respond on October 27. The National Commission for Scheduled Tribes also took cognisance of the matter, it said.

Jamia stir: two NSUI members detained; exams moved online

Detained students will be produced before a magistrate today, says their lawyer; university extends online classes till November 24; students deny charges of vandalism, threatening faculty members

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI



Security personnel standing guard outside Jamia Millia Islamia amid an ongoing protest on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Delhi Police on Wednesday detained two members of the National Students' Union of India (NSUI), the students' wing of the Congress, from outside the Jamia Millia Islamia campus, where public assembly has been banned under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS). The police action comes amid an ongoing hunger strike by students demanding the restoration of the students' union, which was dissolved in 2006.

NSUI identified the detained students as Faizan, president of its Jamia unit, and Zishan, a former national head of its social media wing. They were taken to Fatehpur Beri before being brought back to the Jamia Nagar police station. They will be produced before a magistrate on Thursday, their lawyer said. "Instead of listening to the voices of NSUI fellows who have been on hunger strike ... Delhi Police has taken fellows Faizan and Zishan into custody," NSUI national president Vinod Jakhar wrote on X.

While students demanded the election process to be completed by February 5, the administration said it needed more time. Five students continue to remain on hunger strike.

'Vandalism by students'

As the agitation entered its 17th day on Wednesday, the university alleged that students engaged in vandalism. "Groups vandalised university gates and walls, brought down Gate No. 4C, pelted stones, [and] damaged the CCTV control room overnight on October 27, damaging gates, walls and the CCTV control room," an official release stated. It also claimed that "female wardens and faculty members were threatened".

However, protesters denied the allegations. One of the protesters, Neville, said, "They [the administration] erected aluminium sheets... and by evening got them dismantled and are blaming students."

Students alleged harassment by proctorial teams in hostels, with their ID cards being snatched and the canteen ordered to close from November 1 "to pressure them to vacate".

They also alleged that since October 12, the police detained more than 70 students. On Monday, Niranjan K.S., Arbaaj Khan, and Munna Qureshi were arrested, police said. They were later remanded in three days of judicial custody at Tihar Jail.

'For student safety'

Citing concerns over student safety, the university issued an order stating that it has decided to conduct its end-semester exams online and extend online classes till November 24. The university will remain shut for winter vacation from December 25 to January 12, 2027, with the even-semester starting on January 13, the order stated.

Outstation students said the closure of the campus has created problems. A student from J&K, who travelled by bus for document verification, found the gates locked. "I have a deadline to meet as I'm applying to foreign universities for higher studies... I'm uncertain of getting my work done," he said.

Liquor booking app sparks row; AAP seeks rollback, BJP hits back

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The 'Delhi Liquor Booking' app launched by the Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC) has triggered a political row, with the Opposition Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) demanding that the scheme be rolled back within 24 hours and the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) countering that it had been approved during AAP's tenure.

According to a DSIIDC official, the plan was approved in December 2024 and the work order issued in January 2025, when AAP was in power in Delhi.

The corporation, meanwhile, launched a mobile app in November 2025, after the BJP came to power in February that year. In September this year, the department launched a website with a QR code that customers can scan to book alcohol online, the official added.

Although customers can book and pay online, home delivery is not available. Customers must collect their orders from shops within 48 hours of booking, the official said.

Delhi has over 700 retail liquor shops, run by four Delhi government corporations. The facility is available at 196 vends operated by the DSIIDC.

> If this scheme is not withdrawn within 24 hours, we will demand the resignation of [Industry] Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa. We are going to launch a massive movement
> **SAURABH BHARADWAJ**
> AAP Delhi president

'Gift from CM'

Addressing a press conference on Wednesday, AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj called the app "a Karva Chauth gift from Chief Minister Rekha Gupta to women".

"If this scheme is not withdrawn within 24 hours, we will demand the resignation of [Industry] Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa. We will not let him off; we will ensure that he resigns. We are going to launch a massive movement. We are giving the Rekha Gupta government 24 hours," he said.

He later wrote in a post on X: "No Minister or CM of Aam Aadmi Party ever gave any approval for this disgusting app for booking liquor. Why is BJP Govt afraid of suspending the officers who launched this service without approval of elected Govt?"

Delhi Congress chief Devender Yadav alleged that the BJP "learnt no lessons from the previous AAP government's liquor policy". He claimed that the ruling party's intention also appears to be "to fill its coffers and lead unemployed youth astray through online liquor booking".

'Object of ridicule'

Hitting back, Delhi BJP spokesperson Praveen Shankar Kapoor said Mr. Bharadwaj had made himself an "object of ridicule" by opposing the app.

"AAP leaders have committed so many sins during their tenure that perhaps Saurabh Bharadwaj even forgot before opposing that this liquor booking app was also brought by the AAP government on December 13, 2024 and it was implemented on January 2, 2025 by the government of [then CM] Atishi. At that time, Mr. Bharadwaj himself was the Minister [of the department concerned]," Mr. Kapoor said, adding that the BJP government neither publicised nor promoted the app.

CM hands over ex gratia cheques to families of victims of tragedies

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday handed over compensation cheques to families who lost their loved ones in various mishaps and during the COVID-19 pandemic, the Chief Minister's Office stated in a release.

The families of four persons who died in the building collapse at Satya Niketan last month were given ex gratia of ₹10 lakh each.

Ms. Gupta gave cheques of ₹10 lakh each to the families of those who died in the Tughlakabad fire, ₹2 lakh to each injured person, and ₹20,000 each to two persons who sustained minor injuries. A cheque for ₹5 lakh was also given to the family of a person who died in a drowning incident in Jasola.

Earlier in the day, Ms. Gupta handed over cheques of ₹1 lakh each and Karva Chauth kits to 51 newly-weds celebrating their first Karva Chauth. The women got married in a mass wedding ceremony organised by the Ladli Foundation in March.

L-G, Mandaviya inaugurate inter-university sports cup

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Union Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, and Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood at the inauguration of the DDA-University Sports Cup 2026 in Delhi. ANI

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and several government universities have joined hands to organise an inter-university sports tournament featuring five disciplines, following an initiative by Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu to promote team sports among students, according to a release issued by Lok Niwas on Wednesday.

Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya, Mr. Sandhu, and Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood inaugurated the DDA-University Sports Cup 2026 at Roshanara Club on Tuesday. Organised by Delhi Technological University (DTU) in collaboration with the DDA, the tournament is being held at the DTU Sports Complex from October 28 to November 2, the release stated.

According to Lok Niwas, students will compete in men's and women's categories in hockey, football, kabaddi, basketball, and cricket. The participating universities include DTU, Netaji Subhas University of Technology, Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology Delhi, Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women, Delhi Skill and Entrepreneurship University, Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, Ambedkar University Delhi, Delhi Teachers University, and Delhi Sports University.

Culture of sports

Addressing students and athletes at the inauguration, Mr. Mandaviya described the initiative as "a significant step towards building a culture of sports and fitness among the youth" and urged young sportspersons to pursue excellence with discipline. He also referred to India's ambition to host the 2036 Olympics and its successful bid to host the Commonwealth Games in 2030.

Mr. Sandhu said, "The tournament will bring Delhi's universities together on a common platform and encourage sportsmanship and team spirit. As the Prime Minister has said, sports teach us not only to become champions, but also to become better competitors. Sports are an important part of education, teaching young people to work together and accept victory and defeat alike."

Former hockey Olympian Ashok Kumar, wrestler Deepak Punia and shooter Ashima Ahlawat were also present at the inauguration. The event featured a march-past by university contingents and unveiling of the trophy.

BJP takes out march in Chandni Chowk; traders allege losses

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI



BJP chief Nitin Nabin with CM Rekha Gupta and other leaders during a foot march in Chandni Chowk on Wednesday. ANI

The BJP on Wednesday took out a 'Save Democracy, Remove Anarchy' foot march through Chandni Chowk, targeting the Congress over its protests seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and suspension of the special intensive revision exercise.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, BJP president Nitin Nabin, party Delhi unit chief Harsh Malhotra and PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh were among those who took part in it.

Criticising the Congress over its 'vote *chori* [theft]' campaign, Ms. Gupta said, "If they [Congress] think they can remove a government elected by the people and bring regime change, they should forget it."

Mr. Nabin said Narendra Modi would return as Prime Minister after the 2029 Lok Sabha election.

Several traders told *The Hindu* that the march came at a crucial time, with Karva Chauth a day away and Deepavali round the corner. They said security arrangements for the march and the removal of roadside stalls reduced footfall, leaving even established shops struggling to attract customers.

Rajkumar, a shop owner, said, "It does not matter which political party organises it; traders end up paying the price. Festive and wedding seasons are when we expect to make up for the rest of the year, but business is suffering."

The Congress, meanwhile, accused the BJP of "hypocrisy", saying the march through one of Delhi's busiest commercial areas went against its claim of standing with traders.

"On the one hand, the BJP is being a well-wisher of traders, and on the other, by taking out a march in a crowded area, it is causing harm to traders," Delhi Congress leader Anil Bharadwaj said.

CLASSIFIEDS MART
TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 011-43579797

REAL ESTATE

NOIDA– PRIME–COMMERCIAL_ 75M Plot/ Const_GF–800_FF–800SqFt TF–400SqFt_Rentd–2.25Lac P.M. 'PRS'_Bright_'SAN' 9266039534

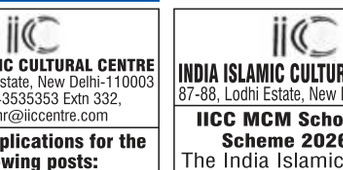
TENDERS

NOTICE INVITATION OF TENDER
FOR REGTL SHOPS AT ARMY HOSPITAL (R&R)
ON CLOSED BID SYSTEM
1. A closed bid tender is invited from eligible persons for allotment of following regimental shops for welfare of patients, troops and their families at Army Hospital (R&R), Delhi Cantt-10, initially for eleven months and extendable for a period of maximum five years subject to revision of license fee as per the policy in vogue:-
Tea Snacks Bar & General Store: Opp PMR
Tea Snacks Shop & Juice Bar: Opp Gamma Knife
JCOS/OR Cafeteria: Old Aashiana
The Royal Treat Restaurant: Multi Level Parking
2. Priority of allotment will be given to the following categories of eligible applicants in the order as mentioned through a closed bid system:
(a) Widows of defence personnel who have died while in service (including widows of all types of Battle and Physical Casualty of defence personnel).
(b) Disabled soldier.
(c) Ex-serviceman
(d) Spouses/ widows of ex-serviceman
Note: Subletting will not be allowed. Applicants more then 60 years old are not eligible.
3. Application form can be obtained from Main Office, Army Hospital (R&R) from 1000 hrs to 1300 hrs within 07 days of publication of this notice in newspaper.
4. Eligible volunteers may submit their application alongwith self attested copy of discharge book/documents/PPO within 15 days of publication of the advertisement addressed to "The Commandant, Army Hospital (R&R) Delhi Cantt-110010" in a sealed envelope or drop in Tender Box kept at Main Office under surveillance of CCTV. Allotment will be done on recommendation of a board of officers and intimation will be given to the allottee accordingly.
Note:-
1.Applicants who are already in possession of Regti shop in any locations or had licence within last three years are not eligible to apply.
2.Bid in open envelope/without envelope/ with over writing will not be accepted.
3. Applicant will attach Rs 200.00 (Rupees two hundred only) Demand Draft in favour of "Regimental Fun A/c of Com" as processing fee which will be non-refundable.
Offgerig I/C Adm & Cdr Tps
Army Hospital (R&R)
for Comdt

For enquiries on announcements in
CLASSIFIEDS MART
please contact our office at the following number between 10a.m. to 8p.m.
New Delhi : 011- 43579797
For Placing Advertisements Online
log on to
www.thehinduads.com

AUTOMOTIVE

Embassy of France in India is selling
NISSAN CARAVAN 2WD MINIVAN
Year of Manufacture : 2016 | Year of Registration : 2017 | Kilometer: 64772 | Fuel : Petrol
Imported from Japan (taxes as applicable)



The Embassy of France in India invites bids for the purchase of the above-mentioned vehicle. The vehicle will be sold to the highest bidder, subject to the Embassy's right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason. Interested parties are requested to submit their bids in a sealed envelope at the Embassy's main gate, clearly written "Bid for Purchase of NISSAN CARAVAN MINIVAN – SGA, Embassy of France, New Delhi."
The deadline for submission of bids is 5 November 2026, 11 AM.
An additional tax of 6% of the purchase price shall be payable by the successful bidder. The successful bidder shall also be responsible for all applicable vehicle registration charges and related fees payable to the competent local authorities.
Eligibility Requirement: **The purchaser must possess an Aadhaar card bearing a Delhi address and the vehicle must be registered in Delhi.**
Inspection of the Vehicle: The vehicle may be inspected at the Embassy of France, New Delhi, by prior appointment. Appointments may be requested by telephone at 011-43196100 or by email at **scg.new-delhi-amba@diplomatie.gouv.fr**
Inspections may be arranged from Monday to Friday, excluding weekends, subject to prior confirmation

SITUATION VACANT
GENERAL

INDIA ISLAMIC CULTURAL CENTRE
87-88, Lodhi Estate, New Delhi-110003
Ph: 011-43535353 Extn 332,
Email: hr@iiccentre.com
Invites applications for the following posts:
• **Electrician-01**
• **Fire Fighting Operator-01**
• **Helper-cum-AC Technician-01**
• **HR Executive-01**
• **Steward-04**
For qualification & experience etc. of these posts, kindly refer to our website: iiccentre.com, Send CV within 15 days by email to: hr@iiccentre.com
Secretary, IICC

PUBLIC NOTICE

INDIA ISLAMIC CULTURAL CENTRE
87-88, Lodhi Estate, New Delhi-110003
IICC MCM Scholarship Scheme 2026-27
The India Islamic Cultural Centre (IICC), New Delhi, invites applications from eligible Indian students for the MCM Scholarship Scheme 2026-27.
Apply online at
https://iicc-mcm-scholarship.in/ by 25/11/2026.
Secretary, IICC

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

EMPLOYMENT OF NOTIFICATION
WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR THE POST OF PROFESSOR, ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR ON CONTRACT BASIS

Application are invited for Walk-in-interview for engagement of Professors and Associate Professors in the different Disciplines / Department on Contractual basis for a period of 11 months from the eligible candidates of Indian National of state domicile for Agartala Government Dental College & IGM Hospital, Agartala under the Health & Family Welfare Department, Govt. of Tripura.

Sl No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post	Subject
1.	Professor	1(UR)	Conservative Dentistry and Endodontics
2.		1(UR)	Orthodontics
3.	Associate Professor	1(ST)	Conservative of Dentistry and Endodontics
4.		1(ST)	Prosthodontics & Crown and Bridge
5.		1(UR)	Paediatric & Preventive Dentistry

Interested candidates are requested to submit application with prescribed format on or before 10th November 2026 up to 5.00 P.M. positively.
The application should be addressed to the Principal, Agartala Govt. Dental College & IGM Hospital, IGM Hospital Complex, Agartala, West Tripura, Pin-799001.
The Applications received after the closing date will not be entertained TA & DA is not admissible for appearing in the interview.
Further details are available at office of the Director of Medical Education Agartala & also available in www.dme.tripura.gov.in, https://agdc.tripura.gov.in.
Prof. (Dr.) H. P Sarma
Director of Medical Education
Government of Tripura
N.B:- Candidates will have to enclose self-attested copies of caste certificate (ST/SC), age proof certificate, PRTC(in case of state domicile, BDS & MDS degree certificate, Registration Certificate of Dental Council, other qualification certificate, Experience Certificate (if any) with his/her application & the original certificate must be produced at the time of selection.
ICA/D/1244/26

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder
Call our toll-free number 1800 102 1878
Or write to us at customercare@thehindu.co.in
Scan the QR code to register your feedback
THE HINDU | thehindu businessline. | FRONTLINE | SPORTSTAR | The Hindu Young World | THE HINDU

Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department
Corrigendum.
The online tender invited by the Executive Engineer, Jawali Division HP.PWD Jawali, vide this office letter No. PWJ/CB/TA/Tender/2026-27-4999 dated 21.10.2026 schedule to be opened on 29.09.2026 is hereby extended as per the revised key as under:-

Sr. No.		Already published key	Now to be published
1.	Date of online publication	28.10.2026 at 11.00AM	04.11.2026 at 11.00 AM
2.	Start Date	28.10.2026 at 11.00AM	04.11.2026 at 11.00 AM
3.	Bid submission end date	04.11.2026 at 5.00 PM	12.11.2026 at 5.00 PM
4.	Date of opening	05.11.2026 at 11.30 AM	13.11.2026 at 11.30 AM

Sd/- **Executive Engineer, Jawali Division, HP.PWD, Jawali.**
HP / 4378/26-27 **him suchan avam jan sampark**

Timings
DELHI

THURSDAY, OCT. 29			
RISE	06:31	SET	17:39
RISE	20:12	SET	09:57
FRIDAY, OCT. 30			
RISE	06:31	SET	17:38
RISE	21:19	SET	11:02
SATURDAY, OCT. 31			
RISE	06:32	SET	17:37
RISE	22:28	SET	11:58

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	32	16
Safdarjang	32	16
Palam	29	16

Delhi Palam Today
29ºC The weather will be slight warm and windy. Night will be slight cool. Chances of light to moderate rain and thunder-shower with gusty winds.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
28ºC Morning will be cool with mist and haze. Day will be comfortable Night also will be pleasant. Chances of rain and thundershower.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

TAJ

FESTIVITIES
LIKE ALWAYS

CELEBRATIONS
LIKE NEVER BEFORE

Taj Lake Palace, Udaipur

FESTIVALS of INDIA
CELEBRATIONS BY TAJ

EXPERIENCE INDIA IN ITS MOST BEAUTIFUL MOMENTS

20% Savings on Breakfast & One Meal Inclusive Stays

20% Savings on Food & Beverage at Restaurants During Stay

20% Savings on Spa Therapies & Salon Services During Stay

Earn up to 8% NeuCoins for Members

Valid for bookings and stays until 30th November 2026

1800 111 825 | reservations@ihcltata.com | www.tajhotels.com

T&C Apply

TAJ INNERCIRCLE | Step into a World of Exclusive Privileges

INBRIEF



Out on parole, Asaram fails to return to Jodhpur jail on time

A fresh legal trouble awaited Asaram in Jodhpur after he reported to the central jail nearly 17 hours after the deadline set for his return from medical parole. The Ratanada police registered a case against the convicted godman under the Prisons Act on Tuesday night for failing to surrender within the stipulated time, even as the jail authorities refused to admit him due to the late hour. Asaram, who is serving a sentence in a rape cas, finally surrendered at Jodhpur Central Jail around 10 a.m. on Wednesday after spending the night at Arogyam Hospital in Bhagat Ki Kothi. The 20-day parole granted to him by the Rajasthan High Court on October 6 ended on October 27. PTI

Centre opposes Rajoana's plea against death sentence in SC

The Centre on Wednesday opposed in the Supreme Court a plea filed by Balwant Singh Rajoana seeking commutation of his death sentence to life term in the 1995 assassination of then Punjab Chief Minister Beant Singh. Rajoana, who has been incarcerated for more than 29 years, including on death row for over 15 years, has sought commutation of his death sentence due to the delay in deciding his mercy plea. "We will argue this matter. I don't think such a prayer can be granted," Additional Solicitor General K.M. Nataraj, told a Bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and Aparesh Kumar Singh. PTI

Second 'police encounter' in 12 hours: accused in Bengal BJP worker's murder killed

BJP Minister pens poem on 'encounter'; hours after a rape and murder accused was gunned down, police shot down key accused in the August 28 murder in Murshidabad under similar circumstances

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

Hours after an accused in a rape and murder case was killed in a 'police encounter' in West Bengal's North 24 Parganas district on Tuesday, another 40-year-old man accused in the murder of a Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) worker in Murshidabad in August was shot dead by the police, officials said on Wednesday.

Samaul Sheikh, who was a key accused in the murder of BJP worker Sujit Mondal on August 28, was shot dead in an alleged gunfight with police in Murshidabad at 3 p.m. on Tuesday. Around 12 hours before, Prahlad Das, an accused in the alleged rape and murder of a minor girl in Gaighata, North 24 Parganas, was killed under similar circumstances around 3.30 a.m.

According to the police, the accused, Samaul Sheikh, was taken to Dhulian under Murshidabad's Samserganj police station to reconstruct the crime scene. "Prima facie, officials from the Crime Investigation Department (CID) brought him to the spot for investigation. However, he allegedly snatched the service weapon of an officer and tried to flee the spot. He died in retaliatory firing during the incident," said the Jangipur Superintendent of Police Surinder Singh.

The officer added that police immediately reached the spot upon receiving information. The accused was rushed to a hospital in Anupnagar, where he was declared dead. Later, the body was sent to the subdivisional hospital for an autopsy. CID officials did not comment on the "encounter".



Minister Agnimitra Paul wrote a poem, 'Encounter', to underline her message on crime and safety amid public outrage over the two killings in separate 'police encounters' in West Bengal. FILE PHOTO

On August 28, bidi worker-cum-BJP activist, Mondal, 36, went missing, and a ransom call was made to his house. Parts of his dismembered body were later found. Three persons, including Samaul Sheikh, Tazkira Bibi, and Johni Skheikh, were arrested in connection with the incident, which the police suspect involves a dispute over financial dealings.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari had handed over the case to the CID and alleged non-cooperation by the local police when the family members of the victim sought police protection.

Meanwhile, the mother of the rape-murder accused on Wednesday demanded "justice" for her son even as State Minister Agnimitra Paul turned to poetry to underline her message on crime and safety amid public outrage over the two killings in separate "police encounters". Titled 'Encounter', the Bengali poem calls for "firmness against crime".

The poem, however, does not directly refer to either case or name the accused. BJP State president Samik Bhattacharya earlier said, "In many situations, police may have to open fire, especially when they are attacked."

Opposition parties, including the Mamata All India Trinamool Congress and the Communist Party of India (Marxist), have condemned the incidents. "Instead of relying on the rule of law, people are taking the law into their own hands," said CPI(M) State secretary Mohammad Salim.

(With inputs from PTI)

Mann, all Punjab MLAs get invite to visit Pakistan

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Pakistan Punjab Minister extended the invitation after Punjab CM expressed desire to attend an international Punjabi conference in Lahore

Days after Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann expressed his desire to attend an international Punjabi conference in Lahore, Pakistan Punjab Minister for Minority Affairs and Chairman of the Pakistan Sikh Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee, Ramesh Singh Arora, has extended an invitation to Mr. Mann and all legislators of the Punjab Assembly to visit Pakistan.

"Bhagwant Singh Mann Sahib, as the Minister for Minority Affairs, as the president of the Pakistan Sikh Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee and as a Pakistani citizen, we invite you. The Chief Minister of Punjab, Maryam Nawaz, invites you," Mr. Arora said.

Tour of shrines

Speaking in the Punjab Assembly in Lahore, he said, "We invite the Punjab Assembly of India to come, and Pakistan will not only arrange your pilgrimage to Kartarpur Sahib, but we will also take you to the sacred places of other faiths present here."

The invitation follows Mr. Mann's statement during the recently concluded session of the Punjab Assembly that he wished to accept the invitation from the organisers of the Lahore International Punjabi Conference scheduled to be held in Lahore from November 27 to 29 and that he would also want to visit Sikh shrines in Pakistan.

Long-pending demand

Sikh devotees, Sikh organisations, and political parties have been demanding the reopening of the Kartarpur Corridor, which connects Dera Baba Nanak in India to Darbar Sahib gurdwara in Pakistan.

It was in Kartarpur Sahib, now in Pakistan, where Sikhism's founder Guru Nanak Dev had spent the last 18 years of his life.

The corridor has remained shut since May 7, 2025, after tensions escalated between India and Pakistan following the Pahalgam terror attack.

All 17 escapees from T.N. district jail apprehended in less than 40 hours: police

The Hindu Bureau
THENI

With the arrest of all 17 remand prisoners who escaped from the Theni district jail, the combing operation concluded successfully on Wednesday.

On Monday night, the remand prisoners claimed that one of the inmates suffered epileptic seizures and required assistance. When a jail warder opened the cell, they overpowered him and escaped.

Subsequently, the 17 of them moved out in small groups and reached the main gate, where again, they assaulted the personnel. After taking the keys forcibly, they made their escape.

Inspector-General of Police (South Zone) Vijayendra Bidari formed 17 special teams with SPs – Pradeep Gowtham (Theni) and N Jayakumar (Dindigul) – as coordinators. The police also fanned out to neighbouring Keralam as well in search of the escapees.


Seventeen teams had been formed, and the SPs of Theni and Dindigul were in charge of the search operation. G. KARTHIKEYAN

The first break came within a few hours on Tuesday, when the teams spotted one of the prisoners early morning. In the next few hours, they secured another four persons. Later, in the evening, the teams used three high definition drones and caught eight more accused. On Wednesday, two other prisoners were nabbed, which took the total to 15.

From 2 p.m. onwards, the teams zeroed in on the last two persons and nabbed them somewhere between Cumbum and Gudalur in the district.

In less than 40 hours, the entire combing operation was successfully carried out and police said that the search had ended.

ED attaches assets of Azam Khan's Jauhar varsity in PMLA case

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Wednesday provisionally attached land and buildings of Mohammad Ali Jauhar University in Uttar Pradesh's Rampur in connection with a a money-laundering case against the Maulana Mohammad Ali Jauhar Trust, its founder and Samajwadi Party leader Azam Khan and others.

'Land forcibly taken'

The ED initiated an investigation under under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, on the basis of 26 FIRs registered at the Azim Nagar police station in Rampur under various sections of IPC, alleging that agricultural land of farmers was forcibly taken over for the university.

"As per the inquiry report of the district administration, Rampur, 45 plots of enemy property measuring about 34 acres at village Singhankhera were also illegally occupied by Azam Khan for the university even after the lease for this land to the trust had been cancelled by the custodian. The possession of this land has been taken back by the office of the Custodian of Enemy Property for India under the Ministry of Home Affairs through the district administration, Rampur," an ED official said.

The probe agency added that during investigation, it found that funds meant for public works were diverted to the university and government works were executed on the private campus, and funds from contractors who had been allotted government contracts, were routed back to the trust as donations.

Furniture thrown, proceedings disrupted as lawyers' protest against HC judge turns chaotic

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Chaos erupted in one of the courtrooms at the Allahabad High Court on Wednesday as protests against a judge escalated, with advocates allegedly throwing furniture towards the dais. The conduct of the lawyers prompted the court to consider disciplinary and contempt proceedings against those involved.

A Bench of Justice Arun Kumar Singh Deshwal was hearing a bail application when slogans and commotion from the adjoining corridor interrupted the proceedings.

After being informed that the lawyers were protesting over the alleged mistreatment of their colleague, the judge expressed concern over the disruption caused to litigants and the functioning of the court. The protest reportedly stemmed from allegations that a lawyer had been mistreated by Justice Ajay Bhanot.


The lawyers were protesting over the alleged mistreatment of their colleague by Justice Ajay Bhanot of the Allahabad HC. VIDEO GRAB

Terming the conduct of the lawyers as "wholly unjustified" and "contemptuous", the Bench observed that litigants approach the court seeking judicial relief and should not suffer because of disagreements between lawyers and a particular judge.

"Registrar (Protocol) is directed to get the CCTV footage of camera installed outside of Court No.66, identify the advocates involved in the incident and submit a report to this court by next date of listing. After identifying the advocates, the matter may be referred to the Bar Council of U.P. for initiation of disciplinary proceedings as well as initiation of contempt proceedings against them," Justice Deshwal ordered.

Unmarried rural youth in Maharashtra plan stir for govt. help in getting brides

Radheshyam Jadhav
PUNE

It is not the inflation, unemployment, deletion of names from the voters' list or corruption that is simmering in rural Maharashtra youth who are gearing up for an agitation. Unlike other Gen Z across India, these youth have an unusual demand – get us brides to marry.

"We are planning not only a Statewide but a nationwide network of boys who are not getting brides to marry and plan a massive agitation," Kisan Nanaware, a 28-year-old youth from Solapur, told *The Hindu*.

Mr. Nanaware came into the limelight after he held a dharna demanding bride at the District Collector's office in September. He fears he may suffer the same fate as thousands of men in rural Solapur in western Maharashtra, pointing out that the issue stretches far beyond men in their early 30s, with some in their 40s and 50s having given up hope of finding a partner.

Youth such as Mr. Nanaware argue that the State must issue an official resolution detailing steps to assist those who are unmarried. Their core demands include setting up an all-religion marriage registration bureau under the Social Welfare Department, providing direct financial assistance, creating steady rural employment, and guaranteeing remunerative prices for farm produce. He warns that if authorities fail to act, the movement could take an aggressive turn.

The politicians who have been facing various kinds of agitations are now facing heat of the unmarried youth.


Kisan Nanaware (28), who held a dharna seeking bride at DC's office in Sept., now plans to build a network of unmarried rural youth to protest against State apathy to their plight. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

What was supposed to be a standard campaign stop for the Maharashtra Legislative Council elections in Ashti, Beed district (Marathwada region), took a dramatic turn when an agitated young man seized the microphone from local organisers and voiced an issue cutting across rural Maharashtra for which he wanted an immediate answer from the leaders. "Keep aside all other problems and look at our condition," he demanded, speaking to a crowd of ruling alliance leaders gathered for the Graduates' and Teachers' constituency elections held on October 23. "Many of us, including me, have crossed 30 or 32 and still we are not getting brides. Solve this problem first!"

Leaders of the BJP-led ruling coalition were not entirely surprised by the outburst. Behind the scenes, politicians have been monitoring simmering anger among rural men who find themselves systematically rejected by prospective brides and their families due to falling farm incomes, lack of steady employment, and a skewed gender ratio.

Maharashtra recorded a sex ratio of 899 girls per 1,000 boys during the 2022-24 period, marginally improving from 896 girls in 2012-14 but well below the national average of 918 girls, according to the latest Sample Registration System Statistical Report.

Bleak prospects

From Ministers to leaders across party lines, veteran leader Sharad Pawar to local gram panchayat sarpanches, young boys are now raising one simple question, "What about our marriage?" No one has answer to this.

"If not leaders, who is going to answer? At least they must solve one problem and this is the pressing one," said 32-year-old Avinash Shende from Yavatmal in Vidarbha region. Along with farming, he is working on a contract with a private cleaning agency and has not completed his graduation. He added that like him other youth in the region are now galvanising support to take up this issue at the State level. He says the movement would start from gram sabhas in villages.

The ruling BJP-led alliance in the State is worried as the frustration on the ground is quickly turning into organised agitation. The agitated youth have demanded that if the State government is unable to help them secure brides or improve their financial standing through stable jobs and fair agricultural prices, it must introduce a monthly pension scheme for unmarried men.

'Difficult challenge'

"For a government already dealing with widespread agitations over inflation, unemployment, and the ongoing Election Commission of India's SIR drive, this demographic crisis presents a difficult challenge. Unlike economic policy or infrastructure projects, resolving a social shortage of brides is not something easily fixed by government decree. But then, the youth are not in a mood to listen," said a local BJP leader in Sangli district who requested anonymity.

BMC to launch pre-Deepavali drive to curb pollution

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) will undertake a nine-day special cleanliness and dust mitigation drive across Mumbai from October 29 to November 6, focusing on major arterial roads and dust-prone stretches to curb air pollution and improve the city's air quality ahead of Deepavali.

The drive, initiated on the directions of Municipal Commissioner Ashwini Bhide, will cover major roads, including the Jogeshwari-Vikhroli Link Road, Santacruz-Chembur Link Road and Bandra-Kurla Complex Connector.

Published by Nirmala Lakshman and Printed by S. Ramanujam at HT Media Ltd. Plot No. 8, Udyog Vihar, Greater Noida Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. 201306, on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., Chennai-600002. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA
TELANGANA RISING
CURE - PURE - RARE

RISING TOGETHER

INVEST TELANGANA GLOBAL SUMMIT 2026

7 | 8 | 9 DECEMBER 2026
BHARAT FUTURE CITY, HYDERABAD

The Invest Telangana Global Summit 2026, the flagship summit of the Government of Telangana, returns on a grander scale, bringing together global industry leaders, investors, innovators and policymakers.

The Summit brings under its umbrella the Raksha Expo, Climate Change Conclave, IndiaJoy, Startup Showcase, Product Exhibitions, Policy Conclave, Fireside Sessions and events on Telangana Culture, Heritage and Food.

RAKSHA EXPO 2026
CLIMATE CHANGE CONCLAVE
indiajoy 2026
START UP SHOWCASE

Product Exhibitions
Policy Conclave
Fireside Sessions
Telangana Culture, Heritage and Food

invest.telangana.gov.in

Naidu seeks Central aid for cyclone damage

Chief Minister appeals for continued NDRF support and an early despatch of Central team to assess damage to crops, houses, roads and power infrastructure; paddy and other crops spread across over 80,000 hectares have been damaged; Godavari delta coast bears the brunt of cyclone

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu has sought the Centre's assistance in dealing with the impact of the very severe cyclonic storm, Arnab, which crossed the Andhra Pradesh and Yanam coasts on Wednesday morning, causing extensive damage to crops, houses, roads and power infrastructure in several coastal districts.

Mr. Naidu spoke to Union Home Minister Amit Shah over the phone.

In a letter dated October 28, the Chief Minister requested continued support from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) and other Central agencies. He also sought the early deputation of a Central team to assess the damage, once the State government submits its detailed assessment.

More than 28,000 people had been evacuated from vulnerable locations and shifted to relief shelters.

180 houses damaged

The preliminary assessment put the number of damaged houses at around 180, with most of the reported damage concentrated in Konaseema district.

Strong winds uprooted more than 220 trees along the State roads alone. Close to 1,000 trees got uprooted in Visakhapatnam. Damage to road surfaces was also reported at a few coastal locations, while power supply was disrupted in parts of the affected districts.

Restoration teams were working to clear roads, repair damaged infrastructure and restore electricity.



Picking up the pieces: Fishermen try to salvage nets and boats at Odalarevu village in Konaseema district of Andhra Pradesh on Wednesday. V. RAJU

The extent of the damage was still being assessed, and the figures were expected to be revised as field reports became available.

Heavy rainfall and inundation caused damage to agriculture and horticulture crops. Paddy and other crops spread across about 70,900 hectares were reported to have been inundated or damaged. Horticulture crops covering another 10,450 hectares were also affected, taking the preliminary estimate of the total affected agricultural and horticultural area to about 81,350 hectares.

The damage was concentrated along the Godavari delta coast, particularly in Konaseema, Kakinada, East Godavari and West Godavari districts. Krishna and Anakapalli districts were also affected. Visakhapatnam resembled a war-torn zone after the rain and gusty winds brought down trees, poles, and transformers.

Showers in Telangana

Under the impact of Arnab, various parts of Telangana received showers on Wednesday. Several areas in Khammam, Mulugu, Suryapet and Bhadradri Kothagudem received between 10 mm and 21.3 mm of rainfall till early afternoon.

Nalgonda, Mahabubabad, Warangal and Jayashankar Bhuplapally received up to 10 mm rain.

AAP, Majithia spar over supplementary chargesheet filing

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH



Shiromani Akali Dal leader Bikram Singh Majithia

With the drug menace issue emerging as the key poll issue ahead of the 2027 Assembly election, the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) were embroiled in war of words on Wednesday soon after the Punjab Vigilance Bureau filed a supplementary chargesheet against senior SAD leader Bikram Singh Majithia in a disproportionate assets (DA) case before a special court in Mohali.

AAP chief and former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal said that the Punjab government is taking the fight against drugs to its conclusion by filing a chargesheet against Mr. Majithia.

The party's Punjab incharge, Manish Sisodia, said, "The chargesheet filed by Punjab Police against Bikram Singh Majithia today details how he earned ₹736 crore by selling drugs and deposited the money in the bank accounts of his companies. After this chargesheet, Majithia will rot in jail for the rest of his life."

Hitting back, Mr. Majithia accused Mr. Kejriwal of misleading Punjabis by giving the DA case the label of a drug case. "Kejriwal is attempting to divert public attention from the situation in Punjab by presenting the case against me as a drug trafficking case," he said, adding that Mr. Kejriwal had apologised in 2018 for making false allegations against him in connection with drugs. "The AAP leadership is now once again trying to link my name to the drug case for political gains. The Supreme Court had given the government time until March 18, 2025, to establish the allegations against me, but the Kejriwal-Bhagwant Mann government failed to do so," he said.

'Bundle of lies'

In a post on X, Mr. Majithia said, "No chargesheet was filed in the past five years, neither the original nor a supplementary one... This is a supplementary chargesheet in a disproportionate assets case. It took a year and a half to concoct this story, which is nothing but a bundle of lies."

In the FIR, the Vigilance Bureau claimed the investigations revealed that more than ₹540 crore of "drug money" had been laundered through several channels allegedly facilitated by Mr. Majithia. The FIR stemmed from an investigation by a Punjab Police special investigation team into a 2021 drug case.

Will identify lapses, says Karnataka Cong. after MLC poll loss

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka Congress will conduct a comprehensive review of its organisational shortcomings, said State Pradesh Congress Committee president B.K. Hariprasad, after losing all four Legislative Council constituencies for graduates and teachers that went to the polls on October 23.

In a post on X, Mr. Hariprasad said the Congress had been confident of winning all four seats, but the results went against its expectations. The party had accepted the verdict and would use it as an opportunity for introspection, he said.

The BJP-Janata Dal (Secular) alliance won the Bengaluru and North East Teachers' constituencies as well as the Karnataka South East and Karnataka West Graduates' seats.

The Congress earlier held one of the four seats.



B.K. Hariprasad

The results strip the Congress of its majority in the Upper House. With the fresh mandate, the Congress has 37 members in the 75-member Upper House – one seat down.

The JD(S) has increased its tally from six to seven while the BJP, after retaining all the three seats, has steadied its strength at 24.

The Congress, however, has an opportunity to increase its tally since five seats nominated by the government are yet to be filled.

'Enlightened electorate'

Describing graduates and teachers as an "enlightened segment of the electorate", Mr. Hariprasad said the party would examine why it had failed to win their confidence and identify shortcomings in understanding their expectations, communicating its positions and maintaining sustained engagement with them.

The review would also examine the State government's response to concerns raised by teachers and graduates, including job insecurity, challenges in the education system and issues affecting their professional interests, the PCC president said.

Mr. Hariprasad said the party would assess whether its government's welfare programmes and the Congress's political positions had been effectively communicated to voters. "The result heightens our responsibility to shape our organisational functioning, public outreach and political strategies more effectively," he said.

INBRIEF



Bengaluru Metro gears up to open new elevated corridor

Bangalore Metro Rail Corporation Limited (BMRCL) has obtained the much-awaited safety clearance for the elevated portion of the Metro Pink Line between Kalena Agrahara and Tavarekere, Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda said on Wednesday. He said BMRCL will launch the service as soon as the Centre gives a date for inauguration. The Pink Line is a 21.25 km north-south corridor from Kalena Agrahara to Nagawara. The 7.5-km elevated corridor has six stations. PTI

Nod for Vigilance probe into KIIFB's Kannur land deal

The Keralam Cabinet on Wednesday decided to recommend a Vigilance probe into alleged lapses in the acquisition of land in Kannur district by the Kerala Infrastructure Investment Fund Board (KIIFB). The decision follows a finding by an expert committee that the land acquisition by the KIIFB was skewed. The committee, as part of its scrutiny of KIIFB operations based on a government decision, had questioned the Board's decision to acquire land in Kannur and Palakkad districts.

Man sentenced to 20-year RI for sexually assaulting minor

A 25-year-old man was sentenced to 20 years of rigorous imprisonment by the L.B. Nagar fast-track court in Telangana on Wednesday for sexually abusing a minor girl. According to the prosecution case, the minor girl's mother, who is the complainant, was in a live-in relationship with Jarpula Ganesh. The minor girl, who was also living with them, was repeatedly sexually abused by Ganesh. On October 29, 2024, Ganesh allegedly took the complainant and her daughter to an isolated location and attempted to sexually assault the minor. He fled after the mother raised an alarm, the police said.

3 fishermen in Gokarna dead after inhaling toxic gas

Press Trust of India
KARWAR

Three fishermen were killed and two were hospitalised after inhaling toxic gas while clearing decomposed fish waste from a boat at the Tadadi harbour near Gokarna in Karnataka's Uttara Kannada district on Tuesday.

A 64-year-old fisherman is in a critical condition. According to the police, they were cleaning the storage compartment of the boat when they collapsed. Fisheries Minister K.S. Basavanthappa visited the bereaved families and handed over cheques for ₹10 lakh each to the kin of the deceased.

Come rain or shine



Members of the National Rural Livelihoods Mission's Sanjeevini Okkoota stage a protest at the Freedom Park in Bengaluru on Wednesday. They have demanded that their honorarium be credited directly to their bank accounts. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Maritime Bill passed in Keralam; Opposition walks out

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam Assembly on Wednesday passed the Keralam Maritime Board (Amendment) Bill, 2026, despite a walkout by the Opposition Left Democratic Front.

The Bill provides for restructuring the State Maritime Board, setting up a Maritime Land Bank and an enforcement wing, and revising contracts for 17 port projects. It will become law after receiving the Governor's assent.

Opposing the Bill, Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan said it dealt a blow to the right to life and to livelihood of coastal people guaranteed by the Constitution. The provision to set up a land bank – comprising land under the control of the State – for townships and other projects would lead to their eviction from the land where they parked boats, dried nets, and repaired vessels.

'Corporate takeover'

Mr. Vijayan alleged that constructions along the coast and private tourism projects that went against coastal protection laws would destroy the marine ecosystem. The Bill would hand over the State's coast to corporate mafia, he said, before walking out.

In his reply, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan refuted the Opposition allegations that all land under the control of the State government would be transferred to the board. The Bill specified that the land within port limits would come under the land bank, he said.

(With PTI inputs)

Kochi police chief shifted amid probe into car crash involving judge's minor son

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

Amid widespread outrage over the Cheranalloor car crash case, the Keralam government removed S. Kaliraj Mahesh Kumar as the District Police Chief (Kochi City) on Wednesday.

A 55-year-old man was killed at Cheranalloor in Kochi after he was mowed down by a luxury car allegedly driven by the 17-year-old son of an additional judge on October 25. After the incident, the police were accused of mishandling the case.

Mr. Kumar is likely to be replaced by R. Nishanthini, who is at present serving as IGP (South Zone). The move comes a day after the government suspended four police officers attached to the Cheranalloor police station based on a report submitted by ADGP P. Vijayan.

Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala is reportedly, unhappy with the manner in which the City Police handled the case, particularly the invocation of relatively minor charges against the accused teenager. He had also conceded in the Assembly the lapses on the part of the police in handling the case.

Meanwhile, the police carried out an overnight search operation at the judge's apartment in Aluva, which continued till Wednesday morning.

Judge questioned

The police on Wednesday questioned the judge who was also booked in the case with his 17-year-old son. The questioning went on till late in the evening.

Though the teenager was booked under Section 105 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for culpable homicide not amounting to murder and taken into custody, he was subsequently granted bail by the Juvenile Justice Board.

Former KPSC official held; chief questioned

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Crime Branch investigating the alleged irregularities in an examination conducted by the Kerala Public Service Commission (PSC) arrested a former deputy secretary, P. Satheesh, in connection with the case on Wednesday.

Mr. Satheesh, who was recently named an accused in the case pertaining to a Kerala State Planning Board examination, was apprehended from his home in Kozhikode. This is the first arrest in the case.

The accused, who had retired from service last year, was reportedly in charge of the PSC's examination wing and responsible for the evaluation process of the controversial examination.

SIT probe

The Special Investigation Team (SIT) under the Crime Branch had recently booked the retired official, along with another senior PSC functionary, R. Hari, additional secretary, in the case.

Kerala PSC chairperson M.R. Baiju was questioned by the SIT led by S. Ajeetha Begum. Mr. Baiju reported at the Crime Branch headquarters, adjacent to the State Police headquarters, with police escort around 2 p.m. The official, whose questioning lasted over five hours, left the premises around 8 p.m.

Mob attacks buffalo traders in M.P.; FIRs filed against victims, unknown persons

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The police said the incident took place on suspicion of buffalo theft and the two traders, driver and the van owner were booked for 'animal cruelty'

Two Muslim traders and a van driver were assaulted by a mob, allegedly workers of Hindutva outfits, in Madhya Pradesh's Damoh district for transporting buffaloes, with videos of the incident surfacing online. The police have registered two cases in the matter, including against the injured over alleged animal cruelty, officers said on Wednesday.

According to the police, the incident took place in Hardua village under Hindoriya police station range on October 26 evening when Abid Qureshi and Hasan Qureshi, both local traders, were transporting buffaloes in a vehicle and were stopped by a group of people.

Damoh Superintendent of Police Anand Kaladagi told *The Hindu* that the incident took place on suspicion of buffalo theft. He said both the traders, driver, and the van owner were booked for animal cruelty, while a separate FIR was lodged against unknown persons based on the video clips and a complaint from the victims.

"We have identified some people through the video clips and are working to arrest them. The traders were booked because the animals were being transported in a poor condition in a small van," he said.

The purported clips show a mob dragging the two traders through a field and assaulting them with sticks. In one of the clips, a man is seen recording the victims' statement on a phone, and as one of the victims says they were beaten up, some men start thrashing them again with sticks asking, "Did we beat you?"

Mr. Abid, who spoke to reporters in the hospital, said they had shown the purchase receipt to those who stopped them to prove that they were not transporting stolen buffaloes.

"They did not listen to us so we started running but they caught and beat us. We got some relief when the police arrived," he said, with injury marks visible on his face and other parts of body.

Members of the Muslim community also staged a demonstration at the SP's office and demanded strict action against the accused.

MLC polls: BJP wins 6, SP 3 in U.P.; NDA set to bag 4 in Bihar

Ruling Mahayuti wins two seats in Maharashtra, MVA secures one seat; results and trends pour in for Council elections to seats held across Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Maharashtra on October 23

Mayank Kumar
Amit Bhelari
Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
LUCKNOW/PATNA/MUMBAI


Tight security at the counting centre for the Gorakhpur-Faizabad Teachers' constituency election, in Gorakhpur on Wednesday. ANI

Results and trends poured in on Wednesday for polls to Legislative Council seats held across Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, and Maharashtra on October 23. Though counting began on Tuesday, it continued till late on Wednesday in several seats.

In U.P., where voting was held for six Teachers' and five Graduates' constituencies, results of nine of the 11 seats were declared. According to the Election Commission of India, BJP-backed candidates won six seats and the Samajwadi Party (SP) three.

The Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) said the declared winners are – BJP candidates Dinesh Kumar Goyal (Meerut Graduates'), Manvendra Pratap Singh (Agra Graduates'), Umesh Dwivedi (Lucknow Teachers'), Chand Sharma (Meerut Teachers'), Hari Singh Dhillon (Bareilly-Moradabad Teachers') and Dhruv Kumar Tripathi (Gorakhpur-Faizabad Teachers'); and SP candidates Lal Bihari Yadav (Varanasi Teachers'), Akash Agrawal (Agra Teachers') and Man Singh Yadav (Allahabad-Jhansi Graduates').

Earlier, there was uproar over "slow counting" and allegations that officials were favouring the BJP candidate in the Gorakhpur-Faizabad Teachers' constituency. Following this, the CEO asked the Returning Officer to reply to posts on X about some candidates boycotting the election process.

SP chief Akhilesh Yadav alleged that counting was stopped in Varanasi Graduates' seat and accused the BJP of "foul play". "Everyone understands the conspiracy behind stopping or slowing down voting in Varanasi, but the BJP will not succeed. Every trick is being played out to prevent the BJP's defeat in Varanasi from becoming national news. If the BJP does not know how to win honestly, then it should at least learn to lose honestly," he said in a post on X.

In Bihar, results of six of eight seats were declared. The NDA is set to win four seats, Independents two, and the Jan Suraaj Party and the RJD one each.

JD(U)'s Neeraj Kumar retained the Patna Graduates' seat, which was in focus after Mokama MLA Anant Singh was expelled from the JD(U) for campaigning against the party candidate. The BJP lost the Patna Teachers' seat after 30 years to the RJD. The Congress lost its Darbhanga Teachers' seat to the Jan Suraaj Party. In Saran Teachers' seat, Independent Aafaq Ahmad lost to Independent Rahul Raj, a rebel BJP leader. In Tirhut Teacher' seats, BJP's Narendra Kumar Singh defeated CPI's sitting MLC Sanjay Kumar Singh. In Kosi Graduates' seat, BJP's N.K. Yadav defeated RJD's Nitesh Kumar Yadav. BJP's Sarvesh Kumar is leading in Darbhanga Graduates' seat and Independent Bansidhar Brajwasi in Tirhut Graduates' constituency.

Mahayuti 2, MVA 1

In Maharashtra, where polling was held for three Graduates' and two Teachers' seats, results of three seats were declared by the Maharashtra Chief Electoral Officer late on Wednesday night. The ruling Mahayuti won two seats: Pune Teachers' seat (BJP) and the Amravati Teachers' seat (Shiv Sena). The Opposition Maha Vikas Aghadi also opened its account, with the NCP (SP) winning the Pune Graduates' constituency, where the party's Harshada Deshmukh Jadhav defeated BJP's Smita Jadhav and Shiv Sena (UBT)'s Sunil Modi.

Chennai police issue Look Out Circular against Veeramani's daughter Archana

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI


Gem Granites founder R. Veeramani. FILE PHOTO

The Greater Chennai Police (GCP) have issued a Look Out Circular (LOC) against Archana Veeramani, daughter of Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani, restraining her from travelling abroad, police sources said on Tuesday.

Ms. Archana, who was taken into custody by the Special Investigation Team (SIT) at the Chennai International Airport after she boarded a flight to Singapore on October 23, was questioned and allowed to leave after she complained of illness.

"We believe she is aware of certain suspicious money transactions done to help her father evade legal action," a police officer said, explaining the reason for the issuance of the LOC.

Veeramani, his associate Shanthi and others face eight cases under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

A couple of days ago, the police issued LOCs against five persons, including Ms. Archana, to prevent them from escaping to a foreign country. The SIT said the individuals could be in possession of evidence relating to the cases.

Efforts were still being made to trace Prakash Kanniah, who has absconded and is believed to be staying in the United Kingdom, the sources said.

Bank accounts frozen

Meanwhile, the police have frozen the bank accounts of Veeramani's business establishments. They had already frozen the bank accounts of Mr. Kanniah and a couple of others.

"We have already come across a few suspicious transactions. Freezing the bank accounts is to prevent the use of money to influence or intimidate the witnesses or tamper with the evidence," said an officer who did not want to be quoted.

The SIT was in the process of filing a chargesheet in the designated court for the cases. "We will seek maximum punishment for the accused persons," the officer said.

Second phase of rural polls in Rajasthan takes place amid EVM glitches

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

Villagers in 22 districts of Rajasthan participated enthusiastically in the second phase of polling to elect the zila parishad and panchayat samiti members on Wednesday. The voting was conducted for 352 wards of 22 zila parishads and 2,197 wards of 124 panchayat samitis.

The highest voter turnout was recorded at 70.10% at Railmagra in Rajsamand district, followed by 69.71% at Chirawa in Jhunjhunu district. An average of 68.69% voter turnout was recorded in Jaipur district. The candidates contesting on the symbols of mainstream parties faced a challenge from the Independents. The polling was held in Ajmer, Alwar, Banswara, Barmer, Bhilwara, Bikaner, Dausa, Dungarpur, Jaipur, Jalore, Jhalawar, Jhunjhunu, Jodhpur, Karauli, Kota, Kotputli-Behror, Nagaur, Pali, Rajsamand, Sikar, Sirohi and Udaipur.

There are over 1.06 crore voters in these districts. Polling was delayed at some places because of technical glitches in the electronic voting machines (EVMs). The remaining phases of polls are scheduled for November 3 and 14.

UP POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD.,
ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION DESIGN CIRCLE
10th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extn., Lucknow

E-Tender Notice

--Invites Open Tender--
for
"DESIGN, DETAILED ENGINEERING, MANUFACTURE, SUPPLY OF 220 KV CABLE WITH ACCESSORIES, CABLE LAYING, ERECTION OF JOINTS & TERMINATIONS OF UNDERGROUND SECTION of 220 KV YEIDA SEC 18 (220 KV)-NOIDA INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT T/L & 220 KV JEWAR(SECTOR-32)-NOIDA INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LINE AND FINAL TESTING & COMMISSIONING ON TURN-KEY BASIS"

Tender Specification no-TD-566/26
Bid Portal (Download & Submission): https://etender.up.nic.in.
Bidding: Online, EMD: ₹ 52.15 Lacs
Estimated cost of work: ₹ 52.15 Cr.
Completion Period: 09 Months

KEY DATES:

Online Bid Submission Start: 28/10/2026
Online Bid Submission Closing: 20/11/2026 at 15:30 Hrs.
Bidders are advised to visit E-Portal regularly for amendments/corrigendum's etc.

Superintending Engineer, Electricity Transmission Design Circle
E-Mail: seetdc@upptcl.org **Tele: (0522) 2286759, 2218645**

TO ADVERTISE PLEASE CONTACT
Mr. N SELVA KUMAR
PH: 9820350726
selvakumar.n@thehindu.co.in
THE HINDU
India's National Newspaper

Odisha Police - Office of the D.G & I.G. of Police, Odisha, Kataka
Tel. : 0671-2304001, Website : police.odisha.gov.in , Email : igops.orpol@od.gov.in
RFP No. 25-RFP- AMC - 2026-2027 Date : 27.10.2026

Online Bids through e-Tender Portal **https://tendersodisha.gov.in** are invited from the eligible bidders for a Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for Containerised Tubular Shooting Range (CTSR) for Odisha Police as per the schedule mentioned below.

Sl.No.	Name of Project
1.	Request For Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Agency for Annual Maintenance Contract for Containerized Tubular Shooting Range (CTSR) For Odisha Police

Events	Date
RFP Issue Date	27.10.2026
Date & Time of Pre Bid meeting Queries to be submit on Mail ID: igops.orpol@od.gov.in by Date : 31.10.2026 by 05.00 PM.	In this connection a Pre-Bid meeting will be held in virtual mode based on the request received from Bidder and the link will be sent through mail for the meeting. The Pre-Bid date is tentatively in nature and subject to postponement which will be duly informed through mail: igops.orpol@od.gov.in . Venue_ Operations Hdqrs., SIW Campus, SW Building, Keshari Nagar, Unit-V, BBSR, Khurda, PIN-751001.
RFP Submission Due Date and time	17.11.2026
Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	18.11.2026
Bid to RA enabled	Yes
Date of opening of Financial Proposal	To be informed of technically qualified bidders
Expected Date of Commencement of Assignment	To be informed later
Bid Document Fee (Non-Refundable)	Bid Document Fee (Non-Refundable) (As Demand Draft from any scheduled commercial bank/nationalized bank in the name of "AIG of Police (Provisioning)" payable at "Kataka") of Rs.590/- (Rupees five Hundred Ninety only) (including GST). Note: Scanned copy of the Demand Draft as applicable must be uploaded, and a physical copy of the same must be submitted to: AIG of Police (Prov.), State Police Headquarters, Buxibazar, Kataka, Odisha
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (Refundable)	EMD (Refundable) (As Demand Draft from any scheduled commercial bank/ nationalized bank in the name of "AIG of Police (Provisioning)" payable at "Cuttack") of Rs. 1,05,000/-(Rupees One Lakh five Thousand Only). Note: Scanned copy of the Demand Draft as applicable must be uploaded, and a physical copy of the same must be submitted to:"A.I.G. of Police (Prov.), Odisha, Kataka Kataka, State Police Headquarters Odisha, Kataka"
Performance Security (As Bank Guarantee from any scheduled commercial bank/nationalized bank in the name of Police Department, Odisha)	5% of the over all contract value. The performance security (in case of Bank Guarantee) shall remain valid for a period of minimum (38) Thirty-eight months from the date of supply of items.
RFP can be downloaded from	https://police.odisha.gov.in/ ; https://tendersodisha.gov.in/

The bid document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, Prequalification criteria and terms & conditions are available in the websites: https://tendersodisha.gov.in.The Authority reserves the right to accept / reject any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason thereof.

A.I.G. of Police (Provisioning), Odisha, Kataka. (Tender Calling Authority)
12001/187/2627 OIPR-12001/12029/1/26-27/0042

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
PUDUKKOTTAI CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
E- TENDER NOTICE

Roc.No.9620/2026/E1 **Dated:- 27.10.2026**

Bid is invited by the Corporation Commissioner, General Fund 2026-2027 Selection of Service Provider for Collection & Transportation of Solid Waste through various activities to the Designated Processing Facility/Dump Site/ Depositing Centres and Operation and Maintenance of Micro Composting Centres (MCCs) in Pudukkottai City Municipal Corporation (Two cover system)

1. Work value :- **1. Rs.2644.00 Lakhs**
2. Earnest Money Deposit Amount- **Rs.26,44,000/-**

3.Bid document can be downloaded from the website **https://tntenders.gov.in** at free of cost and the full details of the tenders can be had from the above website.

4. Common date & time

1	Date and time for downloading bid document	30.10.2026 From 11.00 Am
2	Date and Time for the pre-bid meeting	13.11 .2026 - 11.00 AM
3	Last Date and time for submission of bid document, including online submission	30.11.2026 upto 3.00 PM
4	Date and time of opening of the Technical Bid	30.11.2026 at 3.30 PM

In the event of specified date for submission of bids is declared a holiday, bids will be received and opened on the next working day at the same time and venue.

Commissioner
Pudukkottai City Municipal Corporation

DIPR / 3285 / TENDER / 2026

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
MUNICIPAL ADMINISTRATION AND WATER SUPPLY DEPARTMENT
KARUR CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Tel: 04324 - 260011

Bids for Selection of Service Provider for Collection & Transportation of Solid Waste through various activities to the Designated Processing Facility/ Dump Site / Depositing Centres and Operation and Maintenance of Micro Composting Centres (MCCs) in Karur City Municipal Corporation for 18 months
(Roc. H1/5334/ 2026, Dated: 28.10.2026)

1. Bids are invited from eligible and reputed agencies for the Selection of Service Provider for Collection & Transportation of Solid Waste through various activities to the Designated Processing Facility/ Dump Site/ Depositing Centres and Operation and Maintenance of Micro Composting Centres (MCCs) in Karur City Municipal Corporation
2. The details of the bid shall be obtained from web portal: **www.tntenders.gov.in** and Corporation website. **www.tnurbantree.tn.gov.in/karur**
3. The tender document shall be downloaded from **29.10.2026** from the portal **www.tntenders.gov.in**
4. Pre-bid meeting will be on **12.11.2026 at 11.30 AM** at Karur City Municipal Corporation.
5. The last date for downloading the tender document and the last date for uploading / submission of filled up tender document is up to **3.00 P.M. on 30.11.2026**
6. The received bids will be opened at 3.30 P.M. on 30.11.2026 at the office of Karur City Municipal Corporation.
7. The value of each project, Bid Security – (RTGS/e-BG), and the eligibility criteria for the bidder etc., are given in the bid document.

Commissioner
Karur City Municipal Corporation

DIPR/3289/TENDER/2026

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, KANUPUR IRRIGATION PROJECT
AT/PO-BASUDEVPUR, DIST-KENDUJHAR, ODISHA, PIN-758047
e-mail: ccekipbpur@gmail.com

"e"- PROCUREMENT NOTICE - Bid Identification No.: CCE, KIP (KCD-I)-15/2026-27
(Pertaining to Kanpur Canal Division- I&II, Jhumpura/Rimuli)

1.	Nature of Work	Civil Work
2.	Number of works	01 (One No. of Work)
3.	Name of Work	Construction of Distribution System for 2482.16 ha. of CCA including Command area Development (CAD) of Kanupur Irrigation Project through Underground Pipeline Irrigation system including survey, investigation, planning, Design and Estimate Operation and Maintenance on complete Commissioned Project on "EPC" mode for 05(five) years in Kendujhar District of Odisha.
4.	Approximate Amount Put to tender	Rs.5720.84 Lakhs including O&M Cost
5.	Period of completion	12 (Twelve) Calendar Months including Rainy Season
6.	Class of Contractor	"Super" Class as per Detailed Tender Call Notice
7.	Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Dt.29.10.2026 from 10.00 Hours to Dt.26.11.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
8.	Last date & time of seeking tender clarification	Dt.10.11.2026 through email up to 17:00 Hours.
9.	Date & time for Pre-bid Conference	Dt.13.11.2026 at 11.30 Hours.
10	Last date & Time for receipt of bids in the portal	26.11.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
11	Date & Time of Opening of Tender (Technical Bid) (Cover-I)	27.11.2026 at 11.00 Hours in O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Kanupur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur
12	Date & Time of Opening of Tender (Financial Bids) (Cover-II)	To be intimated after Evaluation of Technical Bid.
13	Name and address of the Officer Inviting Bid	Er.Mahendra Kumar Behera, Chief Construction Engineer, Kanupur Irrigation Project, At/Po.- Basudevpur, Dist.- Kendujhar, Odisha - 758047.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal "**https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in**".

(Er.Mahendra Kumar Behera) Chief Construction Engineer,
Kanupur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur, Kendujhar, Odisha

32001/1171/2627 OIPR-32001/32376/1/26-27/0011

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
MUNICIPAL ADMINSTRATION AND WATER SUPPLY DEPARTMENT
Tiruvannamalai City Municipal Corporation

Tender Notice

Bids for Selection of Service Provider for Collection & Transportation of Solid Waste through various activities to the Designated Processing Facility/ Dump Site/ Depositing Centres and Operation and Maintenance of Micro Composting Centres (MCCs) in Tiruvannamalai City Municipal Corporation for 18 months.

(Roc.No. 8845/2026/H1, Dated: 28.10.2026)

1. Bids are invited from eligible and reputed agencies for the Selection of Service Provider for Collection & Transportation of Solid Waste through various activities to the Designated Processing Facility/ Dump Site/ Depositing Centres and Operation and Maintenance of Micro Composting Centres (MCCs) in Tiruvannamalai City Municipal Corporation. Estimate Amount Rs.3078.00 lakhs
2. The details of the bid shall be obtained from web portal: **www.tntenders.gov.in**
3. The tender document shall be downloaded from 29.10.2026 from the portal **www.tntenders.gov.in**
4. Pre-bid meeting will be on 11.11.2026 at 3.00 PM at Tiruvannamalai City Municipal Corporation.
5. The last date for downloading the tender document and the last date for uploading / submission of filled up tender document is up to 3.00 P.M. on 30.11.2026
6. The received bids will be opened at 3.30 P.M. on 30.11.2026 at the office of Tiruvannamalai City Municipal Corporation
7. The value of EMD Rs.30,78,000/– (RTGS/e-BG), and the eligibility criteria for the bidder etc., are given in the web portal: **www.tntenders.gov.in.**

COMMISSIONER
Tiruvannamalai City Municipal Corporation

DIPR/3284Tender/2026

भारतीय सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान, पुणे
Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune
(An Institute of National Importance under the Ministry of Education, Government of India)

RECRUITMENT – 2026

IIIT Pune invites applications from Indian Nationals for the following regular positions:

TEACHING POSITIONS

Post	Pay Level	Vacancies	Advertisement No.
Assistant Professor Grade-I	12	06	IIITP/T/2026/1
Assistant Professor Grade-II	10	11	IIITP/T/2026/2

NON-TEACHING POSITIONS

Post	Pay Level	Vacancies	Advertisement No.
Junior Superintendent	6	06	IIITP/NT/Rectt./2026/1
Junior Engineer (Civil)	6	01	IIITP/NT/Rectt./2026/2
Junior Engineer (Electrical)	6	01	IIITP/NT/Rectt./2026/3

Applicants should have an excellent academic record with relevant experience as mentioned in the detailed advertisements available at **https://www.iiitp.ac.in/careers**
Last date for submission of online applications: 28th November 2026.

Sd/-
Registrar (I/c)

GOVT. OF BIHAR
BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD
I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.
Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

UNDER GRADUATE MEDICAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING
(UGMAC)-2026 for MBBS/ BDS/ B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. in Govt. Medical / Dental / Veterinary Colleges / College of Fisheries and Private Medical / Dental Colleges of Bihar

Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/17 Dated 28.10.2026

Notice regarding Extended Online Counselling Programme for Stray Vacancy Round

In continuation to Adv. No. BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/16 dated 22.10.2026, it is informed to all eligible & interested NEET(UG)-2026 qualified candidates and all concerned that Provisional Seat Allotment Result for Stray Vacancy Round Counselling of UGMAC-2026 has been published on Board's website.

The counselling programme for Stray Vacancy Round Counselling is hereby Re-scheduled as follows;

Sl.	Programme	Re-scheduled Date
i.	**Stray Vacancy Round Provisional Seat Allotment Result publication date**	: **28.10.2026**
ii.	Downloading of Allotment order	: **28.10.2026 to 31.10.2026**
iii.	**Documents Verification and Admission (Stray Vacancy Round)**	: **29.10.2026 to 31.10.2026**

2. Rest of the terms / conditions of Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/14 Dated 18.10.2026 and 2026/16 dated 22.10.2026 will remain the same.

Controller of Examination

Hunker down

Proactive governance kept the casualties low after Cyclone Arnab

Cyclone Arnab, the first named storm of the North Indian Ocean cyclone season this year, intensified rapidly before making landfall as a 'very severe cyclonic storm' on October 28. This particular rapidity is a challenge for forecasters and some models did fail to anticipate how strong Arnab would become. It also moved faster than expected towards the coast, before stalling for a time and beginning the landfall process several hours before the India Meteorological Department (IMD) had predicted it would, in the middle of the night, leaving many district authorities with a potentially narrower window to evacuate high-risk settlements. With core wind speeds of 125-135 kilometres per hour, it delivered more than 100 mm of rain over parts of Anakapalli, Visakhapatnam, Kalingapatnam, Kakinada and Machilipatnam, in Andhra Pradesh. But even though it has completed landfall, southern Odisha likely faces a greater threat only hence. Early reports claimed no loss of life in Andhra Pradesh or Odisha, which has been attributed to the disaster management operations in both States; the Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister, N. Chandrababu Naidu, said there were five deaths in Andhra Pradesh. Regrettably, the suspension of transport services, including road connectivity and flights, closure of schools and offices, and power cuts to minimise risks posed by loose wires remains an essential part of saving lives, entailing other social and economic disruptions that the States must account for, and address, in their post-storm assessments.

Odisha may have to brace for rainfall and waters due to moisture in the storm's outer circulation, which will arrive over land that has recovered in patches from the fourth wettest monsoon in the State's history. Extreme rainfall after repeated flooding may face soil that has not drained fully, raising the risk of more flooding following even lower levels of rainfall, and slope failures in hilly terrain. Farmers in Ganjam and Puri have already voiced worries about the risk of prolonged inundation destroying paddy crops, compounding the already considerable financial consequences of the southwest monsoon; Ganjam alone had lost 33% of crops by October. In Sundargarh, however, farmers hope that Arnab will relieve moisture stress in standing crops after a dry month. The IMD has already issued alerts in the Ganjam, Gajapati, Rayagada, Koraput, Malkangiri, Nabarangpur, and Kalahandi districts, before the rainbelt extends further north. The relatively low figure of deaths will be a testament to proactive governance. However, it is past time that States adopted a zero-disruption approach, especially since property and infrastructure were damaged, and the risk of people being pushed into poverty over lost possessions and livelihoods persists.

Clinging on

Netanyahu's continuance will be bad news for Israel and the region

Benjamin Netanyahu was at the centre of Israel's October 27 elections. For Israel's longest-serving Prime Minister, who oversaw a genocidal war in Gaza following Hamas's October 7 attack, the election was the biggest test of his political career. For the Opposition, which promised to hold him accountable for the failures of October 7 and end the country's "forever wars", the election offered an opportunity to oust him from power. The results, however, sent a mixed message. With 85.6% of the votes counted, Mr. Netanyahu's right-religious coalition has lost its majority but is still the largest bloc. His Likud party is projected to win 26 seats, while its main rival Yashar, led by former military chief Gadi Eisenkot, is expected to secure 21. Otzma Yehudit and Religious Zionism, the far-right extremist parties in Mr. Netanyahu's coalition, demonstrated their continued strength, winning 13 seats between them. The dark horse, however, could be the Arab parties – the Joint List is projected to win 12 seats while the United Arab List (Ra'am) could secure seven seats. With neither bloc commanding a majority, the Arab parties could propel the opposition coalition to power. But the big question is whether the anti-Netanyahu coalition is ready to join hands with the Arab parties, which have historically been kept on the margins of Israel' s power politics.

Mr. Netanyahu's central promise has been that only he can guarantee Israel's security. Yet, the October 7 attack took place on his watch and he has refused to take responsibility for the failures that led to it. A wanted man by the International Criminal Court, he has repeated, before and after October 7, that a Palestine state would not be formed while he is in power. His war on Gaza has killed over 70,000 Palestinians, including 20,000 children, and displaced the region's population. Israel's brutal occupation machinery has also expanded and tightened its control of the West Bank, while settler terrorists have unleashed violence on Palestinian households. His war on Iran has been a disaster, with global economic consequences. Mr. Netanyahu has sought to portray his wars as bold, necessary moves to protect Israel, while exploiting Israelis' security concerns for political gain. He may not be voted out immediately, but his failure to secure a majority and the decline in his party's popularity are significant. The Opposition should take its cue from the results and form a broad coalition with the Arab parties. It should restore accountability in governance, revisit his unchecked militarism and rebuild ties with the world. If Mr. Netanyahu continues to cling to power, it would be bad news for Israel and the region.

The SIR verdict, serious constitutional questions



Bishwajit Bhattacharyya

Senior Advocate, Supreme Court of India, and a former Additional Solicitor General of India

The top court must ensure fairness in electoral roll revisions

Did the Supreme Court of India err in its verdict dated May 27, 2026, on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls by empowering the Election Commission of India (ECI) to undertake a "limited" inquiry into citizenship for the inclusion of names in, or their exclusion from, the electoral rolls?

Second, can crystallised electoral rolls be unsettled in subsequent elections by deleting names on suspicion?

These questions arise in the context of the electoral rolls in Bihar, published on January 6, 2025, following the ECI's Special Summary Revision (SSR).

On June 24, 2025, the ECI decided to undertake a fresh SIR, beginning with Bihar. Thus, every electoral roll in Bihar between January 1, 2003 (the date of the last SIR in Bihar), and January 6, 2025 (the date of the last SSR, in Bihar), was, in effect, called into question by the ECI. This was unnecessary, as the ECI, in any case, periodically updates the electoral rolls efficiently.

This unusual exercise effectively called into question the electoral rolls used in every election held in Bihar between 2003 and 2025.

Consequently, in Bihar, the SSR dated January 6, 2025, was superseded by the SIR ordered on June 24, 2025.

The ECI's notification dated June 24, 2025, was challenged before the Court. However, the challenge was unsuccessful, with the Court endorsing the ECI's stand in its verdict dated May 27, 2026.

Even before the Court delivered its verdict on May 27, 2026, Assembly elections were held in Bihar in November 2025 and West Bengal in April 2026, following the ECI's SIR exercise, which entailed mass deletions and surprising inclusions of voters. Widespread dissatisfaction prevailed.

The SIR is now being implemented in other States amid protests.

The ECI's powers

The Court's verdict clarified that the ECI has not been empowered to determine citizenship in the "strict sense". The Court held that the power of the ECI affects an "individual's entitlement to be included in the electoral roll". It also held: "It does not, however, operate to divest the individual of claims of citizenship, nor does it foreclose a determination of that question by the competent authority under the Citizenship Act."

With respect, the words "limited" and "strict sense", in the context of an inquiry into citizenship, carry no legal significance, even as *obiter dicta* of the Court.

And the statement that the "power of ECI" "affects" an "individual's entitlement" to be "included in the electoral roll" is not capable of any interpretation other than that the ECI has the power to disenfranchise an existing voter.

This seems to give *carte blanche* to the ECI. Little wonder, then, that the ECI has been proceeding to alter the existing electoral rolls nonchalantly.

Enquiry means enquiry, no less; citizenship means citizenship, no less. The ECI's constitutional authority to inquire into citizenship remains contentious. Even a limited inquiry risks exceeding the ECI's electoral mandate. The Court seems to have erred.

While preparing the electoral roll, the ECI's function is limited only to ensuring that every person included is an adult Indian citizen.

The minimum age (18 years) and Indian citizenship are required to be ensured through documents. The ECI's role is strictly ministerial; it has no authority to conduct any inquiry – limited or otherwise – into citizenship. The problem, however, arises because no single document conclusively proves citizenship.

In other words, the Court vested the ECI with unguided discretion to remove a name from an existing electoral roll on the grounds of suspicious Indian citizenship. This amounts to a citizen, whose name was already on the electoral roll as of January 6, 2025, and who was presumed to be an Indian citizen, being disenfranchised by the ECI through the SIR process with effect from July 1, 2025.

Documents, citizenship, deletion

The Court's verdict did not even specify any document that could serve as proof of Indian citizenship.

Significantly, however, paragraph 158 of the Court's verdict reads, *inter alia*: "... it may not be out of place to note that a Ration Card, unlike a Passport or Birth Certificate, is certainly not a conclusive proof of citizenship..." Thus, the Court has ruled that a passport or birth certificate is conclusive proof of citizenship.

Is this why the Ministry of External Affairs, during a press briefing marking Passport Seva Divas on June 24, 2026, made the controversial statement that a passport was merely a travel document and not proof of Indian citizenship?

Could the Court not have, in the exercise of its jurisdiction, specified the documents that prove Indian citizenship? Or, could the Court not have issued a writ of mandamus directing the government to specify the documents that prove Indian citizenship?

The Court did neither, belying the hopes of every Indian citizen whose citizenship is questioned by the ECI.

How does one prove one's Indian citizenship? This question still cannot be answered clearly, yet the ECI can disenfranchise a person who has already voted in the last election merely on the grounds of doubts about their Indian citizenship.

On what basis have electoral rolls in India been prepared since January 26, 1950? How can an electoral roll used in a concluded election be altered on the grounds of suspicion? How can a person be disenfranchised after having voted in the previous election? What is the constitutional benchmark for disenfranchising an existing voter? These are questions that the Court could have considered.

The Supreme Court's powers are extensive under Article 32 (the right to constitutional remedies and the Court's power to issue writs for the enforcement of fundamental rights), Article 141 (the binding nature of the law declared by the Court on all courts in India), Article 142 (the power to pass orders necessary to do complete justice in any cause or matter pending before it), and Article 144 (the obligation of all civil and judicial authorities in India to act in aid of the Court). The Court can surely still set right this legal vacuum by clearly laying down a yardstick for establishing Indian citizenship.

Adulthood and Indian citizenship are the only two – repeat, only two – qualifications required for inclusion in the electoral roll. The Constitution does not prescribe any third mandatory qualification.

The question of disqualification arises only after identifying qualified voters. Only a person who is otherwise qualified can be disqualified.

Article 326 specifies the grounds for disqualification: "non-residence", "unsoundness of mind", "crime", or "corrupt or illegal practice".

The Representation of the People Act, 1950, and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, must comply with Article 326 of the Constitution. The overriding principles of natural justice must also be followed when disqualifying a qualified voter.

The name of a qualified voter simply cannot be removed from the electoral roll without a pre-decisional hearing.

Protecting franchise

Free and fair elections are part of the basic structure of India's Constitution. India's potential to emerge as a world power cannot be realised if this foundation and structure is weakened. If an Indian citizen remains on tenterhooks about their right to vote, how can we expect the best from such a citizen?

Although the right to vote has generally been characterised as a statutory right, its exercise is central to representative democracy and the constitutional commitment to free and fair elections. This was metamorphosed from the Court's judgments in *I.C. Golaknath vs State of Punjab* (1967), *Kesavananda Bharati vs State of Kerala* (1973) and *Indira Nehru Gandhi vs Raj Narain* (1975), and continues to hold the field. In the interpretation of this writer, the three judgments, read together, surely elevate the voting right to a basic feature of India's Constitution.

The *Kesavananda Bharati* judgment established that even Parliament's power to amend the Constitution cannot be exercised to destroy or damage its basic structure. The principle continues to safeguard essential constitutional features, including democracy.

My Lords, uphold the right to vote freely, fairly and on time.

India-New Zealand trade ties set to scale new heights



Anant Goenka

President, The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI)

The India-New Zealand FTA will strengthen trade, investment and professional mobility

In 1953, Sir Edmund Hillary of New Zealand and Tenzing Norgay, the Nepalese-Indian Sherpa mountaineer made history by becoming the first ever to climb Mount Everest. This extraordinary partnership showed what co-operation, trust and determination could achieve, and we are once again set to see the India-New Zealand partnership scale to new heights with the entry into force of the India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA).

The India-New Zealand relationship has always been cordial and extends beyond diplomatic ties. Their people share the same passion for cricket, place a high value on domestic traditions and share strong people-to-people ties. In fact, New Zealand is also home to a large Indian diaspora, strengthening relations between the two countries, be it in business, education or cultural exchange. The implementation of the FTA provides another opportunity to leverage these ties for a stronger economic partnership.

Moreover, this FTA is among the recently signed modern FTAs of India which will strengthen its foothold and economic engagement in the Indo-Pacific. The complementary nature of the two economies will help in creating greater opportunities for both countries, not just in trade but also in investments and other areas of economic co-operation.

High potential for trade expansion

India-New Zealand bilateral merchandise trade, which is at $1.2 billion, is way below potential. India caters to just 1.9% of New Zealand's merchandise imports worth $47.5 billion, while China accounts for an over 22% share and Australia, the United States, South Korea and Japan together account for another 33% share.

Most of these major suppliers (excluding the U.S.) already enjoy preferential access to the New Zealand market through respective trade agreements, thus placing Indian exporters at a competitive disadvantage.

With the India-New Zealand FTA now in force, Indian exporters will also get a level playing field in this market across all tariff lines that have been now offered duty free access.

The immediate gains for India could be significant in the labour-intensive sectors. New Zealand imported nearly $1.2 billion worth of apparel in 2025, but India's share was only around 4%. The elimination of average tariffs of nearly 10% on apparel offers Indian apparel manufacturers and exporters an opportunity to expand their presence in New Zealand. Similar potential exists in sectors such as leather, footwear, home textiles and carpets.

The opportunity is equally important in higher-value manufacturing. New Zealand imports nearly $7 billion worth of machinery and $5.2 billion worth of vehicles and automotive components annually. Yet, India's market share in these categories remains around 1% or lower. The FTA provides an opportunity for Indian engineering and automotive manufacturers to deepen their presence in New Zealand for these products.

Greater market access

The agreement also addresses regulatory barriers, which will create an opportunity for sectors such as pharmaceuticals. India already enjoyed zero-duty access for pharmaceuticals in New Zealand and has held a share of around 5.5% in New Zealand's imports. The FTA includes provisions that facilitate the use of regulatory evaluation and inspection reports from recognised regulators. This can reduce duplicative compliance requirements and further improve market access for Indian pharmaceutical companies.

New Zealand's services imports stood at $24.2 billion in 2024, and India's share was less than 3%. The FTA has provided commitments across 118 services sectors, including IT, professional services, healthcare, education and financial services.

The agreement also creates dedicated pathways for skilled professionals, providing a quota of 5,000 visas at any given time and stay for up to three years.

Additionally, the agreement ensures enhanced student mobility and post-study work opportunities. These will strengthen educational and professional linkages that exist between the two countries.

As part of the agreement, New Zealand will facilitate $20 billion worth of foreign direct investment into India over a 15-year period. This should not be difficult, given India's attractiveness to global investors and New Zealand's capital and technological expertise. India offers significant investment opportunities across sectors, be it high-value manufacturing, renewable energy, agritech, food processing, digital technologies or infrastructure.

Effective utilisation is the key

The outcomes from the FTA will flow only if they are effectively utilised. Indian businesses need targeted market intelligence, stronger distribution networks, regulatory preparedness and commercial partnerships. What is equally important is sustained engagement with New Zealand's investors to develop a pipeline of commercially viable projects.

Through the combined efforts of all stakeholders – the government, the associations as well as the industry on both sides – it should not be difficult to double India-New Zealand bilateral trade by 2030. The agreement has created an enabling framework and success will depend on how these opportunities are converted into exports, investments, jobs and meaningful partnerships.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Weather monitoring

Cyclone Arnab may have had landfall with its impact minimised through effective disaster management but the weather system also draws attention to the operational status of the doppler weather radars at Machilipatnam (MPT), Chennai (CHN) and Karaikal (KKL). This is particularly worrying at a time when there can be changes in the weather system over the Bay of Bengal impacting the eastern coast of peninsular India, southern Odisha and northern Andhra Pradesh. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) must restore these doppler weather radars to full operational status at the earliest and ensure that their data and imagery are made available on the IMD website.

Timely restoration is essential for accurate weather monitoring, cyclone tracking and the dissemination of early warnings to vulnerable coastal communities.

S. Sundararajan,
Chennai

Customer data

The exposure of SBI customers' personal data on the Dark Web raises questions about SBI's cybersecurity safeguards. The apparent reliance on external agencies to detect the exposure needs explanation.

Gopalaswamy J.,
Chennai

Corrections & Clarifications

In a 'Sport' page report, "Lanka drubs Pakistan, eliminates England" (October 28), the 'brief' scores should have read "Pakistan" instead of "England".

The Readers' Editor's office can be contacted by Telephone: +91-44-28576300; E-mail: readerseditor@thehindu.co.in

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Disinvestment as key economic strategy



Chandrajit Banerjee

Director General, Confederation of Indian Industry

Seven months into 2026-27, the fiscal year has been shaped by global uncertainty, high energy prices and worries over a deficient monsoon. Against this backdrop, disinvestment and asset monetisation have helped in navigating a challenging fiscal year. While receipts were already on course to meet the budget target, the government's approval of the sale of its share in the IDBI Bank on October 14 makes it likely that the target will be exceeded. For the industry and investors, the receipts are a signal of the government's continued commitment to reforms and a larger role for the private sector. This year so far, the disinvestment trajectory has progressed well, even before the IDBI stake sale. According to DIPAM data, the Centre mobilised ₹62,124 crore in April-September 2026 through disinvestment and asset monetisation, of which ₹55,757 crore came from disinvestment. These collections had already reached 78% of the full-year budget target of ₹80,000 crore. With the IDBI proceeds, the collections are to head past the target.

This comes at a time when the government looks to diversify its revenue sources amid rising expenditure commitments. Net tax revenue rose by a modest 3.4% in April-August 2026 and non-tax revenue by 3.2%, while capital expenditure was up by over 18%. Overall, the fiscal deficit has already reached 42% of the budgeted levels which implies a tight balance between revenue shortfalls and spending risks.

However, disinvestment should not be seen merely as a tool for meeting fiscal targets. It is a policy choice aimed at unlocking greater value from public assets, widening public ownership, and improving efficiency and governance through greater market discipline. The 2022 LIC IPO which drew in many first-time retail investors and policyholders remains a prime example.

This was precisely the rationale behind the government's 2021 New Public Sector Enterprise (PSE) Policy which envisages a "bare minimum presence" of PSEs in strategic sectors. Likewise, the National Monetisation Pipeline (NMP) re-engines capital via mature public assets. A target of ₹16.72 lakh crore has been set under NMP 2.0 for FY26-30 after having achieved 90% of its Phase 1 goal.

Demand-based approach

This year, however, until this month, receipts had come mainly through Offer for Sale (OFS) measures which help to broaden ownership but keep the status quo on an enterprise's operations. The strategic sale of the IDBI Bank since Air India in 2022 is an encouraging sign. From an industry perspective, the IDBI sale is more than a one-off sale. It is one of the largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) deals in India's financial sector and constitutes as the first step towards a 'Privatisation 2.0' framework. More importantly, this framework is premised on being investor-led, professionally managed and time-bound. Two changes would help to turn into a template.

First, the selection criteria for disinvestments of PSEs should move to a demand-based approach instead of being led by the government. It would work better to first gauge interest across a wider pool and prioritise PSEs that draw strong bids at expected valuations, with structured investor feedback flagging procedural and regulatory hurdles early. Second, a rolling three-year privatisation stream, based on investor interest and the government's strategic priorities, would give investors time for due diligence, which means deeper participation and better price discovery.

Given the fact that privatisation of several PSEs is a long journey, calibrated disinvestment could serve as an interim measure

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Percentage hike in dearness allowance for govt. employees

3 in per cent. The Cabinet on Wednesday approved a 3% in dearness allowance and dearness relief, benefiting over 1.17 crore Central government employees and pensioners. Announcing the decision, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the Union Cabinet headed by Prime Minister has taken the decision to increase the DA and DR ahead of Diwali. PTI

Years after which Air Algerie resumed direct flights to Tripoli

12 Algeria's national carrier Air Algerie resumed direct flights to Tripoli on Wednesday after a halt of nearly 12 years, the internationally recognised Government of National Unity media office said. Many international airlines suspended flights to and from Libya after the 2014 civil war. The airline will initially operate two flights a week, the media office said. REUTERS

Amount approved by Cabinet for PM Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana

7,395 in ₹ crore. The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved an allocation of ₹7,395 crore for the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana, with Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw calling it a paradigm shift from prescription-based schemes to a model focused on local-level capacity building and planning. PTI

Death toll from army drone strike on a market in Sudan

102 The death toll from an army drone strike on a market in the Sudanese city of Nyala has risen to 102, a rights group said on Wednesday, in the latest deadly attack on the paramilitary stronghold in western Darfur. Sudan's military, at war with the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) since April 2023, regularly strikes Nyala. AFP

Energy support announced by U.K. to 20 million households

100 in £. Britain's Labour government will hand out a direct payment of £100 ($133) to 20 million households to help with soaring energy bills, finance minister John Healey said on Wednesday. The measure is designed "to take pressure off in the coldest months and see people through to the spring", Mr. Healey said. AFP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us facebook.com/thehindu X.com/the_hindu instagram.com/the_hindu

Is GRAP enough to curb pollution?

What is GRAP, and why is it imposed in Delhi-NCR? Which factors worsen air pollution during winter? What restrictions are imposed under Stage I of GRAP? What additional curbs come into effect under Stages III and IV? Has GRAP consistently improved Delhi's winter air quality?

EXPLAINER

Nikhil M. Babu

The story so far:

As air quality in Delhi worsened to the 'poor' category in the national capital, the Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and adjoining areas (CAQM) on last Wednesday announced Stage 1 of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) in Delhi and the National Capital Region (NCR) to bring down the pollution.

Every winter, air pollution spikes in Delhi-NCR and many parts of the larger Indo-Gangetic Plains, mainly due to meteorological factors such as lower wind speeds and a drop in temperature. Pollution from stubble burning in October and November and firecrackers during the festive season adds to emissions from vehicles and dust, further worsening air quality.

What is GRAP?

The Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) is a set of short-term emergency measures to reduce air pollution and is divided into four stages. The CAQM announces the different stages, depending on the level of pollution recorded or forecast for the near future.

Whenever the CAQM announces GRAP, it directs State governments to implement the restrictions with "immediate effect" in entire Delhi and also in the NCR districts of Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, and Rajasthan. The restrictions will come into effect on the ground when the respective State governments pass orders to implement them.

As per law, the State governments are bound to implement directions of the CAQM and the Commission can initiate legal action against officers not following its directions.

The GRAP was first notified by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in January 2017, pursuant to Supreme Court directions to provide for graded measures corresponding to different levels of air quality.

Initially, the GRAP was implemented by the EPCA (Environmental Pollution (Prevention and Control) Authority), which was formed in 1998 by the Supreme Court and was responsible for the management and coordination of air pollution in Delhi and the NCR.

But the EPCA was not backed by a statute, and experts had raised the issue that it lacked the teeth to act against authorities that did not follow its orders.

In 2021, the CAQM replaced the EPCA, and since then it has been implementing the GRAP. Over the years, at times after coming under attack from the Supreme Court, the GRAP has gone through multiple revisions, making it more stringent.

What now?

Most of the actions under Stage 1 are directing authorities to strictly implement existing norms related to air pollution.

The four stages of GRAP are: Stage I - 'Poor' Air Quality (Delhi AQI ranging between 201-300), Stage II - 'Very Poor' Air Quality (Delhi AQI ranging between 301-400), Stage III - 'Severe' Air Quality (Delhi AQI ranging between 401-450), Stage IV - 'Severe +' Air Quality (Delhi AQI > 450).

A higher AQI indicates worsening air quality.

Though the GRAP can be imposed any time during the year, the higher stages of GRAP are mostly invoked during winter as air quality deteriorates.

Under GRAP 1, the CAQM has directed Delhi and its neighbouring States to ensure that diesel generator sets are not used as a regular source of power supply, among other measures.

It's under Stage III and Stage IV of the GRAP that more severe actions kick in.

For instance, under Stage III, the CAQM announces a ban on construction and demolition activities in Delhi-NCR and a ban on the plying of BS III petrol and BS IV or below emission standard diesel Light Motor Vehicles (LMVs) or cars in Delhi and in the High Vehicle Density (HVD) districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonipat, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddh Nagar.

Similarly, under Stage IV, the ban on construction becomes even more severe with fewer exemptions, and there is a ban on the entry of trucks into Delhi, except for trucks that are BS-VI, electric, CNG, and LNG. Other measures are also taken under both the stages.



Winter woes: People walk along Kartavya Path as haze envelops Rashtrapati Bhavan; every winter, air pollution spikes in Delhi-NCR and many parts of the larger Indo-Gangetic Plains, mainly due to meteorological factors. ANI

Does GRAP actually help?

The GRAP aims to cut down the sources of pollution for a short time when the air pollution is very high, so that the air quality improves, but it is not a long-term strategy.

According to an analysis released on Thursday (October 22, 2026) by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA), a Finland-based non-profit research organisation, there has been "no consistent" improvement in Delhi's winter air quality over the past four years, despite the imposition of GRAP.

"Delhi's winter AQI (Air Quality Index) has fluctuated over the past four years, with no consistent improvement. The mean AQI rose from 280 in winter 2022-23 to 304 in 2023-24, fell to 285 in 2024-25 and increased again to 295 in 2025-26. The median AQI followed a similar pattern, rising from 294 to 324, falling to 289 and then increasing to 305," CREA said in a statement.

Delhi's winter air quality has not followed a consistent downward trend since the 2022 revision of GRAP, and the mean and median AQI for the latest winter were both higher than in 2022-23, said Manoj Kumar, an analyst at CREA.



Vehicles pass as an anti-smog gun sprays water to curb air pollution in central Delhi, where GRAP-I measures are in effect, in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

What is different this winter?

In addition to GRAP, the Delhi government in June this year issued a gazette notification of a set of restrictions for winter months. But unlike GRAP, these restrictions will come into play irrespective of the air quality at a particular time.

For instance, as per the June 23 notification, from November 1 to January 31, there will be a ban on the plying of all non-Delhi-registered motor vehicles below BSVI emission standards in the national capital. However, electric, CNG, emergency, and sovereign duty vehicles are exempted from it.

Similarly, as per the notification, from November 1 to February 28, existing parking charges at authorised parking sites will be doubled to discourage use of private vehicles, except for parking spaces owned and managed by the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC).

But if there is any conflict between the GRAP orders and the June 23 notification by the Delhi government, the GRAP will take precedence.

With the additional restrictions imposed by the Delhi government, this winter is set to see one of the highest levels of government action in the recent past in Delhi, at least on paper.

THE GIST

- GRAP imposes increasingly stringent restrictions as Delhi's air quality worsens, from 'Poor' to 'Severe+', but its measures are short-term
- Delhi's winter air quality has shown no consistent improvement over the past four years despite GRAP, with the mean AQI rising from 280 in 2022-23 to 295 in 2025-26, according to CREA
- The Delhi government has introduced additional curbs, including a ban on non-Delhi-registered vehicles below BS-VI standards and doubled parking charges at authorised sites, regardless of air quality levels

KEYWORD

How neoliberalism turned the world against its young

The rise in youth unrest stems from failures of neoliberal capitalism, which has weakened public welfare and worsened unemployment; as falling wages undermine consumption and investment, young people face fewer jobs, rising education costs and an economic system that prioritises profits

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

France is in turmoil. And Albania. And Spain. Even India. As were Bangladesh or Sri Lanka earlier. The list goes on. While the specific demands may vary, one thing is common across these mobilisations: the young are on the streets. Why are the young angry the world over? In this piece, we look at the first world, in particular the G7 bloc, to understand why indeed.

France is a good example to understand what is happening in the global North. Emmanuel Macron, the antagonist according to the students in the French protests, has been in power since May 14, 2017.

Over his almost a decade-long reign, France has witnessed severe economic problems – high unemployment, low growth, rising cost of living, falling real wages and severe cutbacks in public expenditure. It is not a happenstance, therefore, that the spark that lit this protest was the lack of resources and staff at the Lycée Antoine-de-Saint-Exupéry in Créteil (a suburb of Paris).

At the heart of it all is the neoliberal economic model, which aggressively enforced reducedpublic expenditure in general, and welfare spending in particular. Whether it's Macron in France or Biden/Clinton in the U.S. or Starmer in the U.K., those championing this economic model have either been ousted or are on the brink of losing power.

Crisis of unemployment

The system has angered young people in particular. Although overall unemployment rates have remained high since the pandemic, youth unemployment rates in G7 countries are now almost twice as high, if not higher (Chart 1). Generation Z (Gen Z), which has taken to the streets, comprises those born between 1997 and 2012, putting them in the 14-29 age group today. That cohort overlaps with the age group 15-29 shown in the chart.

As is well known, unlike countries in the Global South, developed countries are ageing societies, with the share of young people in their populations declining over time. Yet, as their relative population share shrinks, youth unemployment continues to rise. While fewer young people enter the labour force each year, many more join the ranks of the unemployed. Clearly, the problem is not an excess supply of labour but a lack of demand for it.

What causes unemployment?

As is the case with most economics questions, this also has broadly two sides – orthodox and heterodox. The orthodox side believes unemployment has to do with high rigid wages, inflexible labour markets, lack of a skilled labour force, most of which puts the blame, directly or indirectly, on the working class itself for its misfortune.

The heterodox side, in sharp contrast, argues it is the decision of the capitalist class to employ or not to employ workers which determines unemployment in the economy.

Consider a typical labour market – demand for labour comes from the capitalists; supply of it comes from the workers. Capitalists would like to employ as many as they could to maximise their profits. The lower the wage rate, the higher the profits, and so the demand for labour rises as wages fall (downward-sloping demand curve in graph 1). The supply curve, on the other hand, is upward sloping because as the wages rise, more workers join the labour force. The intersection of the two (point E) represents full employment – those who seek work at that wage get it.

When the economy gets stuck at point A – demand for labour (point A) is less than its supply (point B) – the economy has involuntary unemployment (equal to the gap AB). But what stops the economy from reaching point E?

Orthodox economics would tell us the wages are way too high, for which either the labour unions or rigid labour market legislation (against 'hire and fire', for example) are responsible. To be sure, there are other theories like the 'efficiency wages' which explain why the economy remains stuck at A.

The heterodox approaches argue that labour demand depends on the level of demand for goods and services in the economy. Demand, under 'pure' capitalism, consists of investment and consumption (see (A) in box 1). Let's assume, for simplicity, workers consume all their wages and capitalists save their entire profits. Consumption demand would then depend on employment (wage bill), so it cannot be the cause of unemployment. The real cause, therefore, is investment. The less the capitalists decide to invest, less will be the total induced demand for goods and services, and the lower will be the need to employ workers.

It is the capitalists, not the workers, who are responsible for unemployment.

But why can the State not fill the demand gap through fiscal expansion and ensure perpetual full employment? After all, it is a win-win both for the workers and capitalists – those willing to work get work and profits rise with fiscal expansion (see (B) in box 1). That was the Keynesian route out of the capitalist crisis.

In his famous essay on 'Political Aspects of Full Employment', Michal Kalecki argued against this naïveté of Keynesianism because "under a regime of permanent full employment, 'the sack' would cease to play its role as a disciplinary measure".

The rise of the neoliberal world order in response to the 'New Deal' of the 1950s and the 1960s mirrors Kalecki's statement word for word.

Rise of neoliberalism

What was the 'New Deal'? In response to the Great Depression of the 1930s – the deepest and the longest unemployment and profitability crisis capitalism has ever faced – a new world order emerged which argued for larger governments to push the economy towards point E. This created what is called the Golden Age of Capitalism (1945-1973), which recorded the highest ever rates of growth in the global North (see chart 2). But it came along with a class alignment in favour of the working class, whose shares in the total economic pie kept rising throughout the first world (see chart 3). The 'sack' was losing its role as a disciplinary measure.

A counter-revolution, led by the economist Milton Friedman, broke out, which sought to bring the 'sack' back. Inflation that broke out between 1973 and 1980 – the pretext of this countercharge – was cost-push (oil price shocks), and had absolutely nothing to do with larger governments. Despite that, the monetarist countercharge argued that government meddling with a 'natural' state of affairs under capitalism caused this unprecedented inflation. Capitalism, on its own, produces full employment and so let the markets do their job, it was argued and that governments had no business to be in business.

Ronald Reagan in the U.S. and Margaret Thatcher in the U.K. put the monetarist doctrine into practice, which has since come to be known as the neoliberal world order. With the withdrawal of the welfare state, large-scale union busting and 'flexible' labour markets, the balance of class forces was restored in favour of the capitalists. The share of the working class in the economic pie nose-dived and the advances of the Golden Age were reversed (see chart 3).

Crisis of underconsumption

A fall in the wage share, however, comes with its own problems. What makes sense for an individual capitalist – a fall in wage cost – harms the capitalist class as a whole, as far as profits are concerned. It happens for two different reasons. One, a dollar's fall in wages means an equivalent fall in consumption demand, which means a fall in profits of capitalists selling these consumer goods. Two, such a fall in consumption leads to a second-degree fall in investment in the next period because why would the capitalists build more factories if the existing ones become idle? Karl Marx called it the crisis of underconsumption. Chart 3, seen together with Chart 2, is this crisis in action.

This fall in growth creates a crisis of unemployment, which is further aggravated by capital's bid to increase its profit margins by replacing workers with machines. It is a double whammy for the youth – low growth, which is labour-displacing. Artificial Intelligence (AI) could potentially aggravate this crisis.

Last but not the least, when workers are led to believe that their lack of skills is to blame for their unemployment, they turn to education to upgrade their skills. But neoliberalism ensures that education is turned into a money-making industry worldwide.

The cost of education has been skyrocketing under the neoliberal phase (see chart 4).

Getting a degree becomes more expensive, and those who manage to get it don't necessarily land themselves remunerative jobs. Who can blame the youth, therefore, for resisting this system rigged against them by design?

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics)

A burden on the young

Neoliberalism has reversed past economic gains, leaving the young with fewer opportunities and greater insecurity

Chart 1: Wrath of the unemployed Gen Z

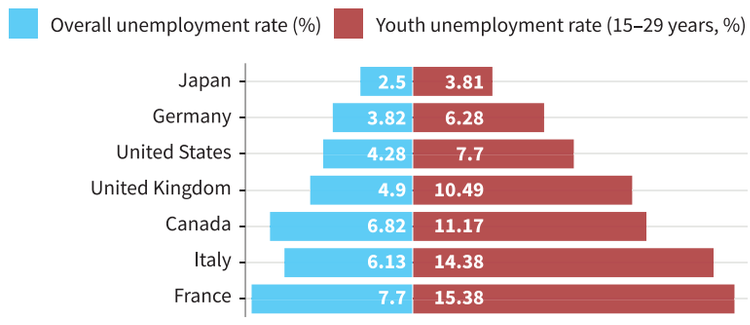


Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: Authors' calculations. International Labour Organisation (ILO), International Labour Organisation Statistics (ILOSTAT)

Chart 2: Growth rates for the G7 bloc (Period-wise CAGR in %)

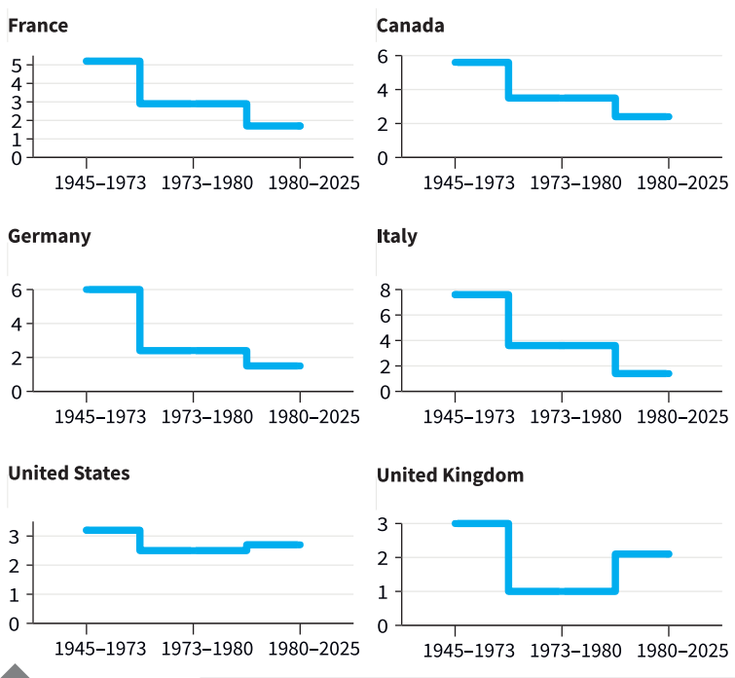
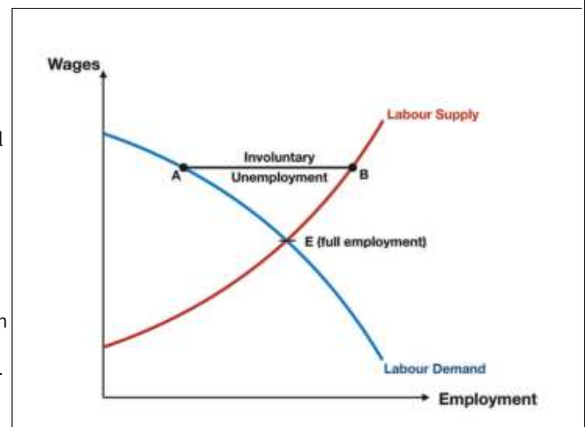


Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: Authors' calculations. U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA). Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis (FRED). Institut national de la statistique et des etudes economiques (INSEE). Federal Statistical Office (Destatis). Italian National Institute of Statistics (ISTAT), Istat-Data. Cabinet Office, Economic and Social Research Institute (ESRI). Statistics Canada. World Bank, World Development Indicators. OECD, National Accounts at a Glance



(A) A "pure" capitalist economy:

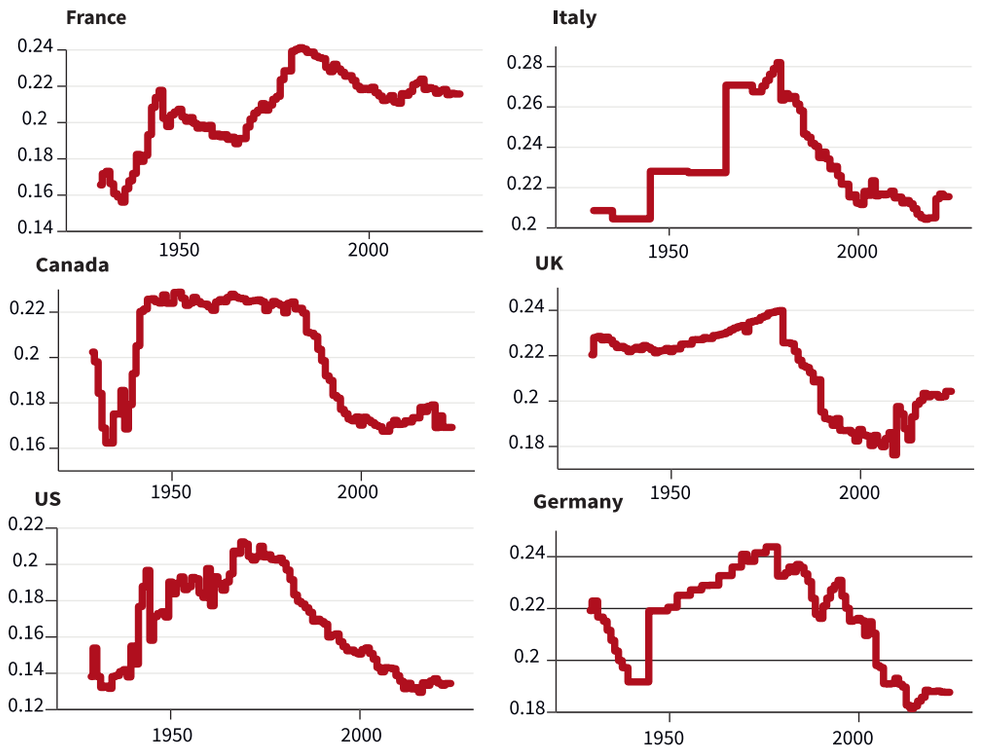
$$\frac{\text{Wage bill}}{\text{Wage x Employment}} + \text{Profits} = \text{Consumption} + \text{Investment}$$

(B) With state intervention:

$$\text{Wage bill} + \text{Profits} = \text{Consumption} + \text{Investment} + \text{Government Expenditure}$$

$$\text{Profits} = \text{Investment} + \text{Government Expenditure}$$

Chart 3: Share of the poorest half in the total income of G7 countries



Some data points for Italy and Germany are not available, so a connecting line through the available data points has been generated for uniformity Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: World Inequality Database

Chart 4: Rising cost of education in G7

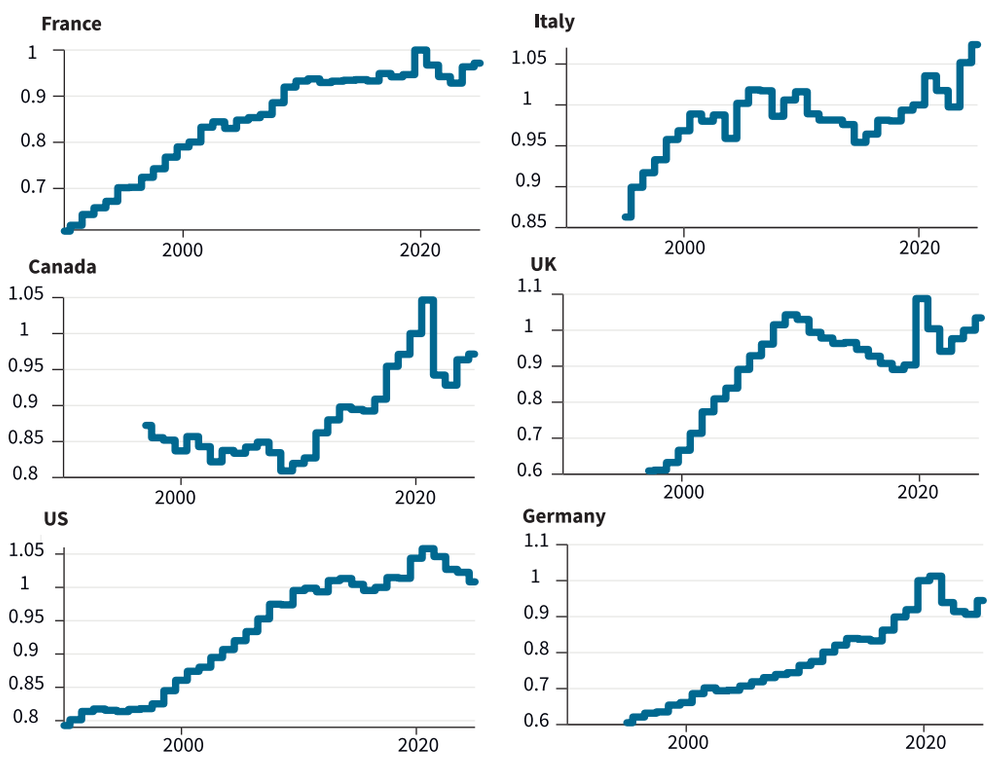


Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: Authors' calculations. U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA), NIPA, republished by FRED. Statistics Canada. Eurostat. OECD National Accounts. World Bank, World Development Indicators. Economic and Social Research Institute, Cabinet Office of Japan. UK Economic Accounts (UKEA).



In rage: France has witnessed some of the worst economic problems — high unemployment, low growth, rising cost of living, falling real wages, severe cutbacks in public expenditure. AFP

From Page One

SC asks if ECI has powers to punish voters

"First and foremost, in Bihar SIR, the ECI had not undertaken 'logical discrepancy' as a category. We had permitted you in West Bengal as an interim arrangement... We have not finally adjudicated on the legality of 'logical discrepancy'," Justice Bagchi spoke for the Bench.

Justice Bagchi asked how voters, included in the 2003 electoral roll after an intensive revision, could be purged in the name of 'logical discrepancy' in 2026.

Petitioners, activists Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, represented by advocates Prashant Bhushan and Neha Rathi, submitted that the ECI was compelling voters to misrepresent themselves as new applicants, an offence which attracts imprisonment.

"You cannot touch these Forms. Form 6, Form 7 [for objection to proposed inclusion/deletion of names in the existing electoral roll], and Form 8 [application for shifting of residence] are cast in stone... You cannot make changes to them," Justice Bagchi said.

Mr. Bhushan said the ECI's approach to voters in the Delhi SIR was short-sighted.

"It ran like 'you were absent at your address when we came with the enumeration form, you are deleted from the electoral roll'. Of the 1,45,10,299 electors in Delhi at the start of the SIR, 47,56,722 were marked as having not returned their enumeration forms on account of being absent, shifted, dead or duplicate entries," he submitted.

The court asked the ECI whether a person who had temporarily moved out of Delhi for a month-long assignment, and missed filling out his enumeration form, would be considered as 'permanently shifted'.

"If a voter has moved residence from Vasant Kunj to Sarita Vihar, is it not enough for him to simply disclose his voter details to continue in the electoral roll," Chief Justice Kant asked the ECI.

Justice Bagchi said the requirement for voters to apply through Form 6 and Form 7 would arise only after the final voter list was published, and not during the draft stage.

"Why don't you allow the deleted voters to continue to submit their enumeration forms? There is a structural incongruity between your manner of conduct of SIR and the Form 6 and 7 regime. Why should voters be asked to apply with Form 6, they can just put in their enumeration forms belatedly... Keep it open-ended. Don't stick to any timelines for voters," Justice Bagchi addressed the ECI.

Chief Justice Kant asked why the ECI had to rush the SIR in Delhi, with no elections around. The last date for filing claims and objections for inclusion/deletions in the Delhi electoral roll is October 30.

Mr. Naidu said voters were never 'deleted' as they could return to the electoral roll at any time before the filing of nominations for an election.

Five killed as Cyclone Arnab crosses A.P.

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu, who briefed Union Home Minister Amit Shah on the damages caused by the cyclone, said crops, mainly paddy, across more than 70,000 hectares have been inundated, and horticultural crops spread over 10,500 hectares have also been affected.

Mr. Naidu announced relief measures for those affected, including fishermen, farmers, handloom households, people staying in relief camps and those whose houses, grocery shops, restaurants and other service establishments have been damaged.

The rainfall activity is expected to continue in the coastal districts of Andhra Pradesh on Thursday as well, as the system may take around 48 hours to weaken further. However, no alerts are in place for the State.

BJP MP seeks reopening of Kartarpur corridor

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Rajya Sabha member Vikramjit Singh Sahney on Wednesday said that he has urged the Union government to reopen the Kartarpur corridor ahead of Guru Nanak Jayanti next month.

The corridor, inaugurated in 2019, links two important Sikh shrines—Dera Baba Nanak in Punjab's Gurdaspur district and Gurudwara Darbar Sahib in Kartarpur, Pakistan.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Wednesday inaugurated a painting exhibition, titled after the Prime Minister's radio programme *Mann Ki Baat*, to mark 25 years of Narendra Modi's public life. The exhibition has been organised by the World Punjabi Organisation, of which Mr. Sahney is international president.

Mr. Sahney is among six Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) MPs who recently switched to the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

"The corridor was closed after the Pahalgam terror attack. We have requested the Minister to reopen it ahead of Guru Nanak Jayanti next month, but it is the government's call," Mr. Sahney said.

India raises concern over U.S. support for Pakistan's F-16 jets

Rajnath Singh discusses cross-border terrorism with Hegseth; Secretary of War reaffirms support to combat issue; they review defence relations

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Wednesday raised India's concerns over Washington's support package for Pakistan's F-16 fighter aircraft with U.S. Secretary of War Pete Hegseth during a bilateral meeting on the sidelines of the ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting-Plus (ADMM-Plus) in Cebu, Philippines.

The two leaders also discussed the threat of cross-border terrorism, with Mr. Hegseth reaffirming Washington's support to India in combating the menace.

According to the Ministry of Defence, the meeting provided an opportunity to review progress under the India-U.S. Major Defence Partnership, including the implementation of foundational security agreements and avenues to enhance operational readiness, technology sharing and defence industrial integration.

Mr. Singh emphasised the need for a zero-tolerance approach towards countries that support, train or finance terrorist organisations. He expressed appreciation for the consistent support extended by the U.S. in India's fight against cross-border terrorism.



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh during a meeting with United States Secretary of War Pete Hegseth on Wednesday. PTI

Mr. Singh also conveyed to Mr. Hegseth that any transfer of advanced military technology to Pakistan could ultimately result in the technology reaching a third country, raising concerns over its wider proliferation and implications for regional security.

The two Ministers also reviewed the ten-year India-U.S. Defence Framework and discussed strengthening maritime security cooperation, military-to-military exchanges and resilient defence supply chains.

Separately, Mr. Singh held talks with Japanese Defence Minister Shinjiro Koizumi, reviewing progress in bilateral defence cooperation since their meeting in August. The discussions explored joint development in naval shipbuilding and design.

DPDP Act does not infringe on press freedom: Vaishnaw

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Ashwini Vaishnaw

Union Information Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Wednesday said the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act did not infringe on press freedom, asserting that the Constitution guaranteed journalistic independence.

"The journalistic freedom is guaranteed by the Constitution. That freedom is absolutely available. There is not even an intention to affect the journalistic freedom," Mr. Vaishnaw said. He invited editors and media professionals to engage in an open dialogue with the government on concerns surrounding the law.

The remarks came amid concerns from news publishers that the law could make investigative reporting more difficult. They have argued that the absence of a specific exemption for journalism could affect reporting on matters of public interest, especially investigations involving personal information collected without consent. They have also raised concerns about retaining information required as part of investigative reporting, and protecting confidential sources. The Minister said the privacy law "fully maintains the journalistic freedom the Constitution guarantees", adding that it was aimed at protecting personal data without undermining media freedom.

It is learnt that the government is also open to amending the law to explicitly safeguard journalistic activities, if necessary. "If hardcoding is required, we can hardcode it; it only requires an amendment... There is no problem in that because our intent is clear," a top source said. The source added that the government was willing to discuss the concerns and that any confusion could be addressed through an amendment in Parliament.

Mr. Vaishnaw said the DPDP Act was introduced following a Supreme Court judgment recognising the right to privacy.

(With agency inputs)

Japan-northeast India link to be strengthened: Centre

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI



Randhir Jaiswal

India has a "very strong partnership" with Japan, and bilateral projects involving the northeastern States will be "further strengthened", Randhir Jaiswal, official spokesperson of the External Affairs Ministry, said on Wednesday.

The comments came hours after Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman and his Japanese counterpart, Sanae Takaichi, agreed to "enhance connectivity in the region", and signed agreements that will pave the way for additional Japanese assistance to Bangladesh's Matarbari deep sea port, which will connect with northeast India.

"We have very strong partnership with Japan. We also have several initiatives involving northeast [India] and Japan, and we would like to further strengthen these linkages," Mr. Jaiswal said. The Japanese language was being taught to the working population in the northeastern States as part of these initiatives, he added.

"It will also give a boost to the Japan-India economic partnership here in India as well," Mr. Jaiswal said. Northeastern States were also receiving assistance from Japan as part of that larger bilateral framework, he said.

Japan and Bangladesh have signed multiple agreements during Mr. Rahman's ongoing visit to Tokyo, which includes further development of the industrial hub centred around the Matarbari deep sea port. Mr. Rahman met Ms. Takaichi and representatives of leading business houses during the visit.

Sources from Japan maintain they envisage the linking of the Matarbari port with India's northeast to ensure optimal usage of the industrial hub and the first deep sea port in Bangladesh, which currently depends on ports in Malaysia and Singapore for handling big vessels.

A joint statement issued during Mr. Rahman's visit has included the agreement on the Matarbari port under the "connectivity" section. "The two Prime Ministers reaffirmed their commitment to steadily advance cooperation aimed at further strengthening connectivity in the region," it said.

Court gives ex-WFI chief final chance to respond to appeal

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A Delhi court on Wednesday gave BJP leader and former Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) president Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh a final opportunity to respond to an appeal by four women wrestlers challenging his acquittal in a sexual harassment case.

Special judge Dig Vinay Singh of the Rouse Avenue Courts issued the notice to him.

The appeal challenges the August 3 order of the Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (ACJM), which acquitted Mr. Singh and his aide Vinod Tomar. The trial court cited "significant" inconsistencies in the complainants' accounts of the dates, years and locations of the alleged incidents.

The wrestlers contend that the decision was legally flawed, relied on a selective assessment of evidence and failed to apply established legal principles.

In their appeal, the wrestlers argue that the judgment relied on "archaic and stereotypical assumptions" about victims' expected behaviour and gave undue weight to minor discrepancies while overlooking the broader evidence.

The case gained national attention in 2023 when wrestlers, including Sakshi Malik, Vinesh Phogat, Bajrang Punia and Sangeeta Phogat, staged prolonged protests in New Delhi, demanding action against Mr. Singh over allegations involving several women wrestlers. The alleged incidents occurred between 2016 and 2019 at the WFI office, Mr. Singh's official residence, and during international tours.

Cabinet clears 3% hike in dearness allowance

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Cabinet on Wednesday approved a 3% hike in dearness allowance and dearness relief, benefiting over 1.17 crore Central government employees and pensioners.

Announcing the decision, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the Union Cabinet headed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi has taken the decision ahead of Deepavali. The hike will be effective from July 1, 2026. It will benefit 48.54 lakh employees and 68.71 lakh pensioners.

The Cabinet also approved the Container Manufacturing Promotion Scheme with a budgetary outlay of ₹10,000 crore up to FY40 to promote a globally competitive container manufacturing ecosystem in India.

Netanyahu bloc leads Israel vote, falls short of majority

Agence France-Presse
JERUSALEM



Supporters of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu celebrate in Jerusalem on Wednesday. AP

Results from Israel's hard-fought election pointed on Wednesday to no clear winner as a leader of the Arab minority appealed to a hesitant opposition to join forces to end the divisive reign of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.

With more than three quarters of the vote counted, Mr. Netanyahu's right-wing bloc was slightly ahead but short of a majority in Tuesday's election, the first since the Hamas attack on October 7, 2023, which has led Israel to wage war on Gaza and across the region.

Both Mr. Netanyahu and Gadi Eisenkot, a former military chief leading a broad opposition bloc, vowed that they would seek to form the next government. But neither looks set to reach the 61-seat threshold for a majority. With 85% of ballots counted, Mr. Netanyahu's bloc had 53 of the 120 seats in Parliament and Mr. Eisenkot's opposition had 48.

The results could still change but one place of clear gains was among Israeli Arab lists which were set to jump to 19 seats.

Voters from the Arab community, descendants of Palestinians who stayed after Israel's creation and who make up around 20% of the population, have been enraged by the Netanyahu government's ultra-nationalist Jewish vision for the country and the Palestinian territories.

HIGH ARAB TURNOUT
» PAGE 16

Data shared in masked form, says ULIP amid complaints over sale of vehicle information

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI



The Road Transport Ministry sought an audit after finding that some entities were extracting data in large volumes from ULIP. FILE PHOTO

After the Ministry of Road Transport sought an audit of users accessing the Centre's logistics portal following complaints that multiple apps and websites were selling vehicle information, the Unified Logistics Interface Platform (ULIP) rejected the allegations of its misuse. It said that all data were masked and called for broader scrutiny of the platforms involved.

"ULIP relays information in the format received from the source API. For example, vehicle owner names, chassis and engine numbers retain their masking, and mobile number field remains null in both the source response and the response provided to users. ULIP does not independently generate, unmask or enrich the underlying data," ULIP wrote in response to a story in *The Hindu*.

The Ministry sought an audit after finding that some entities were extracting data in large volumes from ULIP with some pulling out as many as 50 lakh records a month. The Road Ministry shares vehicle information with multiple government agencies and private firms from its portals such as VAHAN, SARATHI, e-Challan and PUCC portals.

ULIP said it uses sufficient safeguards that include screening of entities that have access to its portal, their proposed use cases, binding terms and conditions, IP whitelisting, phased onboarding and continuous monitoring of API usage. This framework complies with the Road Ministry's Policy for Data Sharing from the National Transport Repository which prescribes authentication, secret keys, masking of personally identifiable information (PII) and defined approval mechanisms, ULIP added.

Referring to multiple apps selling vehicle information data in unmasked form, ULIP said there needed to be a "scrutiny of wider ecosystem of platforms and channels through which such information is being made available".

The Road Ministry has written to the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In), the government's nodal agency for investigating cybersecurity incidents, seeking a forensic audit of VAHAN, SARATHI, e-Challan and PUCC portals, which hold a range of vehicle-owner information.

It has also sought the intervention of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MEITY) for a review of its data sharing policy and suggest ways to strengthen it. The Road Ministry also plans to audit various enforcement agencies that access its portals for data.

Nirmala and Rahul spar over Tata Group leadership dispute

Congress leader questions industry's' 'silence' over leadership battle, says the conglomerate is being 'criminally destroyed'; Union Finance Minister hits back, accuses him of politicising commercial, legal matters and casting 'baseless aspersions'

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi sparred on Wednesday over the leadership dispute at Tata Sons, with Mr. Gandhi questioning why Union Home Minister Amit Shah had hosted representatives of Tata Trusts and Tata Sons at his residence and accusing the government of "criminally destroying" the Tata Group.

Hitting back at Mr. Gandhi's charge of criminal destruction, the Finance Minister accused him of politicising commercial and legal matters and casting "baseless aspersions".

The Opposition leader responded by asking which "commercial and legal matter" required a meeting of Tata Trusts and Tata Sons hosted at Mr. Shah's residence.

"Which 'legal and commercial matter' required Tata Trusts and Tata Sons to be hosted at Amit Shah's residence? When is crony number 1 going to appear in the game and which pieces of Tata is he going to get?" Mr. Gandhi said in a post on social media platform X addressing the Minister. "Finally, all India's businesses except 3-4 of your cronies, already hate all of you and don't need any incitement," he added.

Mr. Gandhi's post followed an earlier rebuttal from the Finance Minister.

> Tata is being criminally destroyed and no business leader dares say a word. How long will you stay silent? Until they own you? Indian business is not Modi and Shah's plaything
>
> **RAHUL GANDHI**
> Congress leader



> You have repeatedly decried the successes of industry & our entrepreneurs. Now, are you trying to incite our business leaders to join you in spreading distrust & toxicity
>
> **NIRMALA SITHARAMAN**
> Union Finance Minister



"Being the LoP @RahulGandhi, I suggest you refrain from politicising every issue. Also, casually labelling commercial and legal matters as criminal is unacceptable," Ms. Sitharaman said in a post on X.

"You have repeatedly decried the successes of Indian industry & our entrepreneurs. Now, are you trying to incite our business leaders to join you in spreading distrust & toxicity?" the Minister said.

Mr. Gandhi had earlier questioned the "silence" of India's business leaders over the bitter leadership dispute at Tata Sons, the holding company of the country's largest conglomerate.

'Lack courage'

"Tata is being criminally destroyed and no business leader dares say a word. How long will you stay silent? Until they own you? Indian business is not Modi and Shah's plaything," Mr. Gandhi said, adding, "You lack courage. We don't. We will ensure justice for these crimes."

Mr. Gandhi is the first high-profile politician to publicly comment on the dispute, which has split the trustees of Tata Trusts and spilled into the Tata Sons boardroom.

Unlike other conglomerates, Tata Trusts, a group of philanthropic entities, holds approximately 66% of the shares in Tata Sons, which oversees the group companies, including Tata Consultancy Services Limited, Tata Motors Limited, Tata Steel Limited and Titan Company Limited.

Earlier this week, Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata challenged the resolution to reappoint N. Chandrasekaran as chairman of Tata Sons, which was passed at the September 17 board meeting.

At the heart of the friction between Tata Trusts and Tata Sons is the question of listing Tata Sons on the stock exchanges. While Mr. Chandrasekaran is in favour of a listing, amid pressure from the Reserve Bank of India, Mr. Noel Tata is opposed to the move.

In her post, Ms. Sitharaman contrasted the Congress's record in government with that of the Narendra Modi-led government, accusing the former of having suppressed entrepreneurship through the "Licence-Quota Raj".

"So Rahul*ji*, refrain from seeing ghosts everywhere," Ms. Sitharaman said.

There was no immediate reaction from the Tata Group to Mr. Gandhi's allegations.

Modi questions Congress over party's losses in MLC elections across four States

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday took a dig at the Congress, pointing to the principal Opposition party's losses in the Member of Legislative Council (MLC) elections held using ballot papers across four major States.

"MLC elections in 28 seats across four big States – Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Bihar and Karnataka. Elections held using ballot papers. Guess how many seats Congress won?" said Mr. Modi on X.

Results for all 11 seats had been declared in Uttar Pradesh. While the Bharatiya Janata Party won six seats, the Samajwadi Party bagged five. In Bihar, the BJP-led NDA alliance won four seats. The Jan Suraaj Party opened its account with one seat, while the Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) secured one seat and Independents bagged two. In Karnataka, the BJP-JD(S) alliance swept all four seats.

Mahayuti allies BJP and Shiv Sena, and Opposition NCP (SP) won one seat each out of the five Maharashtra constituencies, while counting of votes for two other seats was underway.



Narendra Modi

The Congress claimed its candidate has won the Nagpur Graduates constituency, with State unit chief Harshwardhan Sapkal saying that the BJP nominee has been trounced in the RSS headquarters.

'Whirlwind of lies'

Earlier, at a press briefing, BJP MP Sudhanshu Trivedi said the MLC election results showed a lack of public support for the Congress and that its methods were not working. He said the ambitions of Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and the Congress to "spread anarchy by creating a whirlwind of lies" appeared to have been dented by the results.

"The most important aspect of these elections is that they were conducted through ballot papers and ballot boxes... This makes it clear that the Congress party lacks the ability to secure the support of the public or the concerned electorate in any kind of election, whether conducted using EVMs (Electronic Voting Machines) or through ballot papers and ballot boxes," he said.

Responding to Mr. Modi, Congress leader Pawan Khera said Mr. Modi should demonstrate his confidence in the BJP's electoral prowess by committing to hold all future Lok Sabha and Assembly polls through ballot paper, suspend the special intensive revision of electoral rolls, restore the 13.3 crore deleted voters, remove Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and repeal the law granting him lifelong immunity.

(With inputs from PTI)

INDIA bloc to hold 'impeachment' of CEC at Kharge's residence tomorrow

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) will hold its proposed "public impeachment" of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar at Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's official residence here at 3.30 p.m. on Friday, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh announced on Wednesday.

The Congress president's official residence was decided as the venue after the Opposition bloc's attempts to organise the event at the Ashok Hotel and Ramlila Maidan allegedly ran into hurdles over permissions.



Mallikarjun Kharge

The programme has been planned as a curtain-raiser for the Opposition's November 1 rally at Ramlila Maidan against alleged electoral irregularities and the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

"The CEC has openly violated the spirit and provisions of the Constitution. He has hollowed out the very foundation of our meticulously planned electoral democratic system. In plain words, he has lied to the Supreme Court. Acting on the signals of that venomous duo, he has turned himself into their tool. Their turn will come next," Mr. Ramesh said.

On Tuesday, the Congress had alleged that the authorities were obstructing the event to silence criticism of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal claimed that Ashok Hotel, which had initially granted permission, withdrew it following police intervention. The party subsequently decided to shift the programme to Ramlila Maidan.

However, Mr. Venugopal alleged that police personnel stopped workers from setting up infrastructure at the venue.

Responding to the charge, Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh had told *The Hindu* that the Congress had sought permission only for a rally at Ramlila Maidan on November 1. No separate request for a mock impeachment had been received, he said.

Union Minister Hardeep Puri to return to RS from seat vacated by L. Murugan

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Wednesday named Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri as the party's candidate for the coming Rajya Sabha byelection in Madhya Pradesh, necessitated by the resignation of former Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting L. Murugan earlier this month.

Mr. Puri, 74, is the Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas. His term as MP from Uttar Pradesh is set to end on November 25. The byelection to the vacated seat in Madhya Pradesh is scheduled for November 12. Mr. Murugan had four years left of a six-year term when he vacated his Rajya Sabha membership. The BJP is well poised to get Mr. Puri elected without trouble due to its comfortable numbers in the State Assembly.

The Opposition has been targeting Mr. Puri over his name appearing in the Epstein files released by the U.S. Department of Justice.

Taking to X, Mr. Puri expressed his gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the top leadership of the BJP for his return to the Rajya Sabha.

Cockroach Janta Party backs INDIA bloc's November 1 rally

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Wednesday extended its support to the rally called by the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance on November 1 against the irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, reiterating its demand for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

In a post on X, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke said, "Gyanu must go! The Cockroach Janta Party extends its support to the INDIA Bloc's November 1 rally. Nation above all!"

(With inputs from PTI)

Former West Bengal Minister arrested in Durga Puja ticket scam

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

Former West Bengal Minister Indranil Sen was arrested by the Kolkata Police on Wednesday in connection with a Durga Puja ticket scam case.

The controversy is focused on MassArt, which was established after Durga Puja received the UNESCO intangible cultural heritage tag in 2021. Two years later, allegations of irregularities linked to Mr. Sen's dealings with organisation surfaced. The outfit is headed by his wife Madhuchanda Sen. The ED investigation alleged that Mr. Sen used the platform for personal financial gains.

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY
Yelahanka, BANGALORE - 560 064
Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

Corrigendum to TENDER NOTICE No : RWF/S/146/2026-27/09 dt: 09/10/26

The estimated Tender Value in above mentioned tender notice No. has been modified from the existing value of Rs 48,29,000/- to **Rs 46,20,000/-**.
Detailed scope & corrigendum will be available in IREPS E-Portal.

Principal Chief Materials Manager
(on behalf of President of India)

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR
SRIHARIKOTA – 524124

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

No: SHAR: CMG CIVIL:MAINT:E-PT-13/26-27 **Dt: 27.10.2026**
On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for following works;

Name of Work	Tender No	Estimate Cost
Civil repair works in M R Kurup auditorium at SDSC SHAR.	T/C-26-029	₹ 69.39 Lakhs

Tender documents can be downloaded up to **05.11.2026**, **14:30** hrs. **For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html** and tender free view at **https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro**

Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
SRI SRINIVASA AYURVEDA PHARMACY, TTD, Narasingapurm.

e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE | ADV.No:4/SSAP/SMP/TTD/2026-27, Dt:27.10.2026

e-Tenders are invited on e-procurement platform for supply of AMBER Color PET Bottles 30ml, 60ml and 25mm neck Aluminum cap with TTD Emblem/logo on cap. ● **Bid document downloading start date & time: 30-10-2026 at 04:00 PM** ●**Bid document downloading end date & time: 12-11-2026 at 01:00 PM.** For more details, please visit site **http://www.tirumala.org** and **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in.**

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.228) Date:28-10-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

Office of The Superintending Engineer,
PHED, Circle Jhalawar

No./SE/PH/CJ/TA//2026-27/5374 Dated 22/10/2026

AMMENDMENT NO.2

In this office NIT no. 23/2026-27 Item No 1-A to 1-C "Annual Rate contract for Construction & commissioning of 200 mm dia tube wells with submersible pump sets etc. complete work in all types of strata & laying, jointing, testing, commissioning of HDPE pipe line including defect liability period of PANCHAYAT SAMITI AKLERA, MANOHARTHANA, JHALARAPATAN, KHANPUR, BAKANI, BHAWANI MANDI, DAG & PIRAEA of PHED Division Jhalawar/Bhawani Mandi, District, Jhalawar (With Material Complete)" due to administrative reasons an amendment in schedule dates & RISL head of submission of tender document/bid are hereby amended in the tender document as mentioned below:

S. No	Events	Existing	Revised
1	Tender Processing Fees	Rs. 2000/-To be deposited in revenue head 8658-00-102-16-02 through Egras portal in favour of 23570- Executive Engineer PHED Division Jhalawar for item no. 1-A, 1-B and 32118-Executive Engineer PHED Division Bhawani Mandi for item no. 1-C	Rs. 2000/-To be deposited in revenue head 0075-800-54-01 through EIFMS3.0 portal in favour of. 23570-Executive Engineer PHED Division Jhalawar for item no. 1-A, 1-B and 32118-Executive Engineer PHED Division Bhawani Mandi for item no. 1-C
A	Date of availability of tender document on web site	From 30-09-2026 (at 09.30 hrs) to 22-10-2026 (Upto 18:00 hrs)	From 30-09-2026 (at 09.30 hrs) to 29-10-2026 (Upto 18:00 hrs)
B	Date & time for start online submission of tender.	From 30-09-2026 (at 09.30 hrs)	From 30-09-2026 (at 09.30 hrs)
C	Last date & time for on line submission of tender	22-10-2026 (At 18:00 hrs)	29-10-2026 (At 18:00 hrs)
D	Physical Submission of Earnest Money, Tender Fee, RISL Charges and other mandatory documents	23-10-2026 (At 13:00 hrs)	30-10-2026 (At 13:00 hrs)
E	Opening of Technical bid.	23-10-2026 (At 15:00 hrs)	30-10-2026 (At 15:00 hrs)
F	Opening of Price bid	Will be intimated to all qualified bidders	Will be intimated to all qualified bidders

All other terms & conditions of tender document shall remain unchanged.

DIPR/C/17984/2026 **Superintending Engineer, PHED, Circle Jhalawar**

Sundram Fasteners Limited
CIN: L35999TN1962PLC004943
Registered & Corporate Office : 98-A, VII Floor, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, Mylapore, Chennai - 600 004
Tel: +91 - 44 - 28478500 | Fax: 91 - 44 - 28478510
Email: investorshelpdesk@sfl.co.in | Website: www.sundram.com

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF-YEAR ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(₹ in Crores)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		Quarter ended	Half-Year ended	Quarter ended	Quarter ended	Half-Year ended	Quarter ended
		30.09.2026	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	30.09.2026	30.09.2026	30.09.2025
		(Unaudited)			(Unaudited)		
1	Total Revenue from Operations	1,760.77	3,375.53	1,338.37	1,984.50	3,830.57	1,521.02
2	Net Profit for the period (before tax and exceptional item)	214.76	417.99	186.92	230.55	454.09	201.80
3	Net Profit for the period (before tax)	214.76	417.99	186.92	230.55	454.09	201.80
4	Net Profit for the period (after tax)	159.98	310.95	140.27	172.63	341.32	152.75
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	170.23	322.20	151.99	191.11	366.99	175.41
6	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Re 1 each fully paid up)	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01
7	Earnings Per Share (EPS) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (Face value of Re 1/- each) (not annualised) (in Rs.)						
	(a) Basic	7.62	14.80	6.68	8.20	16.21	7.18
	(b) Diluted	7.62	14.80	6.68	8.20	16.21	7.18

Notes:

1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of the standalone and consolidated financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites, www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website www.sundram.com. The full financial results can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below.

2 The Statutory Auditors have carried out a limited review for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 and have issued an unmodified review report thereon.

Place : Chennai
Date : October 28, 2026

For Sundram Fasteners Limited

Suresh Krishna
Chairman

INBRIEF



UAE honours flydubai crew, Smit Machchhar for bravery

UAE President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan has conferred the First Class Order of Zayed II on Indian Captain Smit Machchhar and fellow flydubai crew members in recognition of their courageous efforts to ensure passenger safety during an attempted mid-air attack aboard a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight. The medals were presented by His Highness Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence, who commended the crew's actions and sense of responsibility, Dubai Media Office said in a statement on Tuesday. PTI

SC asks Sanjay Raut to appear in person over contempt case

The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the physical appearance of Shiv Sena (UBT) Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Raut in court on November 17 in a contempt case initiated by the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) over allegedly derogatory remarks made about the Chief Justice of India. A Bench headed by Justice Aravind Kumar allowed senior journalist Nikhil Wagle to appear virtually on the same day (November 17) in the same contempt case. Mr. Wagle, accused of making public comments of a disparaging manner against the CJI, was represented by senior advocate Indira Jaisingand has also filed an affidavit in response to the contempt notice.

HC notice to Centre, Meta for blocking Instagram account

The Delhi High Court has asked the Centre and Meta to respond to a plea against withholding the Instagram handle 'Bring Back Ballot', which published content advocating the use of paper ballots for elections. Justice Amit Mahajan, on October 27, issued notice on the petition by the account operator, organisation Mission Save Constitution, and its founder lawyer Mehmood Pracha, and listed the case for hearing on November 6. The petition said that on the day the organisation proposed to hold a peaceful protest, called "Bring Back Ballot - EVM Hatao Desh Bachao", at Jantar Mantar, it discovered that its handle was not available in India.

Early intervention vital for child development: CDC chief

Inclusive early childhood development (iECD) seeks to ensure that every child, including those with developmental delays, disabilities, autism and other forms of neurodivergence, has equitable access to healthcare, nutrition, protection, and early intervention, Deepa Bhaskaran, director, Child Development Centre (CDC), Thiruvananthapuram, said at a media workshop organised by UNICEF and PIB. It aimed to strengthen understanding of inclusive early childhood development, child rights and disability inclusion, promote ethical, child-sensitive and non-stigmatising reporting, and raise awareness of AI-related risks.

Regulator cuts prices of 543 anti-cancer medicines

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) on Wednesday revised downward the maximum retail price of 543 anti-cancer medicines of different brands, effective November 9.

On October 17, the NPPA had announced Trade Margin Rationalisation (TMR) of 137 non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs in public interest to address excessive trade margins, make cancer treatment more affordable, and improve access to anti-cancer medicines.

Meanwhile, Jan Swasthya Abhiyan India (JSA India), an organisation working for accessibility of medicines, said that controlling trade margins alone is insufficient. Life-saving cancer treatment must be affordable based on medical need, not a patient's ability to pay.

"For example, the reported MRP of one brand of palbociclib fell from approximately ₹40,421 to ₹2,720 per pack, while thiotepa fell from approximately ₹80,072 to ₹7,150 per vial. Such drastic reductions raise serious questions about the pricing practices of pharmaceutical companies," the group said.

Centre forms panel to probe death of young cheetah in M.P.'s Kuno

Wildlife officials say the animal may have been shot in self-defence after being mistaken for a leopard, but they have not yet ruled out poaching

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The Union government has formed a high-level committee for an on-ground investigation into the death of a 19-month-old cheetah cub due to gunshot injuries outside the boundaries of the Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh.

The Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, in a statement, said the Centre had taken "serious note" of the cub's death.

The three-member probe team will closely coordinate with the Madhya Pradesh Forest Department and the special task force constituted by the State to ensure strict and swift action in the matter, it added. The team will also review the security protocols and monitoring measures in place for the big cats.

"Viewing the matter with utmost gravity, the Centre has deputed a high-level team for an on-ground investigation into the incident, given the critical importance of Project Cheetah and the need to ensure the highest standards of protection for the reintroduced population of the Big Cat," it said.



Fragile existence: The Union government launched its ambitious reintroduction programme for cheetahs in September 2022. PTI

The team comprises the Inspector-General of Forests, National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA); Additional Director, Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB); and Regional Deputy Director, WCCB. "The Central team deputed by the MoEFCC would work in coordination with the State machinery. It would also examine the implementation of security protocols, as well as monitoring and protection measures being undertaken to avoid any such incident in future. The Central team would submit its findings and recommendations to the Ministry for further directions to the State Government and field authorities," the Ministry said.

Madhya Pradesh's top wildlife officials say that it could be a case of shooting in self-defence after mistaking the animal for a leopard, but have not ruled out the possibility of poaching.

Union Cabinet gives nod to ₹7,396-crore panchayat scheme

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

The five-year scheme will have a Central share of ₹4,869.48 crore and State share of ₹2,526.07 crore

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana (PM-VGSY), a ₹7,395.55-crore scheme aimed at strengthening the planning and governance capacities of gram panchayats over the next five years.

The scheme will be implemented from 2026-27 to 2030-31 with a Central share of ₹4,869.48 crore and a State share of ₹2,526.07 crore. The government said around 32 lakh elected representatives, panchayat functionaries and other stakeholders across 2.55 lakh gram panchayats and traditional local bodies would be trained under the programme.

The new scheme is an upgraded version of the Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan, with a greater emphasis on "holistic" development, as opposed to the existing practice of providing separate training modules for individual schemes. The idea is to offer "digital handholding" for the panchayat representatives to help them with evidence-based planning. Though the government refers to the 32 lakh representatives as "beneficiaries," it does not offer any stipend.

The scheme seeks to position gram panchayats as the focal point of local governance and development planning. It envisages preparing 2.55 lakh Gram Panchayat Development Plans (GDPDs) through the eGramSwaraj portal, enabling village-level priorities to align with Central and State government schemes and resources.

Awareness drives will be conducted across the country as part of the programme, with each campaign expected to reach at least one lakh citizens. A key element of PM-VGSY is the creation of a common digital platform that will integrate information on government schemes, beneficiaries, community assets and available resources. This will help panchayats identify development gaps, improve departmental coordination, and monitor implementation more effectively.

Railways to turn off charging points in trains during night

V. Geetanath
HYDERABAD

Train passengers will no longer be allowed to keep their mobile phones charging overnight, with the Railway Board issuing strict instructions to all zonal railways to switch off charging points between 11 p.m. and 5 a.m.

In an official communication, the Board has directed railway authorities to conduct surprise inspections in coaches during overnight journeys. Both officers and supervisory staff have been asked to ensure strict compliance with the directive, with no exceptions permitted under any circumstances.

Senior railway officials said a circular mandating the shutdown of mobile charging circuits during night travel had been issued more than a decade ago. However, the rule was apparently not being enforced consistently on some trains.

The Railway Board's renewed insistence on implementing the measure follows a recent incident in the South Eastern Railway zone. Railway staff reportedly failed to switch off charging points during the prescribed hours, leading to a power bank explosion while being charged.

However, some officials believe the focus should be on preventing the charging of power banks during the six-hour overnight period rather than restricting charging altogether.

They also argued that the number of charging points should not be increased indiscriminately.

SC agrees to hear AITUC challenge to definition of 'industry' in new law

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court agreed on Wednesday to hear a petition filed by the All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) Tamil Nadu challenging the definition of 'industry' under the Industrial Relations Code (IRC) 2020 as "deliciously vague", especially when the new law exempts a wide array of institutions from charitable to sovereign functions of the government.

The IRC affords legal protections to workers who are employed in institutions which come under the ambit of 'industry'. Section 2(p) of the IRC defines industry as any institution engaged in a "systematic activity carried on by co-operation between an employer and worker for the production, supply or distribution of goods or services with a view to satisfy human wants or wishes".



Appearing before a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan and advocate Aarthi Rajan, for the trade union, referred to the exceptions to 'industry' listed in the Code.

Mr. Sankaranarayanan submitted that the exceptions to 'industry' included institutions wholly or substantially engaged in charitable, social or philanthropic service to "any activity of the appropriate government relatable to sovereign functions" to "any other activity as may be notified by the Central government".

"Is there a problem with the definition of 'industry'?" Chief Justice Kant asked.

The senior counsel said the definition in the Code did not meet the requirements of the 'triple test'. A 1978 seven-judge Constitution Bench judgment, authored by Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer, in the *Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board v. A. Rajappa* case, had laid down conditions that any activity which was systematic or organised, operated on the basis of employer-employee cooperation and dealt in the production of goods and services to satisfy human wants came within the ambit of 'industry'. The judgment had brought even hospitals, educational institutions and municipalities within the fold of 'industry'.

In August 2026, a nine-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice Kant had reviewed the interpretation given by Justice Iyer in 1978 to the definition of 'industry' under Section 2(j) of the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947. However, the nine-judge Bench had been preceded by the coming into force of the 2020 Code, which largely made the reference to it infructuous.

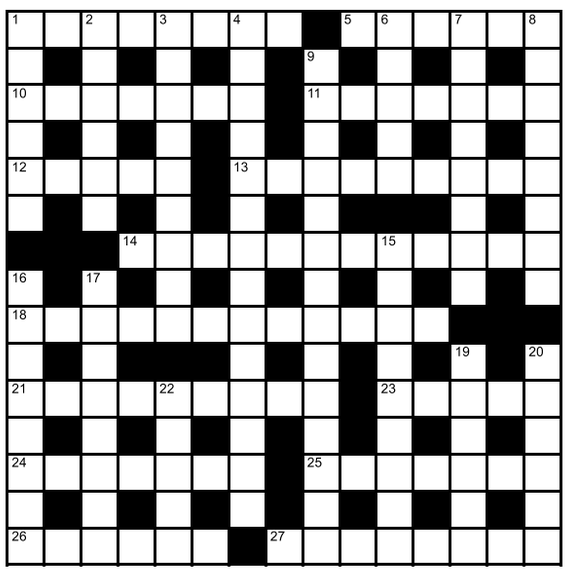
"The future of 'industry' in Section 2(p) of IRC is not burdened by the interpretation of 2(j) in the Industrial Disputes Act," Chief Justice Kant had observed.

TH CROSSWORD + 14935

(set by Afterdark)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Roadwork Company clerk at the outskirts to get a valve, say (8)
5 At the same time as wife, husband is crossing line on time (6)
10 Rowdy's cover at slums exposed (7)
11 A plane curve can be seen at eclipse, after initial cover disappears left (7)
12 A play in rugby looks odd after second choke-tackle in the front (5)
13 Old boy's toxic and disgusting (9)
14 Doctor reins her fear with an aerosol spray, perhaps (3,9)
18 Happiness at party after Sita's mingling (12)
21 Box kept near gate has arrack, essentially for the band (9)
23 Neighbour at North East has friend (5)
24 To that article, two leading reporters toiled one-third (7)
25 In release, Tom said - process of the temporal bone (7)
26 Break off with blonde, sister relayed (6)
27 Deadly deli, i.e barmen at both ends menacing (8)

Down

1 Rift in school is mushrooming primarily (6)
2 Aromas are forbidding in old society (6)
3 Disconcerted masculine insults (9)
4 Quotient of two integers derived from standard operation using Faraday's rule (6,8)
6 Curse over 50 individuals makes them a genus of snail (5)
7 A connector in friend's back's jagged at the tip, points to erosion at both ends (3,5)
8 Exchequer at Surrey vandalised (8)
9 Our primitive ancestor learnt, had men adopt one development (11,3)
15 Caught son turning inside on the description of a facial feature (4-5)
16 Different fool retweeted without no end (8)
17 Holders assemble rocket in ship (8)
19 One pill at the beginning and end by doctor's order advances calmness (6)
20 Vehicle found in a small ridge (6)
22 Time lost in matches for betting odds (5)

SUDOKU

			3			9		
				2				
	2	1		7			3	4
5		7			1			9
	6						4	
2			9			1		7
9	8			1		6	7	
				3				
		4			2			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

No.SS7045 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle

I	M	P	O	S	T		A	S
N		A		A			H	
A	D	O	R	I	N	G		D
R		V		D		S		L
D	I	S	E	M	B	O	W	E
		N		L		I		
S	C	U	B	A		S	I	D
U				S		S		E
S	P	R	I	N	T	E	R	
E		C				O		A
T	R	E	E		S	O	L	I
B		B		T		L		E
B	O	N	E	D	R	Y		I
W		R		U				C
L	I	G	H	T	S		K	E

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	7	6	2	3	9	8	1	5
5	3	2	8	1	6	9	4	7
8	1	9	7	5	4	6	2	3
3	6	8	1	2	7	5	9	4
1	2	4	9	8	5	3	7	6
7	9	5	6	4	3	2	8	1
2	5	3	4	9	1	7	6	8
9	4	7	5	6	8	1	3	2
6	8	1	3	7	2	4	5	9

FAITH

Karva Chauth significance

Celebrated on Chaturthi tithi of Krishna Paksha in the Karthik month, the festival of Karva Chauth is a significant occasion for married women in north India. They pray for their husbands' long life, prosperity and health. Culturally, the festival connects with the initiation of the Rabi crop in the agricultural calendar and culture of martial communities where the men went far away to battle and the women who were left behind worried and prayed for their well-being, said Prof. Kumool Abbi.

Elaborate rituals are part of this festival. Married women observe complete *nirjala* fast from sunrise to moonrise. A pre-dawn meal called *sargi* is offered by the in-laws for the married women to partake, before the fast. The important myths associated with the festival of Karva Chauth are those of Satyavan and Savitri, Karwa and Princess Veeranwali. The legend of Satyavan and Savitri, which is narrated by sage Markandeya in the Mahabharata, is widely shared on this occasion. Savitri, a princess chooses Satyavan as her husband, but is warned by sage Narada that he was destined to die in one year's time. When Yama arrives to take away Satyavan, Savitri follows him, discoursing on dharma with him. Impressed by her wisdom, Yama grants her a boon. She perseveres and he grants further boons, the last of which is the granting of Satyavan's life. This underscores the importance of dharma in one's life. The festival culminates with the sighting of moon and offering prayers and water (*argya)* to the moon using an earthen pot *karva*. The water is offered through a sieve as the moon rises and the fast is broken with water offered by the husband who is seen through the same sieve.

INBRIEF



City Union Bank Q2 net profit rises 26% to ₹416 crore

City Union Bank on Wednesday reported a 26% rise in net profit at ₹416 crore for the second quarter ended September 2026. The bank had a net profit of ₹329 crore in the July-September quarter of last fiscal. Interest income grew 27% to ₹2,092 crore in the second quarter of FY27, up from ₹1,653 crore in the corresponding quarter of FY26. Net non-performing assets improved to 0.48% in the September quarter of FY27, from 0.90% in the year-earlier period. PTI

Hyundai Motor India Q2 net profit falls 24% to ₹1,196 crore

Hyundai Motor India Ltd. (HMIL) reported a 24% year-on-year (YoY) decline in Q2 standalone net profit to ₹1,196 crore, as against ₹1,572 crore a year earlier, as elevated commodity prices weighed on profitability. Revenue, however, rose 19% YoY to ₹20,696 crore. "Commodity headwinds weighed on profitability, however operating leverage, healthy mix and cost reduction initiatives helped improve EBITDA margin sequentially," HMIL said in a filing.

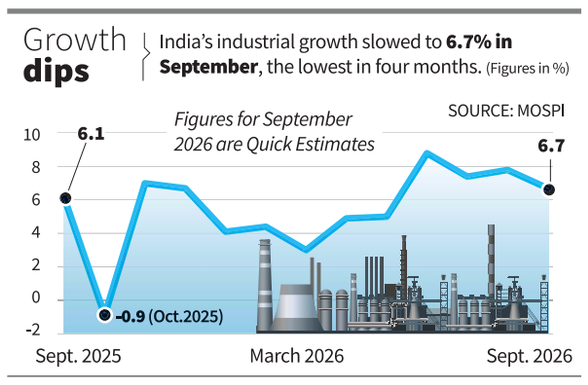
GAIL India to invest $63 mn in heating unit at Ratnagiri

GAIL India is investing ₹6 billion ($63.1 million) to build a heating unit at its Ratnagiri LNG terminal to help it gasify the super-chilled fuel, the company's business development director told reporters on Wednesday. The facility, due to be completed by June 2027, will enable the company to run the LNG terminal at its full capacity of 5 MTPA, R.K. Singhal said. The facility is operating at about 50% capacity as the heating unit is not ready, Mr. Singhal said. REUTERS

Industrial growth eases to 4-month low of 6.7% in Sept.

Growth in 10 out of the 11 sectors covered in the index was slower in Sept. than it was in August; 8 of 23 manufacturing sub-segments, with weight of 22.2% in IIP, recorded double-digit expansion

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI



Growth in industrial production slowed to a four-month low of 6.7% in September 2026, with nearly every sector slowing as compared to the previous month, the latest official data shows.

Data on the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) on Wednesday, showed that growth in 10 out of the 11 sectors covered was slower in September than it was in August.

The IIP had grown 7.8% in August 2026 as per the revised data.

"The deceleration was broad-based, with all the four sectors [by economic activity] recording a deterioration in their year-on-year performance between these months," Aditi Nayar, chief economist at ICRA said. Ms. Nayar also noted that, while the growth in manufacturing output eased to 7.6% in September 2026 from 8.6% in August 2026, partly on account of an unfavourable base, this growth remained "quite healthy".

"As many as eight of the 23 manufacturing sub-segments, with a weight of 22.2% in the IIP, recorded a double-digit expansion in September 2026," she pointed out.

Auto sector-driven

According to Madan Sabnavis, chief economist at the Bank of Baroda, manufacturing growth was driven by the automobile sector and electrical machinery, with some help coming from rubber products, computers, electronics, and non-metallic machinery.

India and Mexico to start trade deal talks

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

India and Mexico on Wednesday signed the Terms of Reference (ToR) to start negotiations on a trade deal between the two countries, the government announced following the signing in Mexico.

The signing of the ToR follows an understanding reached between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum during their meeting on the sidelines of the G7 Summit in Canada in June 2025.

"Mexico and India take an important step towards strengthening their economic and trade relations with the signing of the Terms of Reference for negotiations on a Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA), which establish the framework, scope, modalities and roadmap for negotiations aimed at creating new economic opportunities for both countries," the government said in a release. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal represented the Indian side.

Jio Platforms debuts with a 21% premium

Gowri Lakshmi
MUMBAI

Jio Platforms Ltd (JPL) made a strong stock market debut on Wednesday, listing at ₹1,358, a 21.36% premium over its issue price of ₹1,119. The stock extended gains to close at ₹1,417.50, up nearly 4.4% from its listing price.

The debut came amid a weak broader market. The Sensex plunged 995 points in early trade before recovering to close 352.64 points, or 0.48%, lower at 73,246.03. The Nifty settled below 22,700 as rising crude oil prices, selling in IT stocks and caution ahead of the U.S. Federal Reserve's policy decision weighed on sentiment.

"My heart overflows with gratitude. Gratitude to every individual, every institutional investor in India and abroad, who made our IPO a blockbuster success," Akash Ambani, JPL's MD, said at the NSE listing ceremony. The ₹32,000-crore IPO was subscribed more than 22 times, attracting demand exceeding ₹7.4 lakh crore.

LTM launches GCC Origin as IT firms race to serve global capability centres

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI


Venu Lambu

LTM, formerly LTIMindtree, has launched GCC Origin, a dedicated business unit to help enterprises establish, operate, scale and transform global capability centres (GCCs) in India, as technology services companies step up efforts to tap growing demand for such centres.

The move formalises LTM's GCC-as-a-Service offering, launched in July 2025, into a standalone business with dedicated leadership, sales and delivery teams, specialist expertise and significant investment. Shailendra Singh will lead the unit and report to Venu Lambu, CEO and Managing Director, LTM.

The launch reflects a broader industry trend, with Indian IT services companies and workforce solutions providers developing specialised offerings to help multinational corporations establish and expand their technology and business operations in the country.

Quess Corp launched its GCC-as-a-Service offering, Origint, in June 2025. Infosys unveiled its AI-First GCC Model in November 2025, while Tata Consultancy Services launched its Global Value & Innovation Centres business unit in June 2026. Cognizant, HCLTech, Wipro, Accenture and Tech Mahindra are also targeting the market through dedicated practices and services.

GCC Origin integrates strategy, artificial intelligence (AI), technology, talent, infrastructure, operations and ecosystem partnerships.

Its services include site selection, workplace and infrastructure development, operational readiness and turnkey facilities across Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities.

The unit will leverage BlueVerse, LTM's agentic AI ecosystem, to help enterprises establish new GCCs and transform existing centres into AI-native operations.

Its offerings span strategy and advisory, talent acquisition and development, AI agents and studios, automation, business operations and the transfer of capabilities and operational ownership.

Clients can opt for the entire GCC lifecycle or individual services through models such as Assisted GCC, Build-Operate-Transform-Transfer, Virtual GCC, joint ventures, staff augmentation and Hire-Operate-Transfer.

'India requires $220 billion for green power transition by FY30'

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

India's renewable energy sector will need $220 billion in investment between FY27 and FY30, spanning generation, transmission, manufacturing and emerging green technologies, Santosh Sarangi, Secretary, Union Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, said.

Another senior official told reporters at the curtain-raiser for the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo 2026 that solar energy would account for $70-75 billion of the requirement followed by transmission infrastructure at $40-45 billion, wind energy at $25-30 billion and green hydrogen at $20-25 billion. Manufacturing will require another $15-20 billion, the official said.

The sector attracted about $64 billion in private investment between July 2024 and June 2026, including $6.2 billion in foreign direct investment. The Centre infused $6 billion to support renewable energy development.

Mr. Sarangi said Indian green hydrogen developers got orders to supply 5.5 lakh tonne until 2026. The Ministry is developing a framework for geothermal exploration rights similar to hydrocarbon sector.

L&T eyes ₹15 lakh-cr. order book by 2031

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Larsen & Toubro (L&T) is aiming at almost doubling order book to ₹15 lakh crore by 2031 on expansion in energy, electrolysers, semiconductors, data centres and manufacturing, president and whole-time director (finance) R Shankar Raman said.

The engineering and construction conglomerate is also focusing on renewables, hydrogen, automation and strengthening its services business to drive long-term growth.

"Manufacturing thrust, consolidation and automating construction infrastructure, making the new areas of renewable and hydrogen work and pushing the services business forward, all of these together, will make the company far far stronger from what it is today by 2031," Mr. Raman told journalists.

TVS Motor decides to demerge consumer finance businesses

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

TVS Motor Company plans to demerge consumer finance and related businesses into a separate holding company, allowing it to sharpen focus on mobility while giving financial services operations greater strategic autonomy.

The announcement came as the two- and three-wheeler maker reported record quarterly revenue of ₹17,103 crore for the September quarter of FY27, up 44% year-on-year. Net profit surged 52% to ₹1,377 crore.



Q2 net surged to ₹1,377 crore

The board okayed a Composite Scheme of Arrangement under which investors would get an equal number of shares in the resulting firm as they hold in TVS Motor. The revamp is to boost capital allocation and allow finance unit to pursue opportunities across consumer finance and related sectors.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
INDIAN SPACE RESEARCH ORGANISATION
(CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP)
ISRO-TELEMETRY TRACKING & COMMAND NETWORK (ISTRAC)
Plot No.12 &13, 3rd Main, 2nd Phase, Peenya Industrial Estate, Bengaluru-58.
Fax: 080-28094180. Ph: 080-28094185, 4144, 4145, 4541

CORRIGENDUM-III Dated: 27.10.2026

1. On behalf the President of India, **item rate E-Tender** is invited from Contractors of appropriate class for the following work.

NIT No.	**ISTRAC/CMG/E/CON/E-Tender-56/ 2026-2027 Dated: 23.07.2026**
Name of work	**Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Power Fencing System at IDSN Campus, ISTRAC, Byalalu.**
Estimated Cost put to Tender	**Rs. 132.06 Lakhs**
Tender Document details	**E-Tender**
Period of Completion	**08 Months**
Period during which the tender documents can be downloaded	From 16.00 hrs. on 24.07.2026 to 26.09.2026 till 16.00 hrs. **Extended up to 15.11.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.**
Bid clarifications	From 11.00 hrs. 25.07.2026 to 27.09.2026 till 16.00 hrs. **Extended up to 16.11.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.**
Last date of reply to Bid clarification	28.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. **Extended up to 17.11.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.**
Last date & time for receipt of tenders	29.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. **Extended up to 18.11.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.**
Due date & time of opening of tenders	01.10.2026 after 11.00 hrs. **Extended up to 20.11.2026 after 11.00 hrs.**
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	**Rs. 2,64,120/-**

2. Interested tenderers may please refer to the Detailed Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) for eligibility criteria and other details in website: **www.isro.gov.in** and download the tender documents from **www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO.**

Sd/- Group Head-CMG

TVS MOTOR COMPANY LIMITED
Regd office: "Chaitanya", No. 12, Khader Nawaz Khan Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai 600 006
Website : www.tvsmotor.com Telephone No. : (044) 28332115 Email : corpsec@tvsmotor.com
CIN:L35921TN1992PLC022845

STATEMENT OF STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER 2026
(Rs. in Crores)

S. No	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		Quarter ended		Year ended	Quarter ended		Year ended
		30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026
		(Unaudited)		(Audited)	(Unaudited)		(Audited)
1	Total income from operations	17,103.41	11,905.43	47,270.32	19,474.44	14,051.22	56,069.52
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	1,864.55	1,223.85	4,944.89	1,791.14	1,223.29	4,871.82
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	1,864.55	1,223.85	4,903.52	1,791.14	1,223.29	4,821.74
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	1,377.15	903.64	3,615.22	1,219.45	832.76	3,186.43
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income / (Loss) (after tax)]	1,382.38	912.08	3,780.58	1,252.48	911.44	3,693.34
6	Paid up Equity share capital (Face value of Re.1/- each)	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-	-	11,186.79	-	-	9,516.74
8	Securities Premium Account	- NOT APPLICABLE -					
9	Networth	13,890.65	9,727.91	11,348.62	10,933.99	7,952.49	9,187.21
10	Outstanding Debt	5,088.25	2,413.88	2,733.36	32,918.14	25,814.24	27,697.48
11	Outstanding Non Convertible Redeemable Preference Shares (NCRPS)	-	1,900.35	1,900.35	-	1,900.35	1,900.35
12	Debt Equity Ratio (Times) (Debt includes NCRPS)	0.37	0.25	0.24	2.90	3.18	2.60
13	Earnings Per Share (Face value of Re. 1/- each) (not annualised) (i) Basic (in Rs.) (ii) Diluted (in Rs.)	28.99 28.99	19.02 19.02	76.09 76.09	25.14 25.14	16.74 16.74	63.53 63.53
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	- NOT APPLICABLE -					
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	- NOT APPLICABLE -					
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiary) (Times)	7.89	5.82	4.77	5.63	3.85	3.03
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiary) (Times)	17.65	31.77	29.64	13.15	18.89	17.75
18	Current Ratio (Times)	0.75	0.54	0.54	1.09	1.08	0.97
19	Long term debt to working capital (Times)	-	-	-	1.83	2.08	2.46
20	Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio (Times)	-	-	-	-	-	-
21	Current liability ratio (Times)	0.72	0.89	0.88	0.64	0.62	0.70
22	Total debts to total assets ratio (Times)	0.17	0.14	0.12	0.57	0.59	0.56
23	Debtors Turnover ratio (Times)	26.93	29.17	28.08	24.99	26.98	25.66
24	Inventory Turnover ratio (Times)	23.77	17.45	20.37	16.90	13.08	14.31
25	Operating Margin (%)	13.0	12.7	12.9	11.3	11.7	11.5
26	Net Profit Margin (%)	8.1	7.6	7.6	6.3	5.9	5.7

Notes:
1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.The full format of the financial results are available on the Stock exchange websites (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and on Company's website (www.tvsmotor.com).
2 Figures for the previous periods have been regrouped, wherever necessary, to conform to the current period's classification.
3 The detailed financial results of the Company for the Quarter ended 30th September 2026 can be accessed through the QR code.

For TVS Motor Company Limited
Sd/-
Sudarshan Venu
Chairman

Date : 28.10.2026

TVS HOLDINGS LIMITED
(Formerly known as Sundaram-Clayton Limited)
Regd office: "Chaitanya", No.12, Khader Nawaz Khan Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai 600 006.
Tel : 044-2833 2115 Website : www.tvsholdings.com Email : corpsec@tvsholdings.com
CIN : L64200TN1962PLC004792

STATEMENT OF STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER 2026
(Rs. in Crores)

S. No	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		Quarter ended		Year ended	Quarter ended		Year ended
		30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026
		(Unaudited)		(Audited)	(Unaudited)		(Audited)
1	Total income from operations	112.12	56.91	516.34	20,182.53	14,549.15	58,154.50
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax and Exceptional items)	16.94	22.25	373.42	1,992.19	1,281.73	5,169.14
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional items)	1,029.38	22.25	373.10	1,992.19	1,281.73	5,118.74
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	930.70	19.30	322.30	1,285.68	880.08	3,390.19
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income / (Loss) (after tax)]	930.75	16.65	317.29	1,318.82	956.12	3,889.32
6	Paid up Equity share capital (Face value of Rs.5/- each)	10.12	10.12	10.12	10.12	10.12	10.12
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-	-	1,744.31	-	-	6,455.61
8	Securities Premium Account	36.42	36.42	36.42	36.42	36.42	36.42
9	Networth	1,759.97	1,634.46	1,750.83	5,277.69	4,518.23	5,070.00
10	Outstanding Debt	2,523.76	943.81	1,593.08	45,553.39	34,480.23	36,156.34
11	Outstanding Non Convertible Redeemable Preference Shares (NCRPS)	930.68	-	-	930.68	-	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio (including exceptional item)	1.37	0.57	0.90	5.81	5.32	4.88
13	Earnings Per Share (Face value of Rs. 5/- each) (not annualised) (in Rs.) (i) Basic (ii) Diluted	460.01 460.01	9.54 9.54	159.30 159.30	313.75 313.75	218.89 218.89	838.12 838.12
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiary) (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiary) (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
18	Current Ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
19	Long term debt to working capital (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
20	Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
21	Current liability ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
22	Total debts to total assets ratio (Times)	0.56	0.35	0.44	0.59	0.59	0.56
23	Debtors Turnover ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
24	Inventory Turnover ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
25	Operating Margin (%)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
26	Net Profit Margin (%)	13.62	33.87	62.45	6.35	6.04	5.91

Notes:
1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results are available on the Stock exchange websites (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and on company's website (www.tvsholdings.com).
2 Figures for the previous periods have been regrouped, wherever necessary, to conform to the current period's classification.
3 The Detailed Financial Results of the Company for the Quarter and Half year ended 30th September 2026 can be accessed through the QR code.

For TVS Holdings Limited
Sd/-
Venu Srinivasan
Chairman

Place : Bengaluru
Date : 28.10.2026

WASHINGTON

Trump says meeting with Putin, Zelenskyy to be set up 'very soon'



AFP

U.S. President Donald Trump said on Wednesday that a meeting between Russian President Vladimir Putin and his Ukrainian counterpart Volodymyr Zelenskyy would be set up "very soon." The Kremlin and Mr. Zelenskyy had earlier said that a meeting between Kyiv, Washington and Moscow would take place in November. AFP

PESHAWAR

One killed, five injured in gunfire along Afghanistan-Pakistan border



AFP

One person was killed and five injured after Afghan Taliban fired at civilian houses and a market in Angoor Adda town in Pakistan's Waziristan, near the countries' border, Pakistan officials said on Wednesday. Pakistani forces responded with a "brief operation targeting the Afghan side with artillery fire", an official said. AFP

TEHRAN

Iranian court sentences filmmaker Jafar Panahi to five years in prison



AP

An Iranian court has sentenced renowned filmmaker Jafar Panahi in absentia to over five years in prison, Iranian media said. The court also imposed a two-year travel ban. Mr. Panahi, whose film *It Was Just an Accident* won the top prize at the 2025 Cannes film festival, has been arrested several times in the past for his filmmaking. AFP

UNITED NATIONS

For the 34th year, UN condemns U.S. economic embargo on Cuba



AP

The U.N. General Assembly decided overwhelmingly on Wednesday to condemn the U.S. economic embargo of Cuba for the 34th year even as Washington's campaign to influence the outcome led to a number of countries voting against the resolution or sitting out the vote for the first time. The vote was 130-17, with 25 abstentions. AP

At least 68 people killed in Spain's second major train crash in a year

Computer malfunction causes trains to stop; Transport Minister says crash was due to 'inexplicable' decision from a central command centre to resume services; second fatal accident in nine months on a network seen as a source of national pride

Associated Press
URDA

A high-speed train slammed into another that had stopped on the tracks in Spain on Wednesday, killing at least 68 people and injuring dozens in the second deadly rail collision this year.

Spain's Transport Minister Oscar Puente said that the accident was caused by what he called the "inexplicable" order from a central command centre for trains after a security system had failed.

Spain's rail system operator ADIF said the crash occurred on Wednesday morning in the province of Toledo, involving two high-speed trains carrying hundreds of passengers and heading in the same direction from the capital Madrid to Seville.



Rail ruins: Emergency services work at the site of the train collision in Toledo, Spain, on Wednesday. AFP

A train operated by the state-owned RENFE company struck the rear of another train operated by private company IRYO that was stopped. The collision derailed two carriages on the tail of the IRYO train and the front of the RENFE train.

January accident

The accident comes with memories still fresh of another train crash in January involving trains from the same two companies, in which 46 people died.

The regional government for Castilla La Mancha confirmed the death toll and said 58 people needed medical treatment. Rescue workers continue to search for survivors and bodies.

Transport Minister Puente said that at 8:30 a.m., the security system on a stretch of 63 kilometres stopped working due to a computer malfunction, causing all trains on that stretch to stop. But the central command told the RENFE train to start running again without any speed restrictions, and it ended up colliding with the stopped IRYO train at 8:53 a.m.

"Today all of Spain is grieving," Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez said from the crash site, where he announced three days of national mourning.

Until this year, there had been no fatal crash on Spain's high-speed lines since the network opened in 1992. It was a source of national pride.

Iran warns any new Israel-led attack will 'devastate' markets

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran on Wednesday warned of a devastating economic impact from any new Israeli-led attack, as the votes were counted in an Israeli election that could determine the future of the regional war.

"Devastating impact on international markets of any Israel-instigated military misadventure in Persian Gulf region remains major concern for both gas suppliers and consumers," Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said in a post on X, referring to recent talks at the gas exporters' summit in Moscow.

Since the war erupted, it has severely disrupted energy shipments from



Abbas Araghchi

Gulf countries after Iran began blockading the Strait of Hormuz.

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, vying to form a coalition government, has said Israel has an opportunity to eliminate the "existential threat" posed by Iran.

Tehran has said the outcome of the polls "makes no difference".

After fleeing Brazil, Flavio Bolsonaro lands in U.S.

Agence France-Presse
OPA-LOCKA

Brazil's defeated presidential candidate Flavio Bolsonaro and his family arrived in Florida, U.S., by a private plane on Wednesday, after defying a court order that banned him from leaving his country.

Following speculation over his whereabouts, Mr. Bolsonaro was seen disembarking the jet at Opa-Locka Executive Airport outside Miami, having flown through Argentina and Ecuador.

Mr. Bolsonaro who lost a run-off election to incumbent Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva on Sunday, is under investigation in Brazil for alleged corruption and money laundering.

What has driven the high Arab turnout in Israel's elections?

NEWS ANALYSIS

Sambavi Parthasarathy

Israel's October 27 legislative elections have recorded a massive voter turnout of 77.7%, the highest since 1999. The country's Arab citizens, who turned up in massive numbers to vote, remained one of the main factors, contributing to the surge.

While the official figures providing voter turnout among Israeli Arabs is yet to be released by the Central Elections Committee, exit polls recorded by Channel 12 estimate Arab voter turnout to be nearly 80%. This implies that the voter turnout among Arab citizens in Israel would be the highest in at least a decade.

While Arabs account for about 21% of Israel's population, the parties representing them have never held more than 15 seats in the 120-member Knesset. Their turnout in the elections has also been relatively low with about 40% of the eligible Arab adults abstaining from voting in most Knesset elections over the past two decades.

"In the previous elections, I think the low voter turnout was a result of disappointment mainly from Arab parties themselves. We know that approximately 10% of Arab citizens boycott Knesset elections for

Arab voter turnout is estimated to be nearly 80%, the highest in at least a decade, according to exit polls

ideological reasons but the majority are reluctant to take part in this political game because of the conduct of their parties," said Arik Rudnitzky, from the Israel Democracy Institute in Jerusalem.

This trend was defied in the latest election. "I believe the number one motivator specifically in these elections is fear. Fear of another term of a Netanyahu government or a right-wing government because Arab citizens have had enough in the past four years," Mr. Rudnitzky told *The Hindu*.

'Life and death'

This surge was used by Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and his coalition to mobilise right-wing voters. Mr. Netanyahu, on his X, called on his supporters to vote for Likud and described the situation as a "matter of life and death".

His posts tried to mobilise voters by calling the situation "a war at home." This attempt was criticised by Arab parties for being racist and for inciting hatred.

A survey by the Israel Democracy Institute published in September revealed that a party's position regarding foreign affairs and security, followed by the economy and high cost of living were the two most influential factors determining the support of Jewish Israelis.

In contrast, more than half of the surveyed Arabs felt that the party's position regarding crime in Arab society was one of the most important factors determining their vote.

A large voter turnout among Israeli Arabs is expected to benefit the Arab parties, thereby improving the chances of Arab representation in the Knesset committees and better policies or support for them. This is evident in the exit polls and latest numbers which have put Arab parties leading in at least 17 seats in the Knesset.

However, it is also true that not all Arab citizens support Arab parties. "In general, approximately 15% of the Arab or Arab citizens support non-Arab parties, Jewish parties. Most of them support centrist parties. Also, the Democrats headed by Yair Golan enjoy relative significant support in the Arab sector," said Mr. Rudnitzky.

Latest numbers also show that neither the Netanyahu-bloc or the opposition coalition is set to secure a clear majority, meaning that Arab parties could hold the key as to who forms the government this time.

Saudi strikes kill 14 in Yemen: Houthis

Agence France-Presse
ADEN

Yemen's Houthis said Saudi strikes killed more than a dozen people on Wednesday, while the Iran-aligned group targeted the airport in government stronghold Aden.

On Wednesday, Houthi broadcaster Almasirah reported 14 dead "and 15 wounded, including women and children in a preliminary toll," in attacks it blamed on Saudi Arabia in Jawf province, where it reported strikes on a market and a petrol station.

Aden airport targeted

In Aden, a Houthi missile fell inside the perimeter of the airport shortly before the group issued a call to evacuate the area, a local police source said. The group targeted the airport again later.

"Our forces call on those present at Aden airport to immediately evacuate due to the presence of a military cargo plane belonging to the Saudi enemy transporting weapons to kill the sons of the Yemeni people," Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree said.

डॉ. सर्वपल्ली राधाकृष्णन् राजस्थान आयुर्वेद विश्वविद्यालय, जोधपुर
प्रशासनिक ब्लाक नवीन रोड, करवड़, जोधपुर (पिन नं. 342037)
Web side : www.raujodhpur.org , E-mail- dsrrau.ao@gmail.com

क्रमांक :- रा.आ.वि./जोध/लेखा/निविदा/2025-26/399 दिनांक :- 16/10/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Tenders are invited from interested bidders for Dr. S.R. Rajasthan Ayurved University, Karwad, Jodhpur. Whose details are as followings:-

1. **UBN No. AUJ2627SLRC00035** TENDER FOR E-PROCUREMENT for Housekeeping (Two Year) at DSRRAU, Jodhpur
2. **UBN No. AUJ2627SLRC00036** TENDER FOR E-PROCUREMENT for Security (Two Year) at DSRRAU, Jodhpur

All particulars of the bid may be visited on the portal **https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/ and https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in/.**
राज.संवाद/सी/26/12499 कुलसचिव

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, PHED, REGION, BHARATPUR
Phone : 05644-222731, e-mail : rj_acebha@nic.in
Corrigendum No. 01, NIT No. 18/2026-27

The following corrigendum is hereby issued for the NIB No. 18/2026-27 of this office in sppp/e-proc site.

Activity	NIT No. 18/2026-27	
	Existing Provision	Amended Provision
Availability of Bid Document	29/09/2026 to 26/10/2026 06:00 PM	29/09/2026 to 02/11/2026 06:00 PM
Last date & time for Online Submission of Bid Document	up to 26/10/2026 06:00 PM	up to 02/11/2026 06:00 PM
Last date & time for physical Submission of Bid Security and other mandatory Documents	Up to 01:00 PM on 27/10/2026	Up to 01:00 PM on 03/11/2026
Date of online opening of Technical Bids	27/10/2026 03:00 PM	03/11/2026 03:00 PM

All other terms and conditions shall remain same as mentioned in original NIT

NIB Code : PHE2627A2857 **(Mohan Lal Meena)**
UBN No. : PHE2627WLOB06042 **Addl. Chief Engineer**
DIPR/C/17980/2026 **PHED, Region Bharatpur**

BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(Wholly Owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER (NIT)
(Through KPP Portal Only)
No: BESCOM/CGM(Proj)/DGM-1/AGM-1/BC-14/26-27/CYS-250 Date: 28.10.2026

BESCOM Invites a tender for the work of **"Replacement of existing 11KV OH line into UG Cable system in Davanagere City Sub-Division-1, Davanagere Division, Davanagere circle, BESCOM"** on Total Turnkey basis under Percentage Quoting basis.
Tender Enquiry No:**BESCOM/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT 1183**. Availability of Bid documents: **31.10.2026 onwards.** Last date for submission of bid Queries: **13.11.2026 before 17:00 Hrs.** Pre-Bid meeting: **16.11.2026 @ 11:00 Hrs.** Venue of Pre-Bid meeting: **Office of the Chief General Manager (Ele), 4th Floor, Project Section, B Block, Corporate office, BESCOM, K. R Circle, Bangalore- 560001.** Last date & Time for bid submission: **01.12.2026 before 15:00 Hrs.** Opening of Technical Bids: **02.12.2026 @ 15:30 Hrs.**
The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the e-procurement portal from the website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** E-procurement Help Desk: Phone No: +91-8046010000 +91-8068948777. E-mail: **support@eprochelpdesk.com**
Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on e-procurement portal. Bidders can take the assistance from the e-procurement during office working hours.

For Electricity Related Complaints Call: 1912
Download BESCOM MITHRA Mobile App.

Sd/-
Chief General Manager (Ele)
Projects, Corporate Office, BESCOM.
K. R. Circle. Bengaluru.-560001.

THE KANCHEEPURAM-THIRUVALLUR DISTRICT CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LIMITED,
X37, KAKKALUR DAIRY, THIRUVALLUR DISTRICT – 602 003.
Ref. No.:2531/Admin/2026 **TWO PART TENDER** Dated : 27.10.2026

Online tender invitation for the period of **2 years 2026 – 2028** for engaging Vehicle on Rental Basis for Milk Collection Routes, Input Taxi Services and Milk Collection Routes.
Ref: 4876/P&I/2026

1.	**A) Milk Collection routes for Chengalpattu, Kancheepuram and Thiruvallur Districts from MPCS to nearby BMC, CC and Dairy - 35 No's** **Chengalpattu District** : Perungaranai, Anoor, Thiruvathur, Elappakkam, Seevadi, Pandithamedu, Thirukazhukundram, Thathalur, Kalpattu, Nugumbal, Uthiramerur, Sirungozhi, Madhur, Pavunjur, Nerumbur, Kunnapattu, Salavedu, Echur, Veerakuppam, Ramapuram, Kayar, Ponthavaakam. **Thiruvallur District** : Nadukuppam, Kilambakkam, Thirumathulambakkam, Sembedu, Ellampalli, Thandalam, Thumbikulam. **Kancheepuram District :** Thirumalpur, Thamal, Manamathi, Natteri, Kalavai, Irungur.
	B) Input Taxi – 2 No's (Thiruvallur & Chengalpattu Districts).
2.	**C) Insulated Milk Distribution Routes -** Chengalpattu, Kancheepuram and Thiruvallur Districts - **9 No's** (Minjur, Tiruttani, Thiruvalangadu, Uthiramerur, Pallipattu, Kanchipuram, Gummidipoondi, Acharapakkam, Thiruporur)

The tender details visit **www.tntenders.gov.in** Tender documents submitted without the required enclosures will be summarily rejected. Last date for online submission **30.11.2026** timing **05.00 PM.**
DIPR/3243/TENDER/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER**

TAMILNADU MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)
No. 417, Pantheon Road, Chennai-600 008. Phone: 044-2819 1890, 2819 0259
Website: www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in E-Mail: gmdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in, mngrpurdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in

Online Tenders is invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Ltd., Chennai – 600008, from the bidders meeting the eligibility criteria indicated in the tender document for the supply of **Reagents and Testing Kits** to TNMSC Ltd for two years from the date of acceptance of the tender.

Sl. No.	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids
1.	Online Tender for the Supply of **Reagents and Testing Kits** to TNMSC Limited for two years from the date of acceptance	e-026/M(P)/ KITS-REAG/ TNMSC/2026, Dated. 30.10.2026	30.10.2026 at 4.00 PM to 30.11.2026 upto 3.00 PM	09.11.2026 at 10.00 AM to 30.11.2026 upto 3.00 PM	30.11.2026 at 4.00 PM

The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at **https://tntenders.gov.in/.** The tender document can also be downloaded at **www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in** for reference purpose.
DIPR/3226/Tender/2026 **Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)**

WORKS DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, EASTERN CIRCLE (R&B), BALESHWAR
e-mail:- seec_bls@rediffmail.com
Government of Odisha **"e" Procurement Notice**
Bid Identification No. CCEEC-18/2026-27
No. : 7069 / Dt.:15/10/26

Nature of work	:- Road Work.
Number of works	:- 01 No. Road
Amount put to Tender	:- Rs.311.58 Lakh
Class of Contractor	:- "A" Class
Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	:- Dt. 31.10.2026 at 10.00 AM
Last Date / Time of receipt of bid in the portal	:- Dt. 16.11.2026 up to 05.00 PM
Date of opening of bid	:- Dt. 17.11.2026 at 11.00 AM
Name & address of the Office inviting bid	:- Chief Construction Engineer, Eastern Circle (R&B), Baleshwar.

The bidders have to participate in **ONLINE** bidding only. Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal **"http//tendersodisha.gov.in"**. All future corrigendum will be available on ONLINE mode only.
34001/1037/2627 Chief Construction Engineer, Eastern Circle (R&B), Baleshwar
OIPR-34001/34026/1/26-27/0020

Mail ID :- sepwdsbp@rediffmail.com
GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, NORTHERN (R&B) CIRCLE: SAMBALPUR
e - Procurement
BID IDENTIFICATION No CCENC (R AND B)/07/2026-27
No.4076 Dtd.26/10/2026

1. The **Chief Construction Engineer, Northern (R&B) Circle, Sambalpur** on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites **Percentage Rate** bids in double cover system **in ONLINE MODE** for the construction of **Building Works** as detailed in the DTCN from the eligible class of contractors.
2. No of works = **06 (Six) (BUILDING Works)**
3. Tender Cost : **Rs.10,000/-**
4. Class of contractor : **"B" Class & "A" Class**
5. Date & Time of available in web site & receipt of Bids : From **10.11.2026 to 17.00 Hours of 25.11.2026.**
6. Date of opening of Technical Bid : **26.11.2026 at 11.00 Hours.**
7. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**.
8. Any corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**.

34001/1070/2627 Chief Construction Engineer, Northern (R&B) Circle, Sambalpur.
OIPR-34001/34035/1/26-27/0006

SPIN TRIO

Sneh looks forward to bowling with Deepti and Ecclestone



FILE PHOTO: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Whichever team I go to, I want to give my best for them. Now that I've joined Warriorz, I want to do the same. It's a spin-heavy bowling unit. Deepti Sharma and Sophie Ecclestone will be operating with me. It's going to be a lot of fun — Sneh Rana who was bought by the UP outfit for ₹30 lakh.

BIG SIGNING

Molineux gives us a lot of quality and flexibility: UP coach Nayar



CREIMAS/BCCI

We went into the auction with a clear idea. Sophie Molineux was a key addition for us, and we are delighted to have secured her services. Along with Grace Harris, Sneh Rana and the other players we have brought in, she gives us a lot of quality and flexibility — Abhishek Nayar, UP Warriorz head coach.

KEY TARGET

Kamalini provides an aggressive option, says Giants coach Klinger



AP

Gujarat Giants head coach Michael Klinger was delighted with the acquisition of wicketkeeper-batter G. Kamalini and the make-up of the squad. "Kamalini gives us an aggressive option in our batting order. The new signings complement our retained players. We are pleased with how the squad has come together," he said.

PRIZE CATCH

Tryon adds depth to our batting and is a handy bowler too: Malolan



FILE PHOTO

I'm very happy to have Chloe Tryon in our squad. She is a very experienced player who has been figuring in franchise leagues and performing well. She adds depth to our line-up, with the ability to bat anywhere between No. 4 and No. 7. She is very handy with her left-arm spin — Malolan Rangarajan, RCB head coach.

Molineux, Kiran top earners; Kashvi scripts history

Warriorz draft in the T20 World Cup-winning captain for ₹1.10 crore; the Indian big-hitter to turn out for Capitals after being bought for ₹75 lakh; the 15-year-old is the youngest to make a WPL squad







Star attractions: Warriorz were so keen on Molineux that they raised the paddle as soon as her name was announced. Kiran and Kashvi will hope to be the points of difference for Capitals.
GETTY IMAGES, K. MURALI KUMAR & SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

WPL AUCTION

P.K. Ajith Kumar
KOCHI

Just a cricket ball's throw away from Hyatt Grand lies the peaceful Vembanad Lake. The WPL's mini auction, held at Grand Hyatt's Vembanad Hall, was about just as peaceful on Wednesday evening: there weren't that many fierce bidding wars.

That wasn't really surprising. It was a mini auction, after all, with just 27 slots up for grabs. Sophie Molineux, the all-rounder who led Australia to the T20 World Cup crown some three months ago in England, turned out to be the costliest star. She was bought by UP Warriorz for ₹1.10 crore.

Warriorz had come to the auction with by far the largest purse (₹3.75 crore), and the paddle from their table went up even before the auctioneer completed announcing Molineux's name. Her base price was ₹50 lakh. Royal Challengers Bengaluru was also keen, but had to step back as it didn't have the kind of money that Warriorz had.

Warriorz, of course, had more spots to fill than the other four franchises. They went on to add Grace Harris (₹30 lakh), Sneh Rana (₹30 lakh), Sushma Verma (₹30 lakh), Asha Sobhana (₹30 lakh), Kathryn Bryce (₹10 lakh), Manali Dakshini (₹10 lakh) and Sahana Pawar (₹10 lakh).

Among them, the biggest steal was Harris, one of the hardest hitters you would come across in women's cricket. She can be more than useful with her off-spin, too. She is returning to Warriorz after being part of the title-winning RCB.

Another big-hitter, Kiran Navgire, did not come as cheap: Delhi Capitals bought her for ₹75 lakh, against a base price of ₹40 lakh. Mumbai Indians was also interested in her.

G. Kamalini and Jess Jonassen were both picked up for their base price of ₹40 lakh, by Gujarat Giants and RCB, respectively. Mumbai Indians went on a spree of budget buys. It got Disha Kasat, Latika Inamdar, Bharti Rawal, Saanika Chalke and Akshita Bhagat, all for ₹10 lakh, and Shweta Sehrawat for ₹20 lakh. Uma Kashvi was sold for ₹10 lakh to Capitals, but she made history. At 15, she is the youngest to make it to a WPL squad.

There were big stars who failed to shine, like Sophia Dunkley. The England opener was the only player, apart from Molineux, who had asked for a base price of ₹50 lakh. She had no takers.

Who went **where**

The 25 players bought at the WPL mini auction on Wednesday

Player	Team	Price (₹)
Sophie Molineux	UP Warriorz	1.1 crore
Kiran Navgire	Delhi Capitals	75 lakh
G. Kamalini	Gujarat Giants	40 lakh
Jess Jonassen	Royal Challengers	40 lakh
Asha Sobhana	UP Warriorz	30 lakh
Chloe Tryon	Royal Challengers	30 lakh
Grace Harris	UP Warriorz	30 lakh
Orla Prendergast	Gujarat Giants	30 lakh
Sneh Rana	UP Warriorz	30 lakh
Sushma Verma	UP Warriorz	30 lakh
Tejal Hasabnis	Royal Challengers	30 lakh
Shweta Sehrawat	Mumbai Indians	20 lakh
Akshita Bhagat	Mumbai Indians	10 lakh
Bharti Rawal	Mumbai Indians	10 lakh
Disha Kasat	Mumbai Indians	10 lakh
Kathryn Bryce	UP Warriorz	10 lakh
Kirstie Gordon	Delhi Capitals	10 lakh
Latika Inamdar	Mumbai Indians	10 lakh
Manali Dakshini	UP Warriorz	10 lakh
Nazma Khan	Delhi Capitals	10 lakh
Saanika Chalke	Mumbai Indians	10 lakh
Sahana Pawar	UP Warriorz	10 lakh
Samaira Raghav	Gujarat Giants	10 lakh
Uma Kashvi	Delhi Capitals	10 lakh
Vrinda Dinesh	Royal Challengers	10 lakh











The 2027 **WPL Dugouts**

DELHI CAPITALS

Retained players: Annabel Sutherland*, Chinelle Henry*, Deeya Yadav, Jemimah Rodrigues, Laura Wolvaardt*, Lucy Hamilton*, Mamatha Madiwala, Marizanne Kapp*, Minnu Mani, N. Shree Charani, Nandani Sharma, Niki Prasad, Shafali Verma.

Wednesday's picks: Kiran Navgire, Kirstie Gordon*, Nazma Khan, Uma Kashvi.

GUJARAT GIANTS

Retained: Anushka Sharma, Ashleigh Gardner*, Beth Mooney*, Bharti Fulmali, Georgia Wareham*, Happy Kumari, Jintimani Kalita, Kanika Ahuja, Kashvee Gautam, Kim Garth*, Rajeshwari Gayakwad, Renuka Singh, Sophie Devine*, Tanuja Kanwar, Yastika Bhatia.

Wednesday's picks: G. Kamalini, Orla Prendergast*, Samaira Raghav.

MUMBAI INDIANS

Retained: Amanjot Kaur, Amelia Kerr*, Harmanpreet Kaur, Hayley Matthews*, Nat Sciver-Brunt*, Nicola Carey*, Rahila Firdous, S. Sajana, Sanskriti Gupta, Shabnim Ismail*, Vaishnavi Sharma.

Traded in: Tara Norris* (from UP Warriorz).

Wednesday's picks: Akshita Bhagat, Bharti Rawal, Disha Kasat, Latika Inamdar, Saanika Chalke, Shweta Sehrawat.

**Overseas players*



ROYAL CHALLENGERS BENGALURU

Retained: Arundhati Reddy, Ellyse Perry*, Georgia Voll*, Lauren Bell*, Nadine de Klerk*, Pooja Vastrakar, Prathyoosha Kumar, Prema Rawat, Radha Yadav, Richa Ghosh, Sayali Satghare, Shreyanka Patil, Smriti Mandhana.

Wednesday's picks: Chloe Tryon*, Jess Jonassen*, Tejal Hasabnis, Vrinda Dinesh.

UP WARRIORZ

Retained: Deepti Sharma, Harleen Deol, Kranti Gaud, Meg Lanning*, Phoebe Litchfield*, Pratika Rawal, Shikha Pandey, Shipra Giri, Simran Shaikh, Sophie Ecclestone*.

Wednesday's picks: Asha Sobhana, Grace Harris*, Kathryn Bryce*, Manali Dakshini, Sahana Pawar, Sneh Rana, Sophie Molineux*, Sushma Verma.



Talking tactics: RCB CEO Rajesh Menon and head coach Malolan Rangarajan in discussion. CREIMAS/BCCI

Vaishnavi's five-for sets up India's series sweep

ZIMBABWE IN INDIA

Lavanya L.
VADODARA

Zimbabwe's historic maiden tour of India ended on a sobering note for the Lady Chevrons, with Vaishnavi Sharma's maiden five-wicket haul and fifties from Pratika Rawal and Shafali Verma guiding India to a dominant eight-wicket win and a 3-0 series sweep here on Wednesday.

People in Vadodara are simple. They like their food and cricket.

They particularly like their local stars being involved in international fixtures.

At the BCA Stadium, from the security personnel to the ground staff, Yastika Bhatia was the name on everyone's lips.



One to cherish: Vaishnavi castles Gwanzura to complete her maiden five-wicket haul. CREIMAS/BCCI

After frustrating the home fans twice, India finally swapped out Richa Ghosh for her.

Yastika had a great afternoon behind the stumps, taking a catch and effecting a stumping and a run out, in an effort that restricted Zimbabwe to just 131 in 39.5 overs. But she botched a perfect opportunity to make a statement with the bat, going grand off the very first ball of the innings, only to find Francisca Chipare at mid-on.

Harleen Deol, in for Tejal Hasabnis, was overshadowed by Pratika's fluency and fell for a run-a-ball 19. Pratika and Shafali, visibly in a hurry, got the job done at T20 pace with 33 overs to spare.

Earlier, Sayali Satghare and Kranti Gaud nipped Zimbabwe's dream of a competitive score in the bud, leaving it stuttering at 12 for two by the third over.

Inexperience

Inexperience showed as the visitors struggled to rotate strike and crumbled under dot ball pressure – a staggering 193 in 237 balls.

Modester Mupachikwa resisted, but Vaishnavi's left-arm spin gobbled up the middle-order.

The Gwalior-born bowler also registered India's first no ball of the series and had a few going wide with the turn which she got on a slow track in Kotambi.

But, a maiden ODI five-for brightened the day and she eventually led India off the field with a wide smile and her signature curtain call.

The scores:
Zimbabwe 131
in 39.5 overs (Modester Mupachikwa 37, Josephine Nkomo 35, Vaishnavi Sharma 5/39) lost to India 133/2 in 17 overs (Pratika Rawal 59 n.o., Shafali Verma 51 n.o.).
Toss: Zimbabwe; **PoM:** Vaishnavi; **PoS:** Pratika.

Renshaw, Inglis put Australia in front

CRICKET

Agence France-Presse
CAPE TOWN

Josh Inglis and Alex Carey added an unbroken 145 for the fifth wicket as Australia took the lead on the second day of the third Test against South Africa at Newlands on Wednesday.

Australia was 330 for four at close, one run ahead of South Africa's first innings total of 329.

Matt Renshaw (74) and Cameron Green (65) put on 126 for the third wicket before Inglis (85 batting) and Carey (51 batting) put Australia ahead. Renshaw and Travis Head (41) put on 58 before Head was dismissed by Simon Harmer. The offie had Marnus Labuschagne caught at slip for a duck in the same over.



Inglis' knock gave Australia the upper hand. AP

The scores: South Africa 329 vs. Australia 330/4 in 90 overs (Renshaw 74, Green 65, Inglis 85 batting, Carey 51 batting).

‘Mix of former players and administrators ideal for smooth conduct of the game’

Nadeem praises Suthar and believes he is a good investment for Indian cricket going forward, says he has seen a tweaker like him after a long time

CRICKET

Vivek Krishnan
RANCHI

Shahbaz Nadeem has swapped the guile of left-arm spin for an administrative position in the plush offices of the JSCA International Stadium. After retiring from cricket in 2024, the 37-year-old’s time is now largely dedicated to his role as joint-secretary of the Jharkhand State Cricket Association (JSCA). He was elected in May last year.

On the third day of the Ranji Trophy Group-C battle between Jharkhand and Delhi, with play abandoned at 3 p.m. without a ball bowled due to rain and bad light, Nadeem was in a relaxed mood on his desk as he shed light on the transition.

“The experience has been good. When you get into cricket administration, you have to seek the welfare of the players. When you have been a cricketer yourself, you have knowledge about what is needed. As an administrator, you have the power to implement the things you have thought about,” the former tweaker, who played two Tests for India besides taking 542 First Class wickets, told *The Hindu* on Wednesday.



Having been a player has helped Nadeem in his new role. VIVEK KRISHNAN



Of the classical mould: Shahbaz says Suthar has the required tools to excel in top-flight cricket. ANI

The switch from cricketer to administrator hasn’t been smooth for many, with the day-to-day running of the sport often requiring wider expertise. Nadeem wants more of his ilk to get involved and alter that perception.

“More cricketers should definitely get into administration,” he felt. “In a cricket association, we have to run cricket, right? So, the experience I have gained by playing cricket is ideal. I wouldn’t say an entire association should be made up of cricketers. A mix of former cricketers and administrative people will make the running of the game smooth.”

Nadeem’s primary love remains left-arm spin. Ask him about Manav Suthar and he doesn’t hesitate to wax lyrical about the youngster’s ability.

“I rate him very highly. The quality of his stock ball is fantastic,” Nadeem assessed. “He has the quality of a proper left-arm spinner. I have seen someone like him after very long. He is the perfect candidate to be invested in”.



SNAPSHOTS

Shadman hits unbeaten 99 on opening day

MIRPUR: Bangladesh opener Shadman Islam was stranded on 99 as bad light brought an early end to day one in the first Test against West Indies.

The scores: Bangladesh 213/3 in 74 overs (Shadman Islam 99 batting, Towhid Hridoy 42) vs. West Indies. **Toss:** Bangladesh.

Silver for Neelam, Kajal

ASTANA: Neelam Sirohi (50kg) and Kajal Dhochak (76kg) took silver medals after losing their respective final bouts at the World wrestling championships on Wednesday. Against four-time World champion Yui Susaki, Neelam could not last long as the Japanese grabbed a 5-0 lead before pinning the Indian. Eighteen-year-old two-time World under-20 champion Kajal was beaten 8-6 by Ukraine’s Anastasiya Alpyeyeva.

Indian colts lose

BAKU: India lost 1-2 to Honduras in a round of 32 Tier C match of the FIFA u-15 World Cup and Festival on Wednesday. The Blue Colts will now move to the round of 16 of the lower bracket and contest for positions 81-96.

The result: Honduras 2 (Danio Flores 18, Alejandro Amaya 36) bt India (Ronandev Aheibam 31).

RANJI TROPHY SCORES – ROUND THREE, DAY THREE

Elite:
Group A:
At Vadodara: Baroda 616 vs. J&K 303 in 77.5 overs (Qamran Iqbal 121, Umar Nazir 101, Atit Sheth 4/61) & 8/1 in 6 overs.
At Nagpur: Goa 220 & 41/1 in 23 overs vs. Vidarbha 442/8 decl. in 134.2 overs (R. Samarth 53, Dhruv Shorey 168, Danish Malewar 56, Akshay Wadkar 63 n.o., Ruthvik Naik 5/70).
At Puducherry: Uttar Pradesh 333 in 124.5 overs (Karan Sharma 167, Shivam Mavi 50, Sagar Udeshi 4/64) vs. Pondicherry 172 in 68.1 overs (Neyan Kangayan 46, Zeeshan Ansari 4/41) & 39/0 in 11 overs.
Group B: At Vijayawada: Andhra 231 vs. Chhattisgarh 216/8 in 95 overs. No play on third day.
At Hyderabad: Punjab 431 & 57/0 in 24 overs vs. Hyderabad 380 in 119.5 overs (Abhirath Reddy 97, Rahul Radesh 86, K. Himateja 81, Pragnay Reddy 65, Vihaan Malhotra 4/15).
At Mysuru: Tripura 194 & 98/3 in 38 overs vs. Karnataka 490/9 decl. in 144 overs (Rohan Patil 72, K.V. Aneesh 68, Karun Nair 63, Aneeshwar Gautam 100, Manvanth Kumar 51, Rithesh Bhatkal 74 n.o.).
At Rajkot: Assam 281 & 65/7 in 26 overs (Parth Bhut 6/7) vs. Saurashtra 387 in 131.4 overs (Hetvik Kotak 80, Prerak Mankad 76, Arth Yadav 46 n.o., Mohit Thakur 4/126).
Group C: At Ranchi: Delhi 515/5 decl. vs. Jharkhand 131/4 in 47 overs. No play on third day.
At Bhubaneswar: Odisha 194 vs. Services 13/0 in 5 overs. No play on third day.
At Pune: Gujarat 223 & 227/3 in 67 overs (Aarya Desai 132 batting) vs. Maharashtra 330 in 120.3 overs (Digvijay Patil 43, Harshal Kate 84, Saurabh Nawale 95).
At Thiruvananthapuram: Bengal 350 & 198 in 46 overs (Abhimanyu Easwaran 47, Jalaj Saxena 5/70) vs. Kerala 141 in 51.3 overs (Vishnu Vinod 41, Pradipta Pramanik 4/44) & 53/4 in 20 overs (Pramanik 4/21).
Group D: At Dehradun: Rajasthan 272 & 290/5 decl. in 101.4 overs (Sachin Yadav 53, Mahipal Lomror 45, Karan Lamba 100 n.o., Kunal Rathore 77) vs. Uttarakhand 194 & 38/0 in 9 overs.
At Chennai: Railways 184 & 108 in 52.3 overs (S. Yuvraj Singh 42, Sai Kishore 4/39) lost to Tamil Nadu 165 & 130/5 in 59.1 overs (Andre Siddarth 56 n.o., Toufik Mondal 4/50).
Points: TN 6 (14), Railways 0 (2).
At Chandigarh: Chandigarh 685/5 decl. vs. Himachal Pradesh 340/3 in 104 overs (Innesh Mahajan 121, Shubham Arora 96, Pukhraj Mann 50 batting).
At Mumbai: Mumbai 430 vs. Haryana 270 in 107.5 overs (Nishant Sindhu 105 n.o., Dheeru Singh 45, Musheer Khan 6/85) & 73/2 in 21 overs.
Plate: At Rangpo: Nagaland 187 & 208 in 91 overs (Chetan Bist 97) vs. Sikkim 184 & 87/4 in 32 overs.
At Ahmedabad: Arunachal Pradesh 111 & 431 in 120.4 overs (Techi Doria 160, Salil Malhotra 135, Kishan Singha 5/88) vs. Manipur 364 & 12/1 in 4 overs.
At Nadiad: Meghalaya 562 vs. Mizoram 350/5 in 127 overs (Lalhruaizela 51, Chinmay Sutar 125, Joseph Lalthankhuma 70 batting).

World u-19 champ Aditya targets LA Games

BOXING

Y.B. Sarangi
KOLKATA

For someone who switched from orthodox to southpaw stance, 17-year-old Aditya Singh owes his 55kg title win at the World Boxing under-19 championships in Montenegro to the hard yards he put in during training.

Hailing from Bharan village of Rohtak district in Haryana, Aditya reached his coach Vinod Kumar, a National bronze medallist in 2006, in Meham six years ago with a modest target of getting into the Army Boys Sports Company - a pathway to employment. But, Vinod saw some spark in the kid.

“For the first six months, nothing worked. He was an orthodox boxer, but his father never told me that.



Aditya.

“I decided to give another six months and see his performance as a southpaw. It produced results,” Vinod, also the basics coach of Olympian Preeti Pawar at Meham Boxing Club, told *The Hindu*.

Apart from Vinod, Aditya, a former National junior champion and an Asian under-19 silver medallist, is grateful to his farmer father Mahender Singh, who took his son to Meham, about 20km from their village, daily for training.

The teenager, who landed in the colder Montenegro two days prior to his first fight, outsmarted USA’s Futures Cup champion Christian Paez with a RSC verdict in the second round.

“I adapted after my first fight,” Aditya, who idolises Vassily Lomachenko and Andy Cruz, said.

He counted his gains from his five wins against boxers from three continents. “The opponents, including two southpaws, had different techniques. I learnt a lot,” said Aditya, who also got past Serbia’s Filip Stanojevic 5-0, Italy’s Tommaso Orlando 5-0, Azerbaijan’s Nihat Gasimov 5-0 and Russian Islam Magomedov 4-1 to claim India’s lone gold medal.

Coach Ramanand of the Indian team praised Aditya for his hard work and adaptability. “Aditya was good in listening to the coaches and adapting well as per the situation. In the final against the Russian, he rallied from 2-3 in the first round to win the bout,” said Ramanand.

While Aditya looks to continue as an age-group boxer, Vinod targets Los Angeles 2028. “He deserves to be in the next Olympics. He stands out with his dedication and discipline,” said Vinod.

FC Goa draws with SC Delhi

Press Trust of India
MARGAO

Sporting Club Delhi was left frustrated after FC Goa snatched a dramatic 1-1 draw with a stoppage-time equaliser in their ISL match here on Wednesday.

The result: FC Goa 1 (Vallejo 90+5) drew with SC Delhi 1 (Pena 51).

LIVE TELECAST

Ranji Trophy: Baroda vs. J &K, Day 4, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
Bangladesh vs. West Indies: First Test, Day 2, FanCode, 9.30 a.m.
South Africa vs. Australia: Third Test, Day 3, Eurosport & FanCode, 2 p.m.
Serie A: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 11 p.m. & 1.15 a.m. (Friday)

IOCL holds Indian Army; BPCL through to the semifinals

MURUGAPPA GOLD CUP

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
CHENNAI

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd. (IOCL) held Indian Army to a 2-2 draw in a Pool-A match of the 97th All-India MCC-Murugappa Gold Cup hockey tournament at the SDAT Mayor Radhakrishnan Stadium here on Wednesday, leaving the latter’s semifinal hopes hanging in the balance.

Indian Railways has secured a last-four berth from Pool-A, while Army’s progress depends on Thursday’s match between Railways and Punjab National Bank (PNB).

PNB needs to win by a seven-goal margin to advance ahead of Army.

In Pool-B, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) has qualified for the semifinals. Indian Navy needs only a draw against Malaysia’s junior team on Thursday to join it, while the Malaysian colts must win to progress.

Sunil Yadav put IOCL ahead in the 29th minute, converting a penalty stroke after Army’s Niraj Waribam impeded S.K. Uthappa with his stick near the goal.



Strong finish: Uthappa’s strike helped IOCL secure a draw. R. RAGU

Army responded immediately, with Cyril Lugun converting a penalty corner in the 30th minute off Rohit Irengbam’s delivery.

Army went ahead in the 43rd minute when Jobanpreet Singh converted a penalty stroke.

The award followed Lugun’s drag-flick striking Vikramjit Singh’s leg on the goal-line as the defender prevented a certain goal.

IOCL restored parity in the 49th minute through S.K. Uthappa, who finished a long through pass from V.R. Raghunath.

Both sides squandered a penalty corner each in the closing stages.

The results:

Pool-A: IOCL 2 (Sunil Yadav 29-ps, S.K. Uthappa 49) drew with Indian Army 2 (Cyril Lugun 30-pc, Jobanpreet Singh 43-ps).

Pool-B: Hockey Unit of Tamil Nadu 4 (G.M. Pruthvi 14-pc, Yojin Minz 23, 47, Patras Tirkey 26-pc) bt Malaysia junior team 2 (Salihe Muhammad 15-pc, Karthikesan Shivamoorthy 60-pc).

BPCL 5 (Varun Kumar 23-ps, Charanjeet Singh 25, 41, Anmol Ekka 35-pc, Sudeep Chirmako 42) drew with Indian Navy 5 (Sushil Dhanwar 6-pc, Pawan Rajbhar 34, 56-pc, Rajat Sharma 37, Rajat Minz 46).

Emotional and proud homecoming for the hockey heroes at ACT

Uthra Ganesan
JALANDHAR

India’s opening game of the Asian Champions Trophy (ACT) here had three goals from Mandeep Singh. The man who had stepped on to the field earlier that day, however, was Lalli.

That’s what Mandeep’s friends and family call him. They were all in attendance at the Olympian Surjit Singh stadium on Tuesday, watching him play in an India jersey on home ground for the first time ever.

Fourteen years after he made the national team as an 18-year-old, Mandeep returned to the turf where he learnt to hold a hockey stick, this time as a two-time Olympic medalist.

“I can’t express what it means to play at home in front of family. It’s just a very special, very proud feeling right now. It started the moment I entered the building and watching the crowd in the stands. I have played for the country for 14 years and this is the first time I am doing so in my own state,” Mandeep told *The Hindu*.

He was one of the five players from the academy to take the field; Manpreet Singh, the most famous one, missed out with an injury even though his family was present in the stands.



Mandeep’s family saw him play at home for the first time 14 years after he turned out for India. X@THEHOCKEYINDIA

Every player in this team, in fact, will be playing international hockey in Punjab for the first time ever – the last time the state hosted a tournament was the Gold Cup in 2009, in Chandigarh.

Harmanpreet Singh was excited about having his parents see him play live in a stadium for the first time. “We have played in all the major cities across the world but nothing matches returning home. This is a very special homecoming for all of us,” he admitted.

Dilpreet, the youngest from the academy, had his own vocal support group of kids from his village in Batala, holding up his posters.

“My parents keep asking me when is the tournament beginning, when can we come; they even want to come and watch me in training sessions,” said Dilpreet.

Goalkeeper Krishan Pathak and Jarmanpreet Singh are the other two from the academy. The one common factor in their narratives is the importance of heroes and watching them live on the domestic circuit, and the importance of domestic events themselves.

“I watched Jugraj Singh play for Punjab Police here,” Harmanpreet gushed.

“I was inspired by watching Sardar and Sandeep Singh during domestic competitions,” Mandeep added.

India, meanwhile, will take on China in its second game of the tournament while Malaysia takes on Korea and Bangladesh plays Japan on Thursday.

Mirabai to compete in 53kg at Worlds

WEIGHTLIFTING

Y.B. Sarangi
KOLKATA

World and Olympic medallist Mirabai Chanu, who recently got a silver medal in the Asian Games in the 49kg category, will compete in 53kg at the World weightlifting championships in Ningbo, China, on Thursday.

The 32-year-old lifter jumped to the higher weight after 53kg became the minimum weight category for women at the Los Angeles 2028 Olympics.

Mirabai, who has won all her major medals in either 48kg or 49kg, had competed in 55kg once at the Singapore International meet in 2022.

For the World championships, which is an Olympic qualifying event, Mirabai has entered a pre-competition total of 200kg and is placed in Group ‘B.’ Top competitors in each weight are clubbed in Group ‘A.’

“Mira entered this competition to check herself and gather some ideas. She did not have the time to prepare after the Asian Games, leave alone increasing her normal body weight (which stays around 50kg).

“We will begin our preparation from March next. The target is to qualify for the Olympics,” chief national coach Vijay Sharma told *The Hindu*.

Qualifying timeline

The LA Olympics qualifying timeline has two periods. Best three results of the first period, comprising six events, and best two results from the second period, including four events, of an athlete will be considered to finalise the Olympic Qualification Ranking (OQR).

Top-eight athletes in each weight category will earn Olympic quota places.

Meanwhile, India has fielded Gyaneshwari Yadav (53kg), Usha and Nirupama Devi (both 61kg) and Commonwealth Games silver medallist Lovepreet Singh (+110kg).

Charu Pesi (65kg), hailing from Arunachal Pradesh, could not make it to Ningbo after he got a stapled Chinese visa.





CREIMAS/BCCI

Terrific Threesome — redefining the slam-bang manual

India are blessed to have four equally aggressive and proven options to pick from to open the batting should it come to that. Abhishek, Samson, Sooryavanshi and Kishan are each more than a handful on his own; throw three, or even all four (like at the Asian Games) in the mix, and you can't help but feel for the already beleaguered bowling community

R. Kaushik

If cricket is a game of glorious uncertainties, then its 20-over variant is even more so. It's no secret that the shorter the format, the more of a level-playing field it is, which is why 'upsets' are more commonplace in T20 cricket than in 50-over games or matches of longer durations.

One of the almost iron-clad certainties, even in the slam-bang version, is that if Abhishek Sharma plays a minimum of 10 deliveries, at least one six, if not more, is guaranteed. So complete is his command over his craft that he has established himself as the most valuable property in this format, wreaking such unimaginable havoc that oftentimes, opposition bowlers desperately wish for the earth to open up and gobble them up.

Tuesday at Wellington's Hnry Stadium is the latest instance of the left-hander from Punjab snatching the game away from the opposition in the small matter of a half-hour. Trailing 0-2 in the five-match and perhaps aware that they had left at least 25 runs back in the changing room, New Zealand targeted early success to keep themselves in the hunt after posting 198. As it turned out, with no little help from the precocious, precious Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Abhishek made it decidedly a no-contest, raining fours and sixes with such stunning regularity that Mitchell Santner and his charges had nowhere to hide.

The vicissitudes of sport

No one has experienced the vicissitudes of sport, and specifically the T20 game, more than Abhishek – perhaps with the exception of his regular opening partner, Sanju Samson. He began 2026 in a blaze of glory with two half-centuries against the Kiwis at home, but each of those was succeeded by a first-ball blob. Then came the cruellest of cuts as India began their hunt to defend the T20 World Cup crown worn in Bridgetown in June 2024.

Abhishek was expected to set the tone for India's dominance, but he made the most wretched of starts to his World Cup career. In the opener against United States in Mumbai, he was dismissed off the first ball of the contest, caught at deep cover. It was an unfortunate dismissal in the sense that he picked out the admittedly strategically placed fielder with unerring accuracy as he opened his shoulders and creamed a full, wide ball from paceman Ali Khan, looking to make his trademark opening statement with a signature six.

It happens, we all said, especially given the willingness with which Abhishek embraces risk. But it happened again, in his next match against Pakistan in Colombo (he missed the game against Namibia in Delhi after being hospitalised with a stomach infection). And in the fixture that followed, against Netherlands in Ahmedabad. Three ducks on the bounce, the last two also in the first over against off-spinners Salman Agha and Aryan Dutt respectively, suggested a pattern which compelled India to split their all-left opening combination of Abhishek and Ishan Kishan by bringing Samson into the equation.

Abhishek salvaged a most modest tournament with an authoritative half-century in the final against New Zealand, feeding off the show of confidence from the think-tank which didn't so much as contemplate leaving him out despite 0, 0, 0 and 15 in his first four hits. His stunning early assault, with the by-now flowing Samson, sparked a first-wicket stand of 98 in a mere 43 deliveries, the foundation from which India closed out a commanding 96-run victory to retain their title in grand style in front of nearly 100,000 unashamedly partisan spectators at the Narendra Modi Stadium.

Thriving off his heroics in the final, Abhishek slipped back into his usual destructive mode thereafter, one of the few bright spots when India lost 0-6 to Ireland and England combined in June-July. A trough in Zimbabwe - 11 runs in three innings - was no more than a temporary blip. Upon return home, he smashed 108 off 34 balls against Afghanistan in Delhi, 61 (28b) in the Asian Games final against Pakistan in Nisshin and 69 (30b) against West Indies in Indore.

Frenzied starts

In New Zealand, he had got the team off to much-needed frenzied starts in the first two games, with 29 off 12 and 27 off 21 in stiff run-chases. Which brought us to the Hnry Stadium, where India were confronted with a target of 199 to take an unbeatable 3-0 lead.

For much of Abhishek's post-World Cup run, his partner in crime was Samson. On and off, the latter made way to accommodate Sooryavanshi, most notably in Zimbabwe where the wicketkeeper from Keralam didn't even figure in the extended squad after a run of modest scores following his Player-of-the-Tournament heroics in the World Cup.

For long, Samson has been one of the great enigmas of Indian cricket. When he is on song, he bats like a dream, making that vocation look ridiculously easy and straightforward. But then, he also lapses into frustrating inconsistency, which is what opened the door in the first place for Kishan's reintegration with international cricket. Overlooked for the early part of the World Cup (except in Delhi in Abhishek's unavailability), Samson was brought back in Chennai to offer a right-handed point of difference at the top of the tree, and responded with successive scores of 24, 97 not out, 89 and 89 (the last three in the knockouts) to become the toast of the nation.

Typically Samson-like, he followed that up with 5, 0 and 1 to make way for Sooryavanshi midway through the England series; chastened, he reeled off 57 and 50 in consecutive knocks against Afghanistan, then embarked on a string of 9, 7, 2 and 11 to ensure that he reprised a pattern that has been his constant companion all his career.

Why then would he not make half-centuries in three of his next five knocks? He wouldn't be Samson otherwise, would he?

Abhishek's mostly-off, now-on travails and Samson's blow-hot blow-cold figures could paint the picture of the lack of substantial starts and early pressure on the incoming No. 3, mostly Kishan, and while there might be some truth to how that picture takes shape, the reality is also starkly surprising. The 26-year-old stylist from Amritsar and the 31-year-old purist from Thiruvananthapuram have been involved in five stands in excess of 50 in the 25 innings in which they have opened together this calendar year, equalling an Indian record held hitherto by K.L. Rahul and Rohit Sharma (in 2021) and by Abhishek himself and his good mate Shubman Gill (in 2025) when the latter made a brief if largely unsuccessful return to 20-over internationals.

Two to tango

Abhishek and Samson complement each other superbly; there is no competition, healthy or otherwise, no subconscious duel of one-upmanship, no trying to outdo each other. Both are comfortable in their respective skins, instinctively holding back when they sense that their partner is firing on all cylinders, and quickly taking over the lead role if the other is a little off-key. It helps that one is a left-hander and the other bats right-handed, because it then becomes practically impossible for the bowling group to line a particular type of batter up.

They target different areas of the ground - Abhishek's on-side play has come on by leaps and bounds and his pick-up shot is a joy to behold even if it can sometimes be his kryptonite too - and hit different strokes to balls of the same length, driving the opposition ragged with their dominance, their chutzpah and their fearlessness, for which loads of credit must also be placed at the doorstep of successive leadership groups.

On Tuesday, Samson was pushed down to No. 3 so that Sooryavanshi, the boy wonder, could return to his preferred opening slot. In Christchurch on Saturday when Kishan was unavailable with an adductor injury, the lad from Bihar had batted at No. 3 and evidently struggled, piecing together an unconvincing four off eight deliveries. That was understandable, considering it was his first competitive outing for three weeks, since the Asian Games final on October 3.

Orchestrating the swap

Quickly realising that Samson's greater experience could allow them to split up the successful opening combination by slotting him at one-drop and thrusting Sooryavanshi to his comfort zone, Shreyas Iyer and Gautam Gambhir orchestrated the swap that resulted in the highest ever PowerPlay score (118) in T20I history.

Sooryavanshi hammered four fours and as many sixes in a 19-ball 45, almost holding his own as his senior partner, Abhishek, tore into the bowling. That being said, it was Sooryavanshi who fired the first shots across the bows, hammering the first ball of the chase, from Jacob Duffy, over mid-on for four and clattering the third legal delivery of the innings over and behind point for a towering six. New Zealand ran into a revolving door; they were battered for 50 in just 2.2 overs, the fastest team fifty in all T20Is.

Huge accomplishment

Abhishek brought up his half-century in 15 deliveries, and took another 20 balls for his second fifty. His 11th century meant he left the great Virat Kohli behind and became the Indian with the most 20-over hundreds; it was also his fourth T20I ton, a monumental accomplishment considering he has played just 69 innings.

Just to put things in perspective, Rohit Sharma (who holds the record for the most T20I hundreds alongside Glenn Maxwell), finished with five centuries from 151 hits, while Suryakumar Yadav, with whom Abhishek drew abreast, batted 107 times though that is offset by the fact that he didn't always occupy the top three slots. In all T20s, only Chris Gayle (22) and Babar Azam (13) have more three-figure knocks than the rangy left-hander. With time, opportunity and ambition on his side, Abhishek won't be playing second fiddle to many of these worthies for a long time.

India are blessed to have four equally aggressive and proven options to pick from to open the batting should it come to that. Abhishek, Samson, Sooryavanshi and Kishan are each more than a handful on his own; throw three, or even all four (like at the Asian Games) in the mix, and you can't help but feel for the already beleaguered bowling community.

As a popular catchline for a television brand goes: Neighbour's Envy, Owner's Pride.

THE GIST

- Tuesday at Wellington's Hnry Stadium is the latest instance of Abhishek making it a no-contest, raining fours and sixes with such stunning regularity that Santner and his charges had nowhere to hide
- Abhishek and Samson complement each other superbly; there is no competition, healthy or otherwise, no subconscious duel of one-upmanship, no trying to outdo each other. Both are comfortable in their skins, instinctively holding back when they sense that their partner is firing on all cylinders
- For much of Abhishek's post-World Cup run, his partner in crime was Samson. On and off, the latter made way to accommodate Sooryavanshi, most notably in Zimbabwe where the wicketkeeper from Keralam didn't even figure in the extended squad

New genetic tools are breathing fresh life into India's staple crops

As new tools like apomixis become more widely available and private companies shift focus to Indian seeds, it is as important to think about how our system will adapt to these changes as it is to focus on investing in fundamental research in plant genetics, physiology, and host-pathogen interactions

K. VijayRaghavan



India's food security largely depends on rice and wheat, which take up more than half our farmland and provide most of the calories we eat. THOMPSON LE/UNSPLASH

Technology is rapidly changing the way we cultivate rice and wheat, and India has the opportunity to lead the pack if we restore the attraction of fundamental research in plant sciences to our students. The shrillness of anti-GMO voices has driven aspiring biology researchers to other areas of life sciences, which use much the same methods. We need to bring them back to plant research, too.

India's food security largely depends on rice and wheat, which take up more than half our farmland and provide most of the calories Indians eat. Scientists and breeders designed today's wheat and rice varieties at a time when the consequences of excess fertilizer use on soil were not sufficiently anticipated, when pesticides were used to hit insects and other pests with a metaphorical hammer, and when water and electricity were abundant or heavily subsidised.

Today, however, climate change, extreme weather events, droughts, and floods are more immediate concerns. This together with demands for sustainable and moderated use of pesticides and fertilizers, but without compromising yield, has created a high-bar of demand in a competitive world. In addition, science and technology are but one component of solutions that also involve politics, economics, and global supply chains.

Public institutions

The supply of seeds to farmers, for crops such as rice and wheat, has had a strong public-sector presence. The National Seeds Corporation (NSC) was established in 1963. The NSC partners with State seed corporations and State agricultural universities to ensure reliability in the early stages of seed supply. The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) laboratories and State agricultural universities ensure supply of 'breeder seeds', certified to be of the highest quality. These are then amplified by partners, which include private companies to generate 'foundation seeds', which are distributed.

For wheat, public institutions dominate the supply of certified seeds, with private players being present in only about 5% of the market. However, their share is growing rapidly, at about 8% each year. In the case of rice, private companies dominate the market for hybrid seeds, with public institutions mainly supplying farmers with small-holdings.

In India, public institutions play a large role in wheat and rice, unlike with maize and cotton, where private companies dominate. The new varieties they develop are available to any registered seed company, public or private. The government has a system in place to make and distribute these new varieties widely, cheaply, and fairly – a system which works reasonably.

India took a big step forward in 2025 in using new gene-editing technology to improve rice, and became the first country to allow farmers to grow rice that had been edited using this technology. The scientists also grew these rice strains in fields, and the approved seeds are now being given to farmers.

Two types of rice, DRR Dhan-100 and Pusa DST Rice-1, were developed by Indian researchers using the CRISPR gene-editing technology. Researchers tested these new rice types widely in 2023-2024. The advances were significant. One variety DRR Dhan-100 took 130 days to mature, compared to 150 days of the baseline strain. It produced close to 20% more rice, at about 5.4 tonnes per hectare, and reduced water use and labour costs. Pusa DST Rice-1 was developed to grow reasonably in salty or alkaline soils. Its yield in these conditions was about 10-30% more than the baseline strains. Government announcements point to lowered water and fertilizer use and, consequently, lowered greenhouse gas emissions as well.

Tale of two varieties

The story behind these two strains is worth understanding for how fundamental research on rice flowering leads to application. The targeted gene in DRR DNAn-1 encodes a product that degrades cytokinin, the hormone driving spikelet formation on a rice panicle. This process caps how many grains a plant can produce.

ICAR's CRISPR edit partially reduces, but does not eliminate, this enzyme's activity, letting cytokinin accumulate just enough to boost spikelet and grain number without the stunted growth seen in complete knockouts. In 2005, Motoyuki Ashikari's team in Japan had already traced a grain-number trait to a natural small deletion in the corresponding gene in a high-yielding wild rice relative, and ICAR recreated that two-decade-old discovery by design, in weeks rather than through years of conventional breeding.

The PUSA DST-1 story is equally interesting. In 2020, a team at ICAR-Indian Agricultural Research Institute, led by Viswanathan Chinnusamy, used the CRISPR-Cas9 gene-editing tool to delete a stretch of a rice gene called *OsDST*, in a particular strain, producing plants with broader leaves, fewer stomata, and sharply better survival under salt stress (over 65% versus just 20% in unedited plants).

This engineered mutant reproduced the effects of a naturally occurring chemical mutation found years earlier in a completely different rice subspecies, confirming that disabling *DST* itself rather than some editing side-effect of the edit had conferred the stress tolerance. Pusa DST Rice 1, released five years later, is the commercial maturation of this already published laboratory mutant, illustrating a journey from a characterised gene to seed ready for farmers to use.

In both cases, the residues of the gene-editing tools were not detected in the final strains. Thus, while genetic engineering tools were used, the results are equivalent to those that would come from conventional mutagenesis and breeding, only much faster and more accurate.

Work on apomixis

Scientists at public institutions conducted the work on the rice, and the resulting seeds will not be tied up in restrictive patents or licensing agreements. The developers have also made sure that the technology used to create it will not be a bottleneck for public breeding programs.

Other innovative approaches are now on the horizon and will likely be deployable in the near future, led by a method called apomixis. It was first successfully demonstrated in rice by Venkatesan Sundaresan and his colleague Imtiyaz Khanday at the University of California, Davis, in 2018. In apomixis, plants are engineered to bypass the normal process of sexual reproduction and fertilisation. This allows desirable traits of the parent plant, known as hybrid vigour, to be preserved indefinitely, rather than being lost in the next generation. The efficiency of this method has improved significantly, with success rates reaching around 90% in rice. Various research groups are now exploring apomixis in other crops, such as maize and sorghum.

Sundaresan's work on plant development earned him a share of the prestigious Wolf Prize in agriculture in 2024, alongside Elliot Meyerowitz and Joanne Chory. In December 2025, Sundaresan and Khanday received the VinFuture Special Prize for their work on self-cloning crop technology, which has the potential to revolutionise agriculture.

There is still a big gap between the lab and the field. Tests in different environments are required to get regulatory approval and to set up systems to produce seeds in large quantities. Because adding foreign genes is not required to make apomixis work, many of these techniques could potentially follow a simpler regulatory process. The technology makes sense for small farmers. If they can save seeds from high-yielding crops and replant them without losing any quality, they will not have to keep buying new seeds every year. This is currently a big expense for many smallholder rice and wheat farmers.

Driving progress

India has not seen a gene-edited wheat released yet, but there are some conventional developments in the pipeline. For instance, the government recently introduced 184 new crop varieties across 25 different crops, including some climate-resilient wheat lines that are expected to reach farmers within the next three years. Hybrid wheat has been a challenge for breeders due to the complexities of wheat's floral biology. It is harder to hybridise than rice or maize. Despite this, hybrid wheat has been gaining traction in India, due in part to private companies like Mahyco and Nuziveedu.

Currently, the most advanced genetically engineered trait in wheat is called HB4, developed by an Argentine company called Bioceres Crop Solutions. This trait uses a gene from sunflowers to help wheat plants tolerate drought. This is not a new type of gene editing but a traditional genetically engineered trait. HB4 is already being grown commercially in Argentina, and on a smaller scale in Brazil and Paraguay.

In August 2024, the U.S. Department of Agriculture gave the green light for HB4 wheat to be grown in the country, making it the fourth to approve its production. However, it may take a few years before we see large-scale commercial planting in the U.S., since more field trials need to be done and the trait needs to be integrated into American wheat varieties. Additionally, export markets need to approve the trait as well.

Australia is taking a two-pronged approach to improving wheat yields, with two separate programmes running side by side. The Australian government has given the green light for field trials of HB4. This trial started in 2024. At the same time, the University of Adelaide is working on a project to engineer wheat and barley to produce higher yields, using genetic modification techniques. This project is set to run until 2029.

Meanwhile, an Australian breeding company called InterGrain has teamed up with a U.S. firm called Inari to try out CRISPR gene-editing. They are hoping to boost wheat yields by 10% and have already started field trials in the 2025 growing season. In a significant development, Australian Grain Technologies and China's Qihe Biosciences have announced that they will be working together on cross-border field trials of a new CRISPR-edited wheat variety. This is important as it shows that international collaboration is driving progress in wheat gene-editing, unlike some other crops like rice.

Reviving a tradition

India's approach to breeding wheat and rice is still largely controlled by the public sector, which means new techniques like editing genes without adding foreign ones can be made available to farmers.

As new tools like apomixis become more widely available and private companies start investing more in Indian seeds, it is as important to think about how our system will adapt to these changes as it is to invest in fundamental research in plant genetics, physiology, development and host-pathogen interactions.

We have had a great tradition here, and it should be revived.

(K. VijayRaghavan is the DAE-Homi Bhabha Chair, TIFR-National Centre for Biological Sciences, Bengaluru. vijay@ncbs.res.in)



India's approach to breeding wheat and rice is still largely controlled by the public sector, which means new techniques like editing genes without adding foreign ones can be made available to farmers. GETTY IMAGES



Salt marshes in India have been estimated to cover around 290 sq. km and support wildlife while stabilising coastal sediments. FILE PHOTO

How the humble salt marsh softens the ocean's fury

Vasudevan Mukunth

The boundary between land and sea is neither fixed nor clear. The soil does not suddenly stop and give away to a wall of water. Instead, the line is often a salt marsh, where ocean waves break and lose vim as they pass over the marsh's elevated surface and push against the stems of salt-tolerant plants.

Gujarat is home to India's largest coastal salt marshes, with smaller areas in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and Maharashtra, among some other places. One 2020 study in *Estuarine Coastal and Shelf Science* estimated they covered around 290 sq. km in all, and supported wildlife and stabilised coastal sediments. Unfortunately they also face significant threats from expanding aquaculture and coastal development.

As global warming continues, storms become ever stronger and water levels rise, these coastal zones are slowly being acknowledged for the formidable natural buffers they are. But they are being threatened as well, especially their plants, and what might happen if they are gone?

A 2014 study in *Nature Geoscience* used a wave flume – a long tank filled with water that uses a mechanical paddle to generate waves – to show that the plants of the salt marsh could break waves substantially even when their stems bent or broke.

Key findings

A new study in *Nature* by researchers at Wageningen University & Research in the Netherlands took the study a big step further. The team moved 306 sq. metres of a live salt marsh, down to the soil and roots, from the coast of the Dutch Wadden Sea to a 300-metre-long flume at the Deltares Research Institute, capable of creating the world's largest artificial waves. There, the marsh was tested at different depths against waves measuring 75 cm, 1.25 metres, and 2 metres high over many hours.

The findings were remarkable: the marsh's elevation fell only 7 mm but at the cost of the flora on the surface losing 75-80% of their biomass and having their stems become shorter by almost half. The researchers concluded the plants' dense network of roots had helped hold the sediments together. The team also found the plants cut the height of waves 75 cm high by 6-22% but those of waves 2 metres high only by up to 6%.

The team also combined their findings with maps of salt marshes worldwide and modelled the storm surges there. For once in a century storms – the kind climate change is rendering more common these days, like Cyclone Nisarga in 2020 – the team elucidated two kinds of outcomes.

Where the incoming waves are at most a metre high, the plants could be expected to cut the height of waves by over 10%, in some instances by as much as 50%. But if the waves got higher, the plants (alone) also became less effective at attenuating them.

Obviously these figures are not a guarantee for every coast everywhere. The study relied on a Dutch marsh dominated by one species of grass (*Elymus athericus*).

A different study published this year, in *Communications Sustainability*, also found that marsh species with more flexible stems often survived extreme waves better than stiffer ones. Nonetheless, the findings are important: they reinforce the ecological value of salt marshes, including the roots they still hold on exposed coasts.

mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in

For feedback and suggestions
for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'